

PSALMS

THE BOOK OF PSALMS.

PREFACE.

The Psalms are called by the Hebrew, Tehillim; that is, hymns of praise. The author, of a great part of them at least, was king David; but many are of opinion, that some of them were made by Asaph and others, whose names are prefixed in the titles. Ch. --- These, however, are not unquestionably of divine authority, though they deserve to be respected. C. --- S. Jerom (ad Cyprian) says: "Let us be convinced that those labour under a mistake, who suppose that David was the author of all the Psalms, and not those whose names appear in the titles." Paine is not, therefore, the first who has made this discovery. Watson. 2 Par. xxix. 30. --- Psalm lxxvi.

compared with Psalms xxxviii. lxiv. lxx. cxi. cxxv. cxxxvi. and cxlv. seems favourable of this opinion, (C. T. &c.) which is contrary to S. Ambrose, &c. The matter is not of great moment, as all confess that the 150 Psalms were dedicated by the Holy Ghost. D. --- S. Aug. (de Civ. Dei.

xvii. 14.) attributes all the Psalms to David; and it seems best to adhere to this opinion, as it is most generally received. M. --- Our Saviour cites the cix. Psalm as belonging to David, (Matt.

xxii. 44.) agreeably to the title; and the 2d Psalm is also attributed to him, by the apostles, (Act.

iv. 25.) though it have no title at all, no more than the first. H. --- It has generally been asserted, that when a Psalm is in this position, it must be referred to the author who was mentioned last.

But Bellarmine calls this in question: and the titles of themselves afford but a precarious argument, either to know the author or the real import of the Psalm.

C. --- S. Jerom himself (ad Paulin.) seems to suppose that David was the writer of all the Psalms, (W.) and that he has left us compositions which may vie with those of the most celebrated pagan bards. In effect, nothing could excel the harmony of these divine hymns, to judge even from a translation. Fleury. ---

What then would they be in the original? The difficulty of coming to a perfect knowledge of the author's meaning, arises chiefly from the variety of translations and commentaries, which have been more numerous on this work than any other. To examine all minutely, would require more volumes than our present limits will allow. The version which we have to explain, is not that which S. Jerom made from the Heb. and which possesses the same intrinsic merit as the rest of his works: but the Church has declared authentic the holy doctor's corrected (H.) version from S.

Lucian, (Bellar. T.) or from the Sept. as the people had been accustomed to sing the psalter in that manner; and it would have been difficult for them to learn another. C. --- A critical examination would show, that the Sept. have not so often deviated from the original as some would pretend.

See Berthier, &c. Pellican extols the fidelity of our version on the Psalms, though he was a Prot.

Ward. Err. p. 6. --- When therefore we offer a different version, we would not insinuate that the Vulg. is therefore to be rejected. The copiousness of the Heb. language, (H.) and on some occasions the uncertainty of its roots, or precise import, (Somon. Crit.) ought to make every one diffident in pronouncing peremptorily on such subjects. Let us rather adhere to the decision of the Church, when it is given on any particular text; and when she is silent, let us endeavour to draw the streams of life from our Saviour's fountains, and read for our improvement in virtue. H.

--- No exhortations could be more cogent, than those which we may find in the Psalms. They contain the sum of all the other sacred books, as the Fathers agree. S. Aug. S. Bas. &c. To understand them better, we

must reflect upon what key or string they each play. Expositors discover ten such stings on this mysterious harp: 1. God; 2. his works; 3. Providence; 4. the peculiar people of the Jews; 5. Christ; 6. his Church; 7. true worship; 8. David; 9. the end of the world; 10. a future life. On some of these subjects the Psalm principally turns.

The titles, composed by Esdras, or the Sept. (W.) or by some other, (C.) will often point out the subject; and if that be not the case, the context and other parts of Scripture will (W.) commonly (H.) do it. W.

--- The greatest stress must be laid on these. C. --- An intimate acquaintance with the history of David, and with the Jewish and Christian religion, will also be of essential service to enable us to penetrate the hidden treasures contained in these most heavenly canticles. H. --- David excels all the pagans in point of antiquity, as he lived 100 years before Homer. His natural genius led him to follow the pursuits of poetry and music; (1 K. xvi. 23.) and God inspired him to compose these poems, as works in metre are more easily remembered, and make a more pleasing impression upon the heart. Hence Moses and other prophets adopted the same plan, both in the Old and the New Testament. The pious king not being permitted to build the temple, made nevertheless all necessary preparations for it; and among the rest, procured 288 masters of music to train up 4000

singers. 1 Par. xxiii. 25. He foresaw that these Psalms would be of service, not only on the Jewish festivals, but also in the Christian Church, (Ps. lvi. 10. &c.) gathered from all nations, (W.) among whom he sings by the mouths (H.) of the clergy, who are commanded daily to sing or recite some of these Psalms. W. ---

The psalter takes its name from an instrument of ten strings, resembling the Greek L, (Ven. Bede) and sounding from above, to insinuate that we may (W.) here learn to observe (H.) all the decalogue, and to aim at heaven. If difficulties present themselves in the perusal of these sacred writings, we must remember not to trust private interpretation, (2 Pet. i.) but to the doctrine of the Church, (Jo. xiv. 16. 1 Cor. xii.) which we may find in the works of the holy Fathers, (S.

Aug. Doct.) and exercise ourselves in humility, when any thing occurs above our comprehension. S. Greg. xvii. in Ezec. W. --- We must pray with all earnestness to the Father of Lights, and surely no prayers can be more efficacious to obtain what we want, than those which he has here delivered.

Whether just or sinners, whether in joy or sorrow, we may here find what may be suitable for us. H. --- In hoc libro spiritualis Bibliotheca instructa est.

Cassiod.

PSALM 1

PSALM I. (BEATUS VIR.)

The happiness of the just: and the evil state of the wicked.

Theodoret observes that this psalm has "no title in Heb.;" and some have attributed it to Esdras, when he collected the psalms into one book. But the Compl. Sept. reads, "A psalm of David;"

"without a title among the Hebrews." The Fathers attribute it to David, and suppose that he speaks particularly of Joseph of Arimathea, or of Jesus Christ; though the Jews refer this high encomium to Josias. Jeremias (xvii. 7.) has imitated this psalm, which may be considered as a preface to all the rest, and an abridgment of the whole duty of man. C. --- Blessed. Heb. also, Manifold are (H.) "the blessings" (Pagnin) both for time (H.) and eternity. W. ---

Ungodly, who mind no religion, or a false one. H. --- Heb. "inconstant."

Sinners, who are still more obstinate. C. --- Pestilence. Heb. "scoffers," who are the most dangerous sort of people, boldly deriding all religion, and maintaining atheism. There is a beautiful gradation here observed, showing the fatal consequences of evil company. If the virtuous associate with one even of the least contagious, the infection presently

catches him, and he is soon introduced among the more dissolute, where he stops with little remorse, till at last he even glories in his shame, and becomes a champion of impiety. 1

Cor. xv. 33. H. --- These three sorts of wicked people may designate pagans, Jews, and heretics. S. Clem. Stron. ii. S. Jerom. C. --- He is on the road to heaven, who has not consented to evil suggestions, nor continued in sin, so as to die impenitent. W.

Virtus est vitium fugere, et sapientia prima. Hor. i. ep. 1.

--- The suggestion, delight, and consent to sin, are here rejected, as well as every offence against God, ourselves, or our neighbours. Hopper.

Ver. 2. Will. He is wholly occupied and delighted in keeping God's commandments. W. --- This distinguishes the saint from him who only refrains from sin through fear. C. --- *Qui timet invitus observat.* S. Amb. --- Yet even servile fear is of some service, as it restrains exterior conduct, and may, in time, give place to filial reverence. H. --- Meditate, and put in practice. M. ---

Night.

The Jews studied the books of the law so earnestly from their childhood, that they could recite them as easily as they could tell their own names; (Josep. c.

Ap. 2. Deut. vi. 6.) and is it not a shame that many Christians should be so negligent, that they have never so much as read the gospels! (C.) though they be eager enough after idle books. The sacred writings are the records of our inheritance. They shew us our true destination, and deserve to be most seriously considered from the beginning to the end. H.

Ver. 3. Tree. Probably the palm-tree, the emblem of a long life. Job xxviii. 18.

The tree of life is watered by the river of living waters, proceeding from the throne of God, who is the source of all grace. Apoc. xxii. 1. Lu. xxi. 33. Jo. iv.

14. C. --- Those who make good use of favours received, are continually supplied with fresh graces. W. --- And. In the office-book a new verse begins here, though not in Heb. which the Vulg. follows. They were not marked by the sacred penman. --- Prosper, and be rewarded hereafter, though the just man even among the Jews might be here afflicted. Prosperity was only promised to the nation, as long as it continued faithful.

Individuals were in the same condition as Christians. They were to trust in the promises of futurity, though some have very erroneously asserted, that there is no mention of eternal felicity in thee holy canticles; (Berthier) Ferrand says, hardly in the Old Testament. C. --- All this verse might perhaps be better understood of the tree. "And its leaf...and whatever it shall produce,"

faciet (fructum). H. --- Some trees are always covered with leaves, like the palm-tree, &c. M.

Ver. 4. Not so. Heb. "but are like the chaff which the wind driveth away." H. ---

They are inconstant (S. Jer.) in the good resolutions which they sometimes form. H. Job xxi. 18. --- The good corn remains, but they are tossed about by every wind, and their memory perishes with all their children and effects. C. ---

They yield to the slightest temptation. W.

Ver. 5. Again. So as to gain their cause, (Amama) or to make opposition; as the Heb. yakumu,

"stand up," with defiance, intimates. H. --- They are already judged, (Jo. iii. 18.) and can make no defence; they being separated from the just, like goats, Kimchi (though he is defended by Amama. H.) and

some other Jews, falsely assert that the souls of the wicked will be annihilated, and that only the just Israelites will rise again. Buxtorf. Syn. 1. --- But this is very different from the belief of the ancient Jews, who clearly assert the truth respecting future rewards and punishments. 2 Mac. vii. 9. 14. 23. and 36. Wisd. v. 1. Josephus. or 4 Mac. x. See Job, &c. ---

The Fathers have adduced many such proofs from the other parts of Scripture, which they had read with as much attention as modern critics. C. --- Council, (M.) or rather "counsel," as the same word, Boule, is used by the Sept. as v. 1.

(C.) though the Heb. hadath, here be different, and mean a council, or assembly. M. --- Sept. and Vulg. may be understood in the same sense. H. ---

Sinners shall be destitute of all hope at the resurrection, and shall be driven from the society of the blessed. W. --- They will not even be able to complain, since they had been so often admonished of their impending fate, (Bert.) and would not judge themselves in time. S. Aug. 1

Cor. xi. Acts xxiv. 15. Prot. "They shall not stand," &c. H.

Ver. 6. Knoweth, with approbation. There is only one road which leads to heaven: but these men, having sown in the flesh, must reap corruption. Gal. vi.

8. Berthier. --- God will reward or punish (W.) all according to their deserts. H.

--- To some he will thunder out, I never knew you; while others shall hear, Come, &c. Mat. xxv. 34. &c. C. --- In this world, things seem to be in a sort of confusion, as the wicked prosper. But, at the hour of death, each will receive a final retribution. Temporal advantages have been dealt out to the wicked for the small and transitory acts of virtue, the afflictions of this world have served to purify the elect from venial faults. H.

PSALM 2

PSALM II. (QUARE FREMUERUNT.)

The vain efforts of persecutors against Christ and his Church.

This psalm has no title, and therefore, S. Jerom, after the Jews, consider it as a part of the former.

In Acts xiii. 33. some copies have, in the first, others in the second psalm; and Origen testifies that he saw a copy where this and the former psalm were joined together; and he says, the psalms were not distinguished by numbers or letters, as they have been since. We find in some Gr. and Lat. MSS. "a psalm of David." It is certain that he composed it, speaking of the Messias, (Acts iv.

25. Heb. i. 5.) though some passages may be applied to himself. The Rabbins would restrain it to him entirely; and some Christians have been so much off their guard, as to allow (C.) that it refers to David in the literal sense, and to Christ only in the spiritual; (Lyrar. Grot.) which would destroy the force of the prophecy. David takes occasion, (C.) from the opposition which was made by Saul, (H.) the Philistines, &c. (2 K. v. 7. Joseph. vii. 4.) to his own exaltation, to foretell the similar rage with which many would resist the Messias. C. --- The Philistines, however, had no kings to oppose David, as Kimchi confesses; and we had better refer the whole psalm to Christ. Berthier.

Ver. 1. Raged. Heb. "come together with tumult," (Sym.) "loud cries," like a furious army, composed of several nations. H. --- Why have the Philistines, &c.

assembled to obstruct my reign? or (C.) "why will the Gentiles be troubled, and the tribes meditate vain things?" S. Jer.

Pilate, Herod, and the chiefs of the Jews, met to destroy the Messias; though, on other occasions, they were at variance. H. --- Their attempts were fruitless.

Their false witnesses could not agree.

C. --- The priests had, in vain, meditated on the law, since they had not discovered Him who was the end of it. S. Athan. &c. --- People of Israel. Acts iv.

27. M.

Ver. 2. Kings. Herod and Pilate, (W.) who acted for the Roman emperor. ---

Princes, of the priests, (H.) Annas and Caiaphas. But all the rage of the Gentiles and Jews against Christ was fruitless, (W.) and wicked, (H.) as the attempt of the surrounding nations to dethrone David was, in contradiction to the divine appointment. He is sometimes styled the Christ, or "anointed of the Lord." Ps. xix. 7. But the Chal. has, "to revolt from the Lord, and fight with his Messiah." So that the ancient Jews agreed with us, (C.) and it would be "rash to abandon the interpretation given by S. Peter." S. Jerom.

Ver. 3. Us. Let us no longer be subject to the old law, which is abrogated, (S.

Aug.) or the enemies of David, and of Christ, encourage one another (C.) to subvert their authority, before it be too well established. Prot. still seem to be actuated with the same phrensy; fearing nothing more than the restoration of the Catholic religion; and incessantly pouring in petitions to Parliament to withhold the common rights of subjects from people of that persuasion. H. ---

"I fear there are more political than religious objectors to emancipation."

Nightingale.

Ver. 4. Them, who continue rebellious. Prov. i. He speaks thus to shew that we deserve derision.

H. --- Quod nos derisu digna faciamus. S. Jer. --- Yet he will convert many, (W.) even of those who, like S. Paul, were bent on persecuting the faithful. If they still resist, (H.) he will shew the futility of their plans, and triumph over all, as David did over his opponents, and Christ over those who wished to have obstructed his resurrection, and the propagation of his gospel. Thus Jesus has proved his divinity, and confirmed our hopes that he will still protect his Church; as he did when it seemed to be in the greatest danger. C. --- God can fear no opposition to his decrees.

M. --- He is in Heaven, to whom we ought to address our prayers. The Lord seems to be here applicable to Christ. Chal. "the word of God." He has the title of the Creator, Adonai, as the Jews have marked it with a Kamets 134 times, when it is to be taken in that sense. Berthier.

Ver. 5. Rage. These, and similar expressions, when applied to the immutable Deity, only denote that men have deserved the worst of punishments. H. ---

God had discomfited the enemies of David (2 K. v. 20. 24.) by his thunder. But he still more confounded the devil, when Christ descended to take away his spoils; and he chastised the Jews by the ruin of their city, (C.) as he has or will do all persecutors of his Church. H. --- He will severely reprehend, and justly punish the obstinate. W.

Ver. 6. I am. Heb. "I have anointed...over Sion, my," &c. S. Jerom and others have read in the first person, what the Sept. translate in the third. The sense is much the same. C. --- But the Vulg. seems to be better connected, and the same letters may have this sense, if we neglect the points, which were unknown to the Sept. and of modern invention. These interpreters may also have read a v for i, as these letters are very similar. Berthier. --- "But I am anointed king by him over Sion, his holy mountain." Houbig. --- Theodoret, observing that Christ is king not only over Sion, but also over all, alters the punctuation: On Sion...preaching, &c. which is very plausible, since Isaias (ix.

3.) says, the law shall come forth from Sion, (Berthier) and C. xxxvii. 32. and salvation from Mount Sion. Hence Christ preached frequently

in the temple. It is certain David was not anointed here, but at Hebron; and the temple was not built till the reign of Solomon. See Psalm cix. 2.

Ver. 7. Thee. Chal. weakens this text. H. --- "I love thee as my son, and look upon thee with the same affection, as if I had this day created thee;" which might be applied to David, now settled more firmly on the throne by his late victory. But it literally refers to Christ, either born in time, (v. 1. S. Aug. C.) or baptized; (S. Just.) or rather rising again, (Acts xiii. 33.) and born from all eternity. Heb. i. 5. This shews him superior to the angels. The prophet had both these events in view. Eternity is always the same. Berthier. Bossuet. D. --- He to whom God may speak thus to-day, at all times, must be God also.

Robertson, Lexic. Jo. v. 25. --- To this Socinians can make no reply, without giving up the Epistle to the Heb. or allowing that the apostle's arguments were inconclusive. Bert. --- The same text may thus have many literal senses. D. ---

The eternal birth seems here to be the chief, as from that source the nativity, baptism, priesthood, (Heb. xv. 5.) and miraculous resurrection of Christ, necessarily spring. H.

Ver. 8. Ask. The Messiah must be invested with human nature, and merit all graces for man.

When did David ask for such an extensive dominion? Berthier. --- But Christ's kingdom extends over the world. His Church cannot fail, as S. Aug. proved hence against the Donatists, and his arguments confute Protestants as well.

W. --- Our doctors used to refer this psalm to the Messiah, said R. Solomon; but it is better to apply it to David, on account of "Christians." D.

Ver. 9. Rule, as a shepherd, (poimaneis) as it is cited Apoc. ii. 26. But he is speaking of vengeance taken on the rebellious; and we might translate, "Thou shalt break," &c. C. --- Yet this is not necessary, as a

shepherd sometimes beats with severity, to prevent his sheep from straying.

H. --- The Church guides also use coercion, but for the good of the flock. C. ---

God brought the murderers of his Son to an evil end, and destroyed their city.

H. --- He broke the Gentiles, to make them a more noble vessel. Jer. xviii. 4. S.

Hilary. --- He will execute judgment at the last day. Apoc. xix. 11. C. --- When the clay is still soft the vessel may easily be repaired; so the sinner may be reclaimed, when he has only just fallen. S. Jer. --- Even the most obdurate, are as clay in God's hands. W.

Ver. 10. And. Here the prophet may address kings, unless the Father or the Messias continue to speak. It is evident these words are not to be understood of David's dominions alone. Fear and joy keep the Christian in proper order.

Phil. ii. 12. and iii. 1. Bert. --- "The love of God pushes us forward, and the fear of God makes us take care where we walk." S. Theresa. --- The one guards us against despair, the other against presumption. Kings are here instructed to support the Church, for which some have been styled, "Most Christian,"

"Catholic," or "Defenders of the Faith." The Donatists falsely asserted, that they were ever found enemies to religion, because of Constantine, &c.

attempted to repress their errors. But Julian favoured them, to increase dissensions. See S. Aug. c. Pet. et. c. Gaud. ii. 26. W.

Ver. 11. Trembling, with reverential awe and humility, (1 Cor. ii. 3. Amama) as none is sure of salvation. Bell. --- More are list by presumption than by trembling. Amama.

Ver. 12. Discipline. Chal. "doctrine." S. Jer. "adore purely." Prot. "kiss the Son, lest he be angry," &c. H. --- Houbig. "adore the son, lest he be angry, and you perish. For he comes forward, and shortly his wrath will be enkindled." This version seems to be judicious: that of the Vulg. is less energetic, but come to the same end, as those who adore the Messias, must follow his doctrine.

Berthier. --- Lord and just is not in Heb. H. --- The way or projects of sinners will perish; (Ps. i. 6.) they will be hurried before the tribunal, as soon as they are dead; (S. Hil.) and when they least expect it. 1 Thes. v. 2. C. --- Some fall from salvation, and God will bring them to judgment at the end of this short life. W. --- Heb. "Kiss purely." Kissing is often used in Scripture to express submission, love, and adoration. S. Jer. c. Ruf. i. Gen. xli. 40. C. --- We testify our respect for God, by kissing the Bible, &c. H. --- But it cannot be shewn that bar means "a son," in Heb. C. --- Amama blames the Vulg. for withdrawing a text in favour of Christ's divinity. We must, however, submit to the law and faith of Christ with confidence and live, if we desire to escape his indignation and enter heaven. Acts iv. 12. Mr. Nightingale (Portrait of Cath. 1812. p. 117 and 332) may represent this doctrine as uncharitable and groundless, though he allows it has been maintained by most (p. 473) who have professed to be the true disciples of Christ, whether Catholics or Protestants. The principle is good, though some apply it wrong. If he and Lord Milton, (speech. 1812. to whom we must express our manifest obligations) had contented themselves with saying that they believed our doctrine was

"unscriptural," &c. (p. 18) we should not have much wondered; as they could not consistently have said less, and remained out of the Catholic Church. But for any man who has read the Bible, to persuade himself that it is not necessary to profess the one only true religion, wherever it may be, after Christ has plainly declared, He that believeth not is already judged, and shall be condemned; (Jo. iii. 18. Mark xvi. 16.) and after the apostle has delivered over to satan those who only asserted that the resurrection was past, (2 Tim. ii.

17.) this fills us with astonishment.

Not a single text can be produced in favour of the contrary system leading to indifference about religion; which, if true, would shew the preaching of the prophets and apostles was nugatory, and their blood shed in vain. All the

"Scriptures" proclaim the necessity of faith and good works. We may observe, that the doctrine of the blessed Trinity seems to be no less objectionable to Mr.

N.

than the rest of our faith, p. 117, &c. Yet (H.) we must not refuse him the praise of liberality.

Catholic Review, &c. Jan. 1813. H.

Ver. 13. Trust for salvation through Christ, (D.) acting as he has directed, so that our hope may be well founded. M. --- This psalm is quoted six times in the New Testament, which shews the concord of Scripture, and that the prophets saw the promises at a distance, following the law of love, which is as ancient as the world. Berthier.

PSALM 3

PSALM III. (DOMINE QUID MULTIPLICATI.)

The prophet's danger and delivery from his son, Absalom: mystically the passion and resurrection of Christ.

Heb. and Sept. have lit. "a psalm of David," (to Daud) which may mean that it was addressed to him by God, or that he would set it to music himself, (H.) or that it was composed by him, or on his occasion. The part. l. has various meanings, and it does not incontestably prove that the person before whose name it is placed, must be regarded as the author. C. --- Yet there is no reason for doubting that this psalm was composed by David. H. --- The Jews say he wrote it on the ascent of Mount Olivet. 2 K. xv. 17. But he rather waited till he had re-entered his capital, and herein expressed his gratitude, specifying at the same

time the sentiments with which he had been impressed in the hour of danger. Ven. Bede explains this and many other psalms of Ezechias, as he perhaps did not read or attend to the title. C. --- This deserves more attention, as it is the same in all Bibles, though all interpreters do not consider them as canonical, no more than that which is prefixed to the Lamentations. Berthier.

--- They are authentic, being inspired to Esdras or the Sept. W. --- But this is doubtful. H.

Ver. 2. Why. Let me know the enormity of my sins. All Israel follows Absalom. 2

K. xv. 13. So all rose up against Christ. W. --- The Church was assailed on all sides, (C.) and every soul must live in expectation of battle from innumerable enemies. Heb. also, (H.) "How are they multiplied." Houbig. --- David is surprised at the sudden change, and adores the depth of God's judgments, which had been denounced unto him. 1 K. xii. 10. C.

Ver. 3. God. His case is desperate. W. --- He must therefore be a criminal. This is the usual judgment of the world, though very false, as we have seen in the person of Job; for temporal punishments are frequently an effect of the divine clemency. Semei upbraided David on this occasion, as the Jews did Christ. 2

K. xvi. 7. Mat. xxvii. 42. At the end of this verse, Heb. adds, Selah, (C.) sle and Sept. diapsalma, (H.) a word which is not much better understood. Houbigant therefore informs us that he has omitted it entirely, as the Vulg. seems to have done, except Ps.

lxi. 8. where it is rendered, in æternum, "for ever," (Bert.) as S. Jerom expresses it semper, in his Heb. version. It would perhaps be as well to leave the original term. H. --- It occurs seventy-one times in the psalms, and thrice in Habacuc. Some think it is a sign to raise the voice, or to pause,

&c. (Bert.) at the end of the lesson, before the psalter was divided. None, except Eusebius, asserts that it was inserted by the original authors, and it seems now to be useless. C. Dis.

Ver. 4. Protector. Heb. "shield." --- Glory. God is the hope of his servants, (1

Cor. xv. 31.) and grants their requests. C. --- He has not abandoned me, when I had fallen into sin. H. --- He gives me the victory, and confirms my throne. W.

Ver. 5. Hill. Sion, where the ark had been placed, (C.) or from heaven. M. ---

Heb. adds,

"Selah." Prot. H.

Ver. 6. Rest, in sin; (S. Athan.) or, I have not lost my confidence in God, though dangers threaten on every side. C. --- Jesus remained undaunted, when his enemies surrounded him; he continued (Theod. &c.) free among the dead, and rose again by his own power. H. --- If he prayed that the chalice might be removed, it was to teach us how to behave. C. --- He was buried, and rose again, and his disciples believed the Scriptures (Jo. ii. 22.) recorded here, and in other places. W.

--- The same word refers to past and future things. S. Greg. Mor. xx. 1. W.

Ver. 7. Thousands. Sept. "myriads." H. --- If my enemies were still more numerous, I should not fear. C. --- I beseech thee to help me. W.

Ver. 8. Without cause. Heb. "on the jaw." H. --- Without redress. C. --- Sept.

seems to have read léinom, as "some Jews say that the ancient copies were different." Origen, A.D. 231. Kennicott.

--- Teeth. Strength and fury.

Ver. 9. Blessing. Abundance of grace is promised to God's servants, who must look up to him for salvation. David gives thanks for the victory, though he grieved at his son's death. W. --- He shewed proofs of the greatest clemency on this occasion. It is evident, from this psalm being inserted before many which regard Saul, that no chronological order is observed. C. --- Selah occurs a third time here, as some may have ended the lecture at one, while others ordered it to be continued to another, or even to the 3d and 5th verse of the next psalm, if that be its real import.

H.

PSALM 4

PSALM IV. (CUM INVOCAREM.)

The prophet teacheth us to flee to God in tribulation, with confidence in him.

Ver. 1. Unto the end. Or as S. Jerom renders it, victory to him that overcometh; which some understand of the chief musician; to whom they suppose the psalms, which bear that title, were given to be sung. We rather understand the psalms thus inscribed to refer to Christ, who is the end of the law, and the great Conqueror of death and hell; and to the New Testament. --- In verses, in carminibus. In the Heb. it is neginoth, supposed by some to be a musical instrument, with which this psalm was to be sung. --- For David, or to David, to Daudid, that is, inspired to David himself, or to be sung by him. Ch. ---

Lamnetseach, from nitseach, "to push to an end,"

may signify (H.) to the end; and this sense is more noble than (Berthier) "To the precentor, or president." C. --- Binginoth. H. --- "Over the female musicians." C. --- "To the chief of the singers on stringed instruments."

Duguet. --- The psalms which have this title, related to future times, and to the Church of Christ; (S. Aug. W.) or were to be sung at the

close of the Jewish festivals, &c. Bert. --- This is considered as a sequel to the preceding, to thank God for the late victory over Absalom. C.

Ver. 2. The God. Heb. "When I call, hear me, O God of my justice:" source and witness of my virtue. If I have offended thee, I have done no wrong to my rebellious son and his adherents.

Many copies read Cum invocarem te, exaudisti me. C. --- Thou. The change of persons intimates that when God is present (S. Aug.) the soul is animated with confidence to speak to him. H. ---

Prayer. Though his request had been granted, he still continues to address God, as we ought to pray without ceasing. 1 Thes. v. 17.

Ver. 3. O. This is a sort of manifesto to the rebels; and an invitation for them to return to their duty, desisting from setting up a false king, or a lie. H. --- Dull.

Heb. "my glory to shame." But the reading of the Sept. seems to be preferable, (C.) as the rhyme in Heb. is now lost, (Fourmont) and the text has been altered (Houbig.) by an injudicious junction of words, and by using c for b.

In ancient MSS. the words were all joined together, (Bert.) as may be seen in the specimen of the Alex. Sept. given by Grabe. Prot. "How long will ye turn my glory into shame?" &c. H.

Ver. 4. Wonderful, (mirificavit) according to the Heb. means also has chosen in a striking manner his appointed ruler, or holy person. Bert. -- - Holy, often means one set aside, (Lu. ii.) or commissioned, though the person be a pagan.

Isai. xiii. 3. Chasid, (H.) particularly signifies a

"clement" character, such as a king ought to be. C. --- "The Lord has set aside for himself the pious." Pagn. --- I am ready to pardon you, but know that if you continue rebellious, you go against the ordinance of heaven. H.

Ver. 5. Angry. My soldiers, do not resent this offence too much, kill not the boy; (2 K. xviii. 5.) or (H.) you, my deluded subjects, enter into yourselves. S. Paul (Eph. iv. 26.) cites this as a moral sentence. C. --- It is more difficult to moderate anger than to deny access to it entirely. S. Fran.

de Sales. H. --- Beds. Repent for the most secret evil thoughts, before you fall asleep. W.

Ver. 6. Justice. External devotion will not suffice. S. Chrys. --- No sacrifice will please God as long as people take part with rebels. C. --- Besides external sacrifices, which have always been required, and those of praise and contrition, (Ps. xlix. and l.) we must offer to God the sacrifice of justice, by complying with our duties to him, ourselves, and neighbours, and by hating sin, and also the world, the flesh, and the devil, which prompt us to offend, and thus to give the preference to vanity. For this purpose, we must not trust in ourselves, but in God; and that no one may plead ignorance, the light of reason and grace is given us, plainly indicating that we have a God to serve, and must expect reward or punishment. Heb. xi. 6. W.

Ver. 7. The. Houbigant transposes this to v. 9, which is not necessary. David answers those diffident people, (Bert.) who thought they had received no marks of God's favour, and were in great want of provisions, till some were brought by Berzellai. H.

Ver. 8. By. Heb. and S. Aug. "From the time of their corn and wine" (C.) gathering. I rejoiced

"more" than those who live in the greatest affluence, which is nothing but vanity. No mention is made of oil, but the original term, "liquor," includes it.

Bert. --- S. Jerom found it not in the Hexapla. But it now occurs in the Arab.

Syr. &c. C. --- David envies not the present prosperity of the rebels. H. - -- He comforts his followers with the assurance of God's favour, which

he had again testified by sending provisions. Bullenger. --- He may also here express the disappointment of the rebels, who promised themselves great riches, of which Providence would soon deprive them, by restoring the king, whom he had chosen, and hitherto so wonderfully protected. H. ---

God gave temporal advantages to the just in the old law, as the figure of heavenly rewards. W.

Ver. 9. Same, (in idipsum) which signifies with one accord. Acts i. 14. Heb.

"altogether," when we shall be united as one people, which I expect will shortly be the case. Confiding in God, I will repose as in the arms of peace. Absalom was already cut off. But all his adherents were not reclaimed. Yet their number was so small, as to cause no apprehensions. H. --- Under thy protection, I am secure, (C.) no longer kept between fear and hope. S. Bern. --- When I lie down, I can enjoy rest, (Bert.) being free from turbulent passions. H.

Ver. 10. Singularly. Art "alone" (Pagn.) the source of all my happiness; (H.) or thou hast taken such care of me, as if thou hadst no other. M. --- I am at a distance from the contagion of evil company, (S. Chrys.) which I hate. Bert. ---

"For thou only art Lord, thou hast made me dwell secure." S. Jer.

PSALM 5

PSALM V. (VERBA MEA AURIBUS.)

A prayer to God against the iniquities of men.

Ver. 1. For her that obtaineth the inheritance. That is, for the Church of Christ, (Ch.) and every faithful soul, which gains the victory and heaven. W. ---

Nechiloth, may also, (H.) signify musical instruments with holes, or "women dancing," on religious and joyful occasions, as they did when the ark was removed, &c. 2 K. vi. 12. C. Ps. lxxvii. 26. --- We may (H.) as well follow the Vulg.

and S. Jerom. Some have supposed that David alludes to Saul, Absalom, &c.

But in most of the psalms, the wicked in general are reprobated, and the sentiments of the faithful expressed. This psalm contains an excellent form of morning prayer, as an armour against all our spiritual enemies. Berthier.

Ver. 2. Cry. Heb. "meditation." M. --- The cry of the heart, (S. Chrys.) and "the groans," which the spirit forms within us. Rom. viii. 26. God cannot reject such prayers. If he seems inattentive, it is because we ask amiss. Jam. iv. 3. C. --- He attends to the prayers of the Church, and of every faithful soul, (W.) and even exhorts sinners to come to him, that they may emerge from the abyss. H.

Ver. 4. Morning. This hour of prayer is also specified, (Ps. lxxii. 1. and cxviii.

147.) as that of the evening is. Ps. iv. 9, and liv. 19. We read also of noon being a time for prayer among the Jews.

Acts x. 9. Daniel (vi. 10.) diligently observed these holy customs. C.

Ver. 5. Stand. Heb. implies "in order," as those who neglect prayer must be all in confusion.

God enables those who are diligent, to see wonderful things. Bert. --- Iniquity.

No: he has it in abhorrence; (C.) consequently he cannot be the author of it, but hates those who commit evil, though he loves them as his creatures, and wishes their conversion. W. --- On this subject I will meditate. M.

Ver. 6. Eyes. God suffers them to remain for a time. S. Jer.

Ver. 7. Workers, (operantur) "who work," (H.) and die impenitent. --- Lie. All heretics, who kill their own and neighbours' souls, (S. Jer.) and in general all seducers, (C.) who will be treated like those who have committed murder.

Euseb. Cæsar.

Ver. 8. Mercy, not trusting in my own merit, (H.) but with the greatest awe. C. ---

The just trust in mercy, not in man's power. --- Temple, the Church, and in God's presence. W. --- Some would infer hence that David was not the author of this psalm. But the tabernacle is called by the same name; (1 K. i. 7, 24, and iii. 3.) so that this reason is not sufficient. C.

Ver. 9. Enemies. Heb. "observers." They are always on the watch to discover any fault. Grant me thy preventing grace. Bert. --- Let me not stumble, (H.) but cause me to walk cheerfully in thy paths. C. --- If thou approve, it matters not how much worldlings blame me. S. Aug.

Ver. 10. Their. Heb. "his." But it is incorrect. Houb. --- S. Jer. has "their."

Ver. 11. Sepulchre, which never says there is enough. Prov. xxx. 15. C. -- - Dealt,

&c. S. Paul authorizes this version, (Rom. iii. 13.) though the Heb. be rendered,

"they flatter cunning;" (Bert.) or "they sharpen their tongue," and polish it like a sword, that it may cut more easily. This may be applied to heretics. SS.

Athan. Chrys. Jer. C. --- Judge, or "condemn them." Heb. may be explained as a prediction. Bert. --- The Holy Ghost could not dictate an imprecation or desire revenge. But David might beg that God would

frustrate the designs of his enemies; and, by treating them with some severity, hinder the execution of their wicked schemes, which would bring on their own ruin. S. Chrys. S. Aug.

C. --- Though the just desire the conversion of all, yet if any die impenitent, they approve of God's judgment, manifested at the end of the world. W. ---

Provoked. Heb. "rebelled against." I forgive them for what they have done to me. But I grieve at thy offence; make them return to a sense of their duty. C. ---

He might abhor the enemies of salvation, the world, &c. whom Christ has condemned. Bert.

Ver. 12. Dwell. Heb. "protect," (S. Jer.) "or shade them." C. --- The just will rejoice under thy protection, (H.) and at the conversion of the sinner. S. Chrys.

Ver. 13. Us. Heb. "him." S. Jer. Aquila. C. --- But neglecting the points, the Sept.

is as accurate, and more beautiful. Bert. --- Shield. Heb. tsinna, (H.) which was probably large enough to cover the body. C. --- If God be with us, who is against us? H. --- The just shall receive the sentence of eternal glory. W.

PSALM 6

PSALM VI. (DOMINE NE IN FURORE.)

A prayer of a penitent sinner, under the scourge of God. The first penitential Psalm.

Ver. 1. For the octave. That is, to be sung on an instrument of eight strings. S.

Augustin understands it mystically, of the last resurrection, and the world to come; which is, as it were, the octave, or eighth day, after the

seven days of this mortal life; and for this octave, sinners must dispose themselves, like David, by bewailing their sins, whilst they are here upon the earth. Ch.

W. --- It may also signify, that this psalm was to be sung by "the eighth" of the 24 bands. 1 Par.

xv. 21. David might compose it after sickness, with which he had been punished for his adultery; (C.) or under any distress: he expresses the sentiments of a true penitent, (Bert.) with which he was ever after impressed.

H. --- It is applicable to penitents of the new law. W.

Ver. 2. Indignation. Lit. "fury." H. --- Such strong expressions were requisite to make the carnal Jews fear God's judgments, though a being of infinite perfection can have no passion. S. Chrys.

--- David does not beg to be free from suffering, (H.) but he requests that God would chastise him with moderation. Jer. x. 24. and xlvi. 28. C. --- Justice without mercy is reserved for the last day.

S. Greg. --- Wrath. This regards those who have built wood, &c. on the foundation. They shall be purified by fire. S. Aug. Purgatory was then believed in the 4th Cent. Bert. --- Let me not be condemned either to it, or hell. S. Greg.

hic. and Ps. xxxvii.

Ver. 3. Troubled, with grief. W. --- I am sinking under my illness: my virtue is lost. C. --- The whole human race is this sick man, requiring the aid of Jesus Christ. S. Aug. --- The ineffable name Jehova, (H.) is repeated thrice, to insinuate that salvation must come from the Blessed Trinity. Bert. v. 9. ---

Under the allegory of sickness, the ravages of sin appear. M.

Ver. 4. Long? Wilt thou leave me in distress? W. --- He breaks off abruptly to express his sorrow. See Isai. vi. 11; Jer. xiii. 26. Bert. --- True converts are often tried a long time, that they may conceive how God will treat those who never return him, (S. Aug. Euseb.) and that they may beware of a relapse. C.

Ver. 5. Turn. God never abandons us first. Jer. ii. 27. Bert. --- We drive him away by sin. S.

Athan. --- Sake. I cannot take one step without thee. C. --- Treat me not as my sins deserve; but mercifully restore me to favour. W.

Ver. 6. Hell. The hardened sinner will not praise thee, (S. Aug.) much less will the damned, who are confirmed in evil. Bert. --- Even those who are in "the grave," though just, cannot sound forth thy praises; and consequently, if I be cut off, the number of they adorers will be diminished. This motive is often urged, as if God was forgotten in the rest of the world. Ps. xxix. 10. Isai. xxxviii.

18. C. --- This life is the time for repentance. After death there is no conversion, but eternal blasphemies in hell. I will strive to prevent this misery, by continuing to do penance, till I am watered with thy grace. W.

Ver. 7. Bed. S. Jerom, "I will make my bed swim" (H.) with tears, or sweat. Bert.

--- Here we behold the effects of true repentance, which will not suffer the sinner to enjoy any repose, (C.) when he reflects on the pains of hell, and the perfections of God. H. --- "O sweet affliction, which extinguishes the fire of hell, and restores man to the friendship of his God." S. Chrys.

Ver. 8. Indignation of God (Theod.) or of my enemies. I am also indignant when I behold my foes exulting in my ruin. C. --- I have. Heb. "It," the eye. Bert. ---

The eye is naturally injured by excessive grief. Yet David could not think of his sins, without floods of tears. H.

Ver. 9. Iniquity, who have fostered my passions, (Bert.) or sought my ruin. I now perceive who were my true friends. C. --- Lord. He is twice mentioned in the next verse, in honour of the blessed Trinity, as a German commentator remarks, after the ancient interpreters (Bert.) and Fathers. They have constantly had an eye to these grand truths, which are nevertheless proved by clearer passages of Scripture. H. --- David confides in God, as every true penitent may do, for protection. W. --- He had also been assured of pardon by Nathan, the prophet. H.

Ver. 11. Troubled. This is a prophecy, (S. Aug.) or a prayer for their speedy and earnest conversion, (S. Jer. C.) or a threat if they persist. W. --- Speedily. At the last day, the wicked will perceive how short life has been. Tunc sentient peccatores quam non sit longa omnis vita quæ transit. S. Aug.

PSALM 7

PSALM VII. (DOMINE DEUS MEUS.)

David, trusting in the justice of his cause, prayeth for God's help against his enemies.

Shiggaion (H.) is a word which has greatly puzzled interpreters. See Robertson in shage. Prot.

have, "Shiggaion of David." The Rabbins confess that they know not its meaning, and it is of no service for the explanation of the psalm. Bert. --
- S.

Jerom follows the Sept. (H.) which may suit very well. Others have,

"ignorance." M. --- "Perplexity." C. --- "Secret." Vatab. --- "Song of wanderings."

Parkhurst, &c. --- Chusi is scarcely less difficult to understand. The person who has inserted this historical title, and many others, without much judgment, had probably in view the wars of Absalom, and the curses of Semei.

But the psalm seems rather to refer to the persecutions of Saul, (C. 1 K. xxii. 8.

M.) who was of the tribe of Benjamin. H. --- SS. Aug.

Bas. and Chrys. explain it of Chusi, (W.) the Arachite, from a town of Benjamin, (C.) who defeated the counsel of Achitophel, (W.) as it is supposed that David was given to understand that his friend had betrayed him, and in consequence speaks of him in such harsh terms. But if that had been the case, he would have suppressed what was founded on error; (C.) and the supposition is contrary to the idea which we have of inspiration. Yet there is nothing in the psalm which requires the harsh expressions to be applied to Chusi. They may as well refer to Achitophel, who spoke in answer to him.

Ver. 2. My God. This title is prompted by love and confidence. H. --- All. David had only few followers, while he was pursued by Saul (C.) and Absalom. H.

Ver. 3. Lion. In a spiritual sense this is the devil. 1 Pet. v. 8. S. Aug. --- "Let him only see the sign of the cross, or the lamp continually burning before the altar, he will flee away. Should we wonder at this? the garments alone of Paul drove him from possessed person." S. Chrys. --- Will modern sectaries still ridicule these things? --- While. Heb. "tearing, and not snatching away."

But there is a similar construction, (Lam. v. 8.) which shews that we ought to follow the Vulg.

Bert. --- Absalom, or any other enemy, may be this lion. W. --- They threatened David with utter ruin, which he could never have escaped, without God's visible protection.

Ver. 4. Thing, alluding to some calumny, (H.) with which he was assailed (W.) by Saul, Absalom, and Semei. Bert. --- He disclaims all such ambitious or unjust sentiments, though he allows that he is not innocent before God. C.

Ver. 5. That repaid. This seems better than "my peaceable one," as some translate the Heb. for it would be but a small commendation not to injure a friend: the pagans do as much. Duport therefore agrees with the Vulg., and S.

Jerom has, "If I have rendered evil to those who did me any, and sent my enemies empty away;" or, as the Heb. is in the future, "I will let my enemies depart without fighting;" which is equivalent to, I will gain no advantage over them. Bert. --- The man who takes revenge, injures himself, and becomes the devil's slave. S. Aug. --- David had been so far from giving way to ingratitude, that he would not even hurt his enemy. H. --- He let Saul escape, when he might easily have slain him. C.

Ver. 6. Dust. Heb. adds, "to dwell," (H.) as if the ignominy was not to be effaced. This would be very sensible for a king. Bert. --- Glory is here synonymous with life, or soul. Gen. xlix. 6. Let my life and (C.) reputation be lost. W. --- Summum crede nefas animam præferre pudori. Juv.

viii.

Ver. 7. Borders. Heb. is rendered, "fury of my enemies." --- My is found in some copies of the Sept. though the edit. of Comp. and Aldus agree with the Vulg., and Bos observes, that an ancient interpreter rendered the first word as we do.

Berg. --- Habar means, "to pass;" and, of course, behabroth (H.) may denote, in the borders; (Berg.) though S. Jer. &c. have, "rise up indignant over mine enemies." Avenge thy own cause, as they would overturn thy decree, which has called me to the throne. H. --- Commanded. Shew thy power, and protect me, since thou hast ordered me to reign. W. --- Convince my enemies of the injustice of their

proceedings, (H.) and cause them to repent. Thy order is what displeased Saul. Protect me as thou hast promised. Chal.

"Execute the judgment in my favour, which thou hast decreed." Then all will obey. C. --- O

Lord, my God. Heb. has not Lord, and some translate elai, "to me." But it also means, "my God."

Bert.

Ver. 8. High, on thy tribunal, to decide this dispute. The Fathers apply this to the ascension of Jesus Christ, who will judge the world. S. Aug. Theod. C. 2

Cor. x. 11. --- The interference of Providence (H.) will induce many to come to thy tabernacle, (M.) to embrace the true religion, (W.) and sectaries will decrease. These will be refuted most effectually, when they see the law well observed. Berthier.

Ver. 9. Innocence. Heb. "simplicity," which has the same meaning. H. He speaks of the justice of his cause (Muis) against his particular enemies. W. ---

S. Paul thus commends himself. 2 Tim.

iv. 7. The justice of the saints is not merely imputed, as the first Protestants foolishly imagined: for how should God reward those whom he saw still in sin, and who were only reputed holy? a notion which their disciples have modified or abandoned, as they have also done what had been taught respecting grace.

Justice is an effect of God's grace, and of man's co-operation. 1 Cor. xv.

10. Bert. --- David begs that the disposer of kingdoms would convince Saul that he was not a rebel: and the world, that he had not lost God's favour, like his rival. H.

Ver. 10. Reins; affections, (Jer. xii. 2. C.) and inmost recesses, which are open to God. M.

Ver. 11. Just. This epithet refers to God, in Heb. Sept. might easily explain it of help, before the words and verse were divided: (H.) yet it is still taken in the former sense, in some Gr. and Lat.

copies. The wicked shall be frustrated in their designs, though they may succeed for a time, (C.) consumetur, (Sym. H.) or rather let their ruin be determined on. 1 K. xxv. 17. C.

Ver. 12. Strong. Heb. el, means also " God threatening every day;" (H.) which must be a proof of his patience, as the Sept. have intimated, since he could destroy at once. Thus numquid, must be rendered "is he not?" Isai. xxvii. 7.

Bert. --- God cannot but be displeased at every sin. He threatens the offender daily by secret remorse, or by his preachers and good books. H. --- But he often defers punishment (W.) till death, when the measure of crimes is full. S.

Aug. --- This silence or delay is one of the most terrible of his judgments, (H.) and a mark of his great indignation. If he were, however, to strike every one as soon as he had committed sin, where should we be? "He would soon be alone," as a pagan observed of "Jupiter, if he were presently to hurl his thunderbolts against every offender." C. See Val. Max. i. 2. Eccli. v. 4.

Ver. 13. Except you. Heb. "if he be not." Houb. would read, "God will not be turned aside."

Bert. --- "For him who does not change, he will sharpen his sword." S. Jer. H.

--- God threatens before he strikes, (C.) expecting amendment. W.

Ver. 14. For them that burn. That is, against the persecutors of his saints. G. ---

Heb. also, "he has made his arrows to turn." Houbigant after Sym. H. -
-- The ancients used fiery darts or arrows. Ps. cix. Eph. vi. 16.

Sed magnum stridens contorta phalarica venit,

Fulminis acta modo. Æn. ix. Herod. viii.

--- The death of Saul seems to be foretold. C.

Ver. 15. Iniquity. Heb. "a lie." All the labour of the wicked ends in smoke. See Mic. ii. 1. Is.

lix. 4. H. --- The psalmist sometimes speaks of many enemies, and sometimes of one, who was the chief. Yet what he says of him must, according to the genius of the Heb. language, be applied to the rest. Bert. --- Saul, (C.) Absalom, and Achitophel, each found their ruin, in their unjust attempts. H. --- They had injustice in view, and were actuated by envy, which destroyed them.

W.

Ver. 17. Sorrow. The evil which he designed for me (M.) will fall on him, like an arrow shot upwards. C. --- Crown. Prot. "pate." H.

Ver. 18. Justice. "Truly thou art just, O Lord," cries out S. Aug. "since thou protectest the just, so as to enlighten them by thyself; and so disposest of sinners, that they are punished, not by thine, but by their own malice."

PSALM 8

PSALM VIII. (DOMINE DOMINUS NOSTER.)

God is wonderful in his works; especially in mankind, singularly exalted by the incarnation of Christ.

Ver. 1. The presses. In Heb. Gittith, supposed to be a musical instrument: (Ch).

or, "the musicians from Geth," who were famous, and might follow David. 2 K.

i. 20. and xv. 18. The Sept. must have read a v for i. (C.) Gothuth. Yet S. Jer. and Pagnin agree with them; (H.) and that sense seems as plausible as any other.

The psalm relates to Christ alone; (Matt. xxi. 16. 1

Cor. xv. 26. and Heb. ii. 6.) who is represented treading the wine-press. Is. lxiii.

3. Apoc. xix. 13.

Bert. --- The Jews confess that it speaks of the Messias. Ferrand. --- We may explain it also for the natural prerogatives of man, (C.) though (H.) this weakens the force of the prophecy. Bert. ---

S. Aug. applies the expressions to the good and bad in the Church. W. --
- It might be sung during the feast of tabernacles, after the vintage. M.

Ver. 2. O Lord, (Jehova) our Lord, (Adonenu) S. Jer. Dominator noster, "our Ruler." H. --- God is Lord of all by creation, and still more of those who believe.

W. --- Adonai is pronounced by the Jews, and sometimes applied to men. But they have lost the pronounciation of the first term, which some read Jehovah, (C.) or Jaho, (S. Jer.) Jave, &c. H. --- Admirable. It expresses all that He is. (Ex.

iii. 14. Bert.) Essence itself. H. --- Earth. This was verified after the incarnation; (S. Chrys.) for before, the Gentiles knew it not, and the Jews caused it to be blasphemed. Bert. ---

Now all confess the glory of Jesus Christ, the master-piece of God. C. --
-

Heavens; which are nothing in comparison, (M.) for he hath created them. W.

Hab. iii. 3.

Ver. 3. Praise. But why does the prophet take notice of this proof of Christ's being the Messias, while he passes over his curing the sick? &c. S.

Chrysostom answers, because the other miracles had been performed in the old law, but God had never before opened the mouths of infants to proclaim

"praise the Lord," as they did when they bore witness to Christ entering the temple.

Other commentators greatly weaken this proof. Bert. --- We read that after the passage of the Red Sea, wisdom opened the mouth of the dumb, and made the tongues of infants eloquent; (Wisd. x.

21.) which may be a figurative expression. The prophets and apostles, whom the world looked upon as fools, were chosen to declare the highest mysteries.

All nature so clearly proves the existence of Providence, that, if other things were silent, infants would open their mouths to confound the incredulous. The condition of man from his infancy is, in effect, one of the plainest proofs of the divine wisdom. His imitative powers, the ease with which he takes his mother's milk, &c. are something surprising. Hippocrates even, concludes hence, that the child must have sucked, even in the womb, as the art is soon lost, and not easily recovered. God seems to be particularly pleased with the praises of children. Mic. ii. 9. Joel ii. 16. S. Aug. admires how the Scriptures have been proportioned to the capacity of infants. Heb. "Thou hast founded strength."

Aquila. C. --- But S. Jerom retains praise, as our Saviour himself quotes it.

Matt. xxi. 16. H. ---

Avenger. The old Vulg. read defensorem (H.) in the same sense. S. Chrys.

explains it of the Jews; and other Fathers understand heretics and the devil. S.

Aug. &c. C. --- Arnobius (con. Gent. i.) seems to think that all have an innate idea of Providence, ingenitum. The poor and simple confessed Christ, whom the proud doctors of the law, and Pharisees, rejected, despising his followers as children or fools. H.

Ver. 4. Fingers, as if they had been formed in play, while the Incarnation is the work of God's right hand. Euseb. C. --- Heavens, moon, and stars, denote the Church. No mention is made of the sun, because it is the emblem of Christ, who was the Creator. Bert. Apoc. xii. 1. --- This text proves that the world was not formed by angels, as some ancient heretics asserted. David, perhaps, wrote this at night; and the sun and stars are not seen together. M.

Ver. 5. Him. The prophet considers the nature of man at such a distance from the divinity.

Being, nevertheless, united with it in Jesus Christ, it is raised far above the angels. Heb. ii. 6.

Bert. --- When we reflect on the meanness of our nature, on the one hand, and on what God has done for it on the other, we are lost in astonishment. The pagans were aware of the corporal infirmities of man, (Seneca Consol. xi.) but not of his spiritual disorders. Heb. has here, the son of Adam, or one of the lowest class; and not of ish, which means a person of nobility, vir. Ps. iv.

4. C. --- Yet Christ applies to himself the former appellation, to shew us a pattern of humility. H.

--- S. Aug. inquires, what difference there is between man or the son. The Heb.

v means, likewise, and; yet or would have been better. Ex. xxi. 16. ---
"Whether he have sold him, or he be in his hand." Amama.

Ver. 6. Angels. Elohim means also "God," as S. Jerom, &c. explain it. Thou hast placed man like a deity upon earth. But S. Paul adopts the sense of the Sept.

C. --- S. Jerom doubted whether the epistle to the Hebrews belonged to him or he would have done the same. Some of the Fathers suppose, (Bert.) that the prophet speaks of man before the fall. Theodoret. --- Yet he has Christ principally in view. C. --- A little less may be better rendered, "'for a little while:" brachu ti.

Acts v. 34. Is. x. 25. modico. Heb. ii. Notwithstanding the prerogatives of Adam, before the fall, what is said by the prophet and S. Paul can be true of none but Christ; who was subject to death only for a short space, and quickly rose from the tomb, Lord of all. 1 Cor. xv. 26. If we do not see it yet, (Heb. ii. 8. Ps. lxix. 2.) our faith must not waver. He is crowned, and will one day assert his dominion.

Bert. Matt. xxviii. 18. Eph. i. 19. C. --- In his assumed nature, Christ became less than the angels; but he has raised it above them, and is appointed Lord of angels, men, and creatures of every description. The sea and the winds obey him. Matt. viii. W.

Ver. 8. All sheep. S. Paul did not judge it necessary to specify these things, as they are included in the word all. Bert. These tame cattle designate the believing Jews; beasts, the Gentile converts; birds, the proud; fishes, the voluptuous. S. Athan. --- The birds may also be put for men of genius, who dive into the secrets of theology; and fishes, for anxious worldlings. Hesyc. ---

SS. Aug. and Jerom understand that people who labour not for their salvation, or who are attached to the earth, men who rise up against God, or never elevate their thoughts to heaven, are emblematically specified by these creatures.

Ver. 9. Sea. All things are subjected to man's dominion. Gen. i. 26. and ix. 2. C.

--- "The Stoics are in the right, who say that the world was made for us. For all its parts and productions are contrived for man's benefit." Lact. ira. xiii.

Ver. 10. Earth. This repetition of the first verse insinuates, that as God was admirable in giving man the power to avoid sin and death; so he is wonderful in raising him again, in such a state the he can sin no more. W.

PSALM 9

PSALM IX. (CONFITEBOR TIBI DOMINE.)

The church praiseth God for his protection against her enemies.

Ver. 1. The hidden things of the son. The humility and sufferings of Christ, the Son of God; and of good Christians, who are his sons by adoption; and called hidden things, with regard to the children of this world, who know not the value and merit of them. Ch. --- It may also signify, "to Ben, the master of music, over the young women." See 1 Par. xv. 18. C. M. --- These authors have joined almuth, which S. Jerom, &c. read as tow words, " on the death of the son." Prot.

"upon Muth Labben." David might allude to the death of Absalom, or of some of his other children. But he has his Son, Christ, the conqueror of death and hell, principally in view, as this psalm sings of victory over nations. His incarnation and the afflictions of Christians are hidden in God. W. ---

Lamnatseach has generally a preposition, l, al, &c. after it, which might induce us to prefer rendering "death," before "secrets or young women." H. --- But al may be understood, as it is found Ps. xlv., where all have, "for the secrets." In Heb. this psalm is divided (Bert.) at v. 22nd, and formerly it seems at the 17th.

C. --- This division is arbitrary, and of no consequence for the understanding of the psalms. Bert. --- It would be well if there were no more serious controversy between Catholics and Protestants. The Jews agree with neither.

Some unite the 1st and 2nd, as Kimchi does the 114th and 115th. Amama. ---

What is here rendered a psalm for David, is the same in the Heb. and Sept. as has been before expressed of David. Ps. iii. H.

Ver. 2. Praise and thanks, or I will confess. W. --- To thee. Heb. "to the." David had received many favours from God, and he has testified his gratitude, and shewn how we ought to praise God, (S. Jer. C.) with soul and body. Bert. W. ---

Wonders; victories gained over the neighbouring nations, so that Israel was at peace and liberty to transport the ark to Sion. 1 Par.

xv.

Ver. 4. Back; routed. After Saul's family was taken off, none durst oppose David. They saw that the Lord had set him on the throne. C. --- Only after his sin, rebels began to molest him. H. ---

The Fathers explain this of the devil and his agents. S. Jer. --- God repelleth the enemy, when man is not able to resist. W.

Ver. 5. Justice, or rightly. C. --- God alone always discerns what is just. S.

Chrys. --- Man overcomes the devil, with the assistance of God's grace. W.

Ver. 6. Name, or destroy them. The name is often put for the thing itself. Yet many of those nations who once made such a noise, are now quite forgotten.

No traces of them can be found.

H. --- The Egyptians and Chanaanites had been exterminated. C. --- Ever, for all eternity, as long as God shall reign, v. 8. 40. or Ps. x. 16. This shews that he speaks of the latter times, and of the final destruction of idolatry, by the preaching of apostolic men, (Bert.) and by the last fire. For some will be so infatuated as to uphold it even to the end. H. --- We have even reason to fear that it will again become more general, (P. Apoc.) as faith shall decrease. Jesus Christ and his apostles gave it however (H.) a mortal wound, so that in the fifth age many of its mysteries were quite forgotten. Theod. SS. Aug. and Jer. C. ---

They took the towns, or the souls, of many from the strong-armed. Luk. xi. 21.

Bert. --- All sinners may be here styled Gentiles, because they were generally wicked. If their reputation survive here for a while, it will certainly perish in the future world. W.

Ver. 7. Swords. "My enemies have sunk under the sword." Syr. H. --- Frameæ is a German word for "javelins," pointed with iron, which they might either throw, or use in close fight. Tacit.

--- It is often put for a sword. Et martii frameam. Juv. xiii. --- The weapons of the enemy being exhausted, they are forced to yield. --- Their. Heb. &c. "the." ---

Noise, as swiftly. These fierce nations are fallen like a huge Colossus. C. ---

Heb. "they themselves," or "with them." --- Cities, &c.

Ver. 8. In judgment. S. Jer. "to judge." H.

Ver. 9. World. This globe must give place to new heavens and earth, (Bert.) after its inhabitants have been judged. H. --- Justice. Men may be corrupt judges, but God cannot. W.

Ver. 10. Poor. Heb. ladac, "the oppressed," (S. Jer.) "broken with grief." C. ---

Tribulation.

God's assistance is requisite both in prosperity and adversity. He generally manifests his power only, when all human succour proves useless. H. --- Thus he acted at the Red Sea, and when he sent delivers to Israel. Our Saviour came at the time appointed, when he was most wanted.

Theod. Gal. iv. 4. C. --- "We are often oppressed with tribulation, and yet it is not the due time; that so we may be helped by the desire of being set free." S.

Greg. --- Thus the delay is for our advantage. W.

Ver. 11. Know, with love. Such are always heard. What wonder if others be rejected, who flee from God? S. Chrys. and S. Aug. C. --- The learned often trust too much to their own knowledge, whereas God has made choice of the simple. Matt. xi. 25. Bert.

Ver. 12. Ways, (studia) "favours," (H.) works, &c. C. --- This was done by the apostles. S. Aug.

--- Men ought chiefly to study the precepts of God. W.

Ver. 13. Their, may be omitted, as it would seem to refer to the Gentiles. God declares that he will demand the blood of all that shed it without authority.

Gen. ix. 5. H. --- He had punished the Chanaanites, &c. for their cruelty, as he did afterwards the persecutors of his Church. If the names of Herod, Nero, &c.

be infamous in history for their sanguinary proceedings, they are not less so on account of the judgments which God exercised upon them,

even in this world. C. See Lact. de Mort. Persec. H. --- God avengeth the blood of his martyrs. W.

Ver. 14. Enemies. Israel has been so long under oppression.

Ver. 15. Death, from the most imminent dangers. H. --- Daughter. In the places where the inhabitants of Sion assembled, (Bert.) or publicly in the Church. W.

--- In hell, the damned would wish to die. Theod. --- The gates of death may also signify sin, (Orig.) and the bad example of parents. S. Jer.

Ver. 16. Hid. These are the enemies of salvation. Bert. --- The nations which had oppressed the Jews found their fortifications and arms turned against themselves, (C.) which is often the case of the wicked. W.

Ver. 17. Hands. Caught in the very act, so that he cannot deny the crime. Here we find in Heb.

(C.) higaion sela, which S. Jerom renders, "by meditation for ever." H. --- Sept.

Sym. and some Lat. copies, "a canticle of the psalm's division," diapsalmatos.

Here perhaps the psalm ended. C.

Ver. 18. Hell; shall die, or be lost. (Convertantur.) Lit. "Let," &c. But it may be properly explained as a prediction, or menace. H. --- "Those who are devoid of God's justice, return to the dominion of the devil." Robertson, Lexic. --- Zeal, and not revenge, prompts David to speak thus. W.

Ver. 19. Not perish. Heb. does not express the negation, but it must be understood. Bert. ---

Prot. supply it from the former part of the verse. The expectation of the just will not be frustrated.

Ver. 20. Man. Heb. enosh, (H.) "weak," sinful "man." Bert. -- Gentiles, or all notorious sinners.

The Jews despised the Gentiles, as the Romans did all barbarians. W.

Ver. 21. Lawgiver. Heb. mora. H. --- Sept. intimates one who rigorously enforces his laws. M.

--- Sym. "a law." Heb. "instruction." C. --- Houb. "fear." S. Jer. "terror: let the nations know that they are men always." Sela is thus frequently explained as a part of the sentence by S. Jerom, though neglected by others. H. --- It is no proof that the psalm ends here; but serves to excite attention. W. --- The Gentiles lived without law, like beasts, except that their conscience sometimes admonished them of their duty. Rom. ii. 14. H. --- Whether a person can ever silence it entirely, is a very serious and terrible question. The great ones stand in need of being admonished frequently of their frail condition. Bert. --- When Pausanias, king of Sparta, asked Simonides to give him some important lesson, he replied, "Remember that thou art a man."

Whoever reflects on this, will beware never to yield to sentiments of pride. The Fathers understand this lawgiver to be Jesus; or Antichrist, whom the wicked have deserved to have set over them. Theod. S. Athan. &c. C. --- Those who will not believe in Christ, will give credit to Antichrist. S. Aug. 2 Thes. ii.

Ver. 22. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 1. In modern times, the Jews have done it. W.

--- The Church allows this title, though the Sept. found none in their copies, and therefore looked upon all to be one ps. The change of subject is no proof of the contrary, as such compositions mingle joy and fear together. David has shewn how the just had got the victory. He now proceeds to declare what persecutions they had to endure. Bert. --- After peace war succeeds. There is no settled state here below. H. --- The same sentiments occur, Ps. xi. and xiii.

&c. C. --- Trouble. God assists his servants in distress; (v. 10,) yet sometimes he delays, in order "to inflame their souls with a desire of his coming." S. Aug.

--- He is present, (Acts. xvii. 28.) but only the men of prayer are truly sensible either of it, or of his absence. Bert. --- The weak think he defers his aid a long time when they suffer any great persecution.

Ver. 23. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 2. Fire. With zeal (W.) and indignation, or rather is oppressed (C.) and persecuted. See Mic. iii. 3. H. --- They. Houb.

would substitute "he is caught." But we may well explain this of the sinner and the unjust, v. 3. Bert. --- Indeed both are under perplexity, as the poor knows not why the wicked prosper. Bellar. M. --- An answer is given to the complaint of the just, intimating that the wicked are caught in their own snares, (W.) and are not free from trouble. H.

Ver. 24. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 3. Blessed by flatterers, while his is full of himself also, as the Heb. insinuates. C. --- "The miser, applauding himself, has blasphemed the Lord. The wicked in the height of his fury will not seek, nor is God in all his thoughts." H. --- This is more energetic, and encourages us to study the original. The worldling wishes there were no God; or banishes him from his thoughts as much as possible. Bert.

Ver. 25. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 4. Seek to regain his favour, (W. M.) or rather (H.) he flatters himself that God will not punish him, v. 13. C. --- Multum irascitur, dum non exquirat. S. Aug.

See Psalm xxxv. 5.

Ver. 26. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 5. Filthy. Heb. "as one in labour." He can enjoy no ease.

Chal. "his ways are prosperous." Jun. "paved." C. --- Removed. Heb. "height itself before him, he will blow upon all his enemies." This more forcibly denotes his violence and scorn. Bert.

Acts ix. 1. M. --- He ruleth for a time, and supposeth that his dominion will never have an end, and that he will enjoy constant happiness. W.

Ver. 27. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 6. Evil. Always happy, or as the Heb. Chal. &c.

may signify,

"I shall not desist from evil." C. --- I will gratify my passions. Who dares to oppose me? A. ---

The pride of Nabuchodonosor is known. Dan. iv. 19. &c.

Ver. 28. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 7. Sorrow. Which he prepares for others, and yet feels himself. C. --- Etiam ad perniciem laboratur. S. Aug. --- To gain hell requires some "trouble. H.

--- The wicked is his own executioner. C.

Ver. 29. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 8. Rich. S. Jer. "in the porches," is equivalent.

Moderns translate, "villages," which Houbigant would change for a word signifying "ditches," without necessity. Bert.

Ver. 30. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 9. Poor. "His eyes look round the strong," for aid; or "the poor," (Prot.) for destruction. See v. 14.

Ver. 31. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 10. Fall. Prot. " and humbleth himself, that the poor may fall by his strong ones." H. --- He imitates the lion in the fable, which feigned sickness. Hor. ep. ---

But the Vulg. gives a better sense. C. --- "He will bring under the broken, (poor) and will rush on violently with all his power." S. Jerom here explains chelecaim, valenter, instead of "the poor;"

(H.) as some of the Gr. interpreters must have done, if it be true that his version is formed on the plan of the Hexapla, of a mere selection from Aq.

Sym. and Theodotion, as Houbigant asserts, (Pref.) in order to confute the Jews. H.

Ver. 32. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 11. End. God delays for a time; but he will punish. C. ---

Religion lays open all the sophisms of infidelity. Bert.

Ver. 35. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 14. Sorrow. Thou punishest with pain. S. Aug.

--- Thou beholdest all the iniquity which is committed, (C.) but waitest until the measure be full. S.

Chrys. --- Terrible delay! --- Poor. S. Jer. "art left thy strong ones," who distrust in themselves, and rely on thee. H. --- Others explain cheleca, "poor and weak." Parkhurst. --- Cheleca only occurs here and v. 9. 10. Prot. "the poor committeth himself to thee." H.

Ver. 36. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 15. Found. When the means of sinning are withdrawn, he will repent; (SS. Chrys. Aug. Is. xxviii. 19.) or it is a sort of irony: he will see whether, as he said, God will take no notice, v. 4. C. --- He shall be utterly exterminated. Ps. xxxvi. M. --- No vestige of his magnificent works, founded on injustice, shall remain. H.

Ver. 37. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 16. Shall. Or Heb. "have perished." In the prophetic style, things to come are spoken of as past, on account of their certainty. Bert. --- The wicked shall not appear in the kingdom of God, to pollute his earth. H. --- Ye nations which have seized the promised land, except not to keep possession. If God suffer the sinner for a while, it is because he is eternal, so that he will never let him escape. C.

Ver. 38. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 17. The. Heb. "Thou, Lord, hast heard the desire of the humble. Thou wilt prepare their heart; thou wilt cause thine ear to hear." Prot. H. --- Luther seems to have altered the text in his German version, in order to establish his error of the certitude of salvation; "their heart is sure that thine ear hath heard." The Heb.

intimates that God prepares the heart for all good. Bert. --- He hears before his servants cry out, (Is. lxxv. 24.) since his spirit inspires the petitions. Rom. viii. 26. Gal. iv. 6. C. --- The cry of the heart is charity, amore petitur. S. Aug. Mor. Ecc. --- The just man is always ready to suffer whatever God may appoint.

W.

Ver. 39. or Hebrew Psalm x. Ver. 18. Earth. S. Jerom is more expressive, "that the man of earth may by no means cherish pride any longer." Though he may be the greatest monarch, he is but man, dust and corruption, v. 21. H. ---

Christ, who shewed himself wonderful in humility at his birth, (v. 1.) will display his power at the last day, by giving sentence against the wicked, and by exalting his servants. W.

PSALM 10

PSALM X. (IN DOMINO CONFIDO.)

The just man's confidence in God in the midst of persecutions.

Ver. 1. Heb. Lamnatseach lidavid, (H.) "to the master of music or, or to David."

C. --- S. Jerom supplies the word psalm. That David, or any other, should give the title of master of music to so great a prince may seem strange; and therefore the Vulg. may perhaps be as accurate. S. Jerom and Pagnin have "to the victor of David." Almost all agree that he composed this psalm (H.) when he began to be persecuted by Saul. He expresses his confidence in God; when his friends advised him to flee. C. --- The Fathers take hence occasion to caution the faithful against the insidious speeches of those who pretend that they can procure greater security than the Church affords, (H.) and that they teach a doctrine of greater perfection. SS. Aug. Jer. &c. C.

Ver. 2. How. My friends... say, &c. W. --- To the. Heb. now, "to your mountain,"

as the words are joined which were formerly divided, while a v has been lost, and another placed instead of i, as we may gather from the ancient interpreters. Chal. Syr. S. Jer. &c. --- Most people suppose that David's friends exhort him to withdraw: but he waits for the divine order. Others think (C.) that these are the words of his enemies, who wished to fill him with dismay, that he might retire among the Gentiles, and adore their idols, 1 K. xxvi. 19. Mariana.

--- Sparrow. Heb. tsipor, any little "bird." H. Prov. xxvii. 8. M. --- Heretics false style their conventicles the mountains. S.

Aug. W.

Ver. 3. Quiver. Heb. "on the string," ready to shoot. C. --- But yether (H.) means

"abundance,"

and may be well understood of the quiver. Bert. --- Persecutors use all rigour, though they disguise the real cause of their resentment against the innocent.

W. --- Dark. Sept. add "moon."

M.

Ver. 4. Made. In choosing me for king, Heb. "the foundations are, or shall be destroyed; and what shall the just do? or, what has the just man done?" The foundations, both of religion and of the kingdom, depend on God's ordinances, as the Sept. well explain. Bert. --- Pagnin has, "the nets;" S. Jerom,

"the laws." In these days of infidelity and rebellion, the just must experience the greatest perplexity. H. --- If faith be lost, who shall be just? Bert. ---

**Persecutors, and especially heretics, pull down what others have built.
W.**

Ver. 5. Heaven. This is the source of my confidence. C. --- The admirable mother of the Machabees suggested this consoling motive, (Bert.) to strengthen her youngest son. 2 Mac. vii.

28. Heaven is the temple of the Lord, (H.) though the tabernacle may be so styled here. See Ps.

x. 8. C. --- The poor man is not in Heb. but it is chiefly of him that the psalmist speaks; (Bert.) and the Sept. and Arab. (C.) seem to (H.) have read it. Eliphaz remarks, that God does not disregard human affairs, as the wicked supposed.

**Job xxii. 12. C. --- If his eyes seem to be shut, his providence watcheth.
W.**

Ver. 6. Trieth, interrogat, which is rendered by examine, v. 5. H. --- God juridically questions all, (C.) and makes them give an exact account of themselves, even of every idle word. H. --- The word also means that he punishes, or chastises. C. --- Heb. "the Lord trieth the just, but his soul hateth the wicked, and the lover of iniquity." S. Jer. &c. H. --- Yet the original may be explained in the sense of the Sept. which is more beautiful and instructive; as the sinner will hardly believe that he is his own greatest enemy. Bert. --- By continuing in sin he brings damnation on his soul.

W.

Ver. 7. Snares. Wonderful expression! The wicked cannot escape. H. ---

Brimstone, as he did upon Sodom. Gen. xix. 4. Jude 7. --- Cup. At feasts, each person (C.) had his portion and his own cup. Dreadful indeed is the inheritance of the wicked. See Ps. xv. 5. Bert. --- If God spare for a time, He must at last punish severely. W.

Ver. 8. Righteousness. As, on the other hand, (H.) the upright shall behold God, (Matt. v. 8.) while the wicked shall be driven into darkness (C.) for all eternity. In vain do modern sophists pretend that hell will not last for ever because God is incapable of revenge, or of delighting in the torture of his creatures. They use the word revenge in a wrong sense. Bert. --- God is not subject to any passion; but his justice requires that those should be eternally punished, whose will is always impious. H. --- Can they shew that there will be room for repentance in the other world?

(Bert.) or that the wicked would make use of it, if granted, since they would not repent as long as they lived? By the same arguments, they might as well prove that God could not punish at all. H.

Dan. iii. 27.

PSALM 11

PSALM XI. (SALVUM ME FAC.)

The prophet calls for God's help against the wicked.

Ver. 2. Save. David, persecuted by Saul, (Bossuet) or Absalom; (Grot.) the captives at Babylon; (C.) our Saviour suffering, or coming to judge; (S. Aug.) in a word, any just man who sees the corruption of men, may use this language.

H. --- We cannot open the writings of the prophets, or of the Fathers, without meeting with such complaints. Heb. "no saint;" chasid, "pious" (Pagn.

H.) clement person. C. --- Truths. Heb. "people of veracity." C. --- Bias said, "All men are bad;"

(Clem. strom. 1.) or, as Laertius expresses it, "Most people are wicked." Hence few are chosen.

H. --- Christ is the truth. If we admire his doctrine, let us put it in practice. Bert.

Ver. 3. Deceitful. Heb. "flattering;" and of course not free from deceit. Bert. ---

"That man I hate, e'en as the gates of hell,

Who thinks one thing, and will another tell." Iliad I.

--- None can have (H.) confidence in a liar. S. Jam. i. 8. C.

Ver. 4. Lips. "The saints do not curse, but foretell what will happen." S. Jer. ---

Heb. "the Lord will destroy" the deceitful, (Bert.) who mean to injure men; (H.) and the proud, who attack God and religion, which they pretend they can prove (Bert.) to be a mere fiction, by their superior eloquence! H.

Ver. 5. Own. "We have lips," (Sym.) or eloquence to gain our cause against these miserable exiles. C. --- Lord. Heb. adon, "master." We admit of no superior, neither in heaven nor on earth. H. --- Such was the haughtiness of Pharaoh, &c. Ex. v. 2. and 4 K. xviii. 19. Dan. iii. 15.

C.

Ver. 6. Arise, and redeem lost man; (Theod.) or, protect my servants (C.) from such insolent oppressors. H. --- Regard. This may be put in the mouth of the afflicted. C. --- "I will place my confidence in the Saviour, and will act boldly in him." H. --- His promises give me full assurance, v. 7. The Heb. seems to be incorrect, and very different from what the ancients read.

C. --- S. Jer. has, "I will place their aid in salvation;" (H.) which he explains of Jesus Christ. See Is. xii. 2. C. --- Moderns insert many words. "I will save him, that they may learn to trust in me."

**German. --- "I will set him in safety from him that puffeth at him."
Prot. Or**

"would ensnare him."

Margin. We may better translate, "I will put in safety, the Lord will act freely herein;" or, "safety which will act freely upon him," the poor.

Bert. --- "I will raise up a Saviour, who with his breath will destroy the wicked." Prin. disc.

Ver. 7. Pure words, very different from those of the deceitful, v. 3. C. --- Earth, dross, or in the crucible, or "for the ruler of earth:" (Pagnin. H.) current money.

If we alter the Heb. a little, it may be, "with care, (bahalil, which is never elsewhere used for a crucible) gold refined seven times;" often, (Prov. xxiv.

16.) or as much as possible. C.

Ver. 8. This corrupt generation; or, both in this world and in the next. Heb.

"preserve them;" the just, or thy words. C. --- "And thou wilt keep him." Pagn.

--- Prot. marg. i.e. "Every one of them." S. Jerom reads, "us." H.

Ver. 9. About. Their life is a circle of relapses; or rather they continually attack the just, (C.) but their designs are made subservient to their advancement in virtue, by the power of God. T. ---

Heb. "They (the just) shall go round the wicked, when baseness shall have raised herself up, on account of the children of men." When God shall have restored the Jews to liberty, the Babylonians shall be, in their turn, oppressed by Cyrus and the Persians, whom they now despise: or, when the miserable shall be placed in power, the wicked shall not dare to approach them. C.

--- "The wicked shall walk round about, when the vilest of the sons of men shall be exalted." S.

Jerom. H. --- The former have spent their life in vanity, and shall be kept for ever out of the kingdom of heaven; as the error of the Platonists, who assert that all things will come to pass again, the world being compared to a wheel, is manifestly refuted by Scripture, which assures us that God will preserve the just from this generation, (S. Aug.) and the wicked will knock at the door, like the foolish virgins, and will be rejected with, I never knew you. Matt. xxv. S. Jer.

or some other learned author. W. --- For some suspect that the commentary which goes under the name of S. Jerom, is not in the state in which it came from his hands. --- H.

PSALM 12

PSALM XII. (USQUEQUO DOMINE.)

A prayer in tribulation.

Ver. 1. Me? These expressions are figurative. God seems displeased: but it is often for our greater good. Some explain this of David, Ezechias, the captives,

&c. It may be applied to every afflicted soul, which places her whole trust in God. C.

Ver. 2. Day; frequently. W. --- Sept. adds, "and night." C. --- These cares and perplexities arise from persecutions and from man's weakness. W.

Ver. 3. Enemy; Saul, &c. or the devil. S. Aug. C.

Ver. 4. Death, by mortal sin, (W.) or through excessive sorrow. Jer. li. 39. Shew me thy favour, (C.) and I shall be secure. Sleep is represented as nearly related to death. Iliad xiv.

Tum consanguineus lethi sopor. Æn. vi. H.

Ver. 7. Mercy. Man must attribute nothing to himself, otherwise he will be moved by pride. S.

Aug. C. --- Things; patience and reward. W. --- The prophet feels a secret confidence arising in his breast, in consequence of God's protection. --- Yea,

&c. is not in Heb. but it is in the Sept.

Arab. and the ancient Fathers. Heb. "My heart shall be transported in thy salvation; I will praise the Lord, because he has rendered me the like," as I placed my hopes in him: (C.) or, "he hath rewarded me." The blessed Virgin adopts the language of this verse, and the prophet probably had the same salvation, Christ, in view. Berthier.

PSALM 13

PSALM XIII. (DIXIT INSIPIENS.)

The general corruption of men, before our redemption by Christ.

Ver. 1. Fool: the man of the most depraved morals, the atheist and deist. There have always been (Bert.) such pests of society. H. --- David has refuted them again. Ps. lii. Bert. --- Some have imagined that this psalm was composed in consequence of the blasphemies of Rabsaces, (4

K. xviii. 32. Theodoret, &c.) or of the Babylonians. C. --- The Fathers explain it of Jesus Christ, denied by the Jews, &c. --- Heart. This must be strangely corrupted, before the mouth can utter such impiety. H. --- No God. Chal. "no power of God on earth." Elohim denotes particularly

"judges." There have been a few philosophers who have denied the existence of God; and more who have called in question his Providence: though this amounts to the same thing. But the number of those who confess God with the mouth, and deny him by their works, is immense. H.

--- These live as if there were no judge. C. --- By sin they come at last to think there is none to govern the world. W. --- Plato (Leg. 10.) acknowledged that three sorts of people offend God; those who deny him; who say that He does not mind human affairs; or those who think that presents may prevail on him to connive at their wickedness. It is doubtful whether the mind can ever be so darkened as to believe that there is no God. Bert. --- The heart may wish there were none to punish its impiety. H. --- Libertinage or pride gives birth to so many infidels. They have begun by reducing conscience to silence. Their arguments only tend to destroy. --- No, not one, is not in Heb. Sept. &c. except in v. 3. C. --- Yet it occurs in the Vatican Sept, which is the best.

Bert. C. --- "They are become abominable, with earnestness there is none who doth good." S.

Jer. H. --- Or they sin designedly and with affectation. C. --- All are unable to do good without the Redeemer. W. --- Some explain this of mankind in general, as all are born in sin. David refers also to actual and habitual sinners. Bert. --- S.

Paul (Rom. iii.) proves from this text, and Isai. lix. 7, that all stand in need of grace and faith, and cannot be saved either by the law of nature or of Moses.

But it does not follow that faith alone will save, or that the most just are still wicked, as Calvin and Beza falsely expound the Scriptures. For the prophets speak of those who were not yet justified, teaching that all mankind were once in sin, and could not be justified but by Christ. At the same time, they assert that, when they are justified, they must serve justice to bear fruit, and obtain happiness. Rom. vi. These points are well explained by S. Aug.: (de Sp. et lit. i.

9.) "The just are justified freely by his grace," not by the law or will; though this is not effected without the will, &c. The same holy doctor (c. 27) observes, that the just do not live free from all venial sins, and yet remain in the state of salvation; while the wicked continue in the state of damnation, though they do some good works. W.

**Ver. 2. God. Those only who seek God, understand their real interests.
H. ---**

The pagans, and particularly those of Babylon, lived in the greatest dissolution, so as to call loudly for vengeance, v. 5. C. --- Both the understanding and the will were gone astray. Bert.

Ver. 3. Unprofitable. Without faith in Christ, none have meritorious works. W. ---

Not one.

Such was the condition of the world before Christ, as all were born in sin. "No one," says S. Aug.

"can do good, except he shew the method." All were immersed in ruin, "except the holy Virgin, concerning whom, for the honour of the Lord, I would have no question at all, in treating of sins."

S. Aug. de Nat. et Grat. con. Pelag. xxxvii. 44. C. --- The Council of Trent approves of this reserve, when speaking of original sin. Our Saviour is the source of this privilege, and much more out of the question. He could not be guilty of any sort of transgression. He was in all things like to us, excepting sin. H. --- Their, &c. What follows to shall not, (v. 4.) occurs in S.

Paul; (Rom. iii. 11, 12, 13.) whence S. Jerom supposes that it has been inserted here, though the apostle took the quotations from different parts of scripture.

Praef. in xvi. Isai. He informs us, that all the Greek commentators marked it as not found in Heb. or the Sept. "except in the Vulg.

or koine, which varied in different parts of the world." There seems to be no reason why it should have been omitted designedly, whereas some might insert it, through the false notion that S. Paul had taken it from this psalm. C.

--- The Heb. is not therefore mutilated, but the Vulg. redundant.

Amama. --- Yet this is not absolutely clear. We find the quotation in the Rom.

Sept. which is the most correct; (Bert.) though some prefer the Alex. MSS. H.

--- It is also in the Arab. and Ethiopic versions; so that it might have been in S.

Paul's copy. Our Saviour read a passage from Isaias, which is not extant. Luke iv. 19. Bert. --- S. Justin, S. Aug. &c. agree with the Vulg.; and Lindan mentions a Heb. copy which had these verses, though the learned have reason to think that this Heb. was of a modern date. C. --- Prot. 1577, inserted these three verses, (W.) which they now omit. --- Sepulchre. They are never satisfied with destruction, (H.) and with vexing others. W. ---

We bear in ourselves the seed of corruption, which can be prevented from growing up only by the grace of Jesus Christ. Bert. --- Perdition is from thyself, O Israel. H.

Ver. 4. Know my just providence, though they would fain keep it out of sight, (v. 1.) that they may indulge their passions. H. --- My people. These we may conclude, were just; (Bert.) at least in comparison with their cruel oppressors, (H.) who made it their daily practice to injure them, (S.

Aug.) as they could do it with facility. Num. xix. 9. Prov. xxx. 14. Mic. iii. 2. C. ---

The prophet, in God's name, complains of their eagerness to hurt the good. W.

Ver. 5. Where. This expression refers to there, which is in Heb. though this last part of the verse is wanting. Capel. --- It is in Ps. lii. 6., and this renders the former omission (v. 3.) more credible.

Bert. --- When Cyrus approached to besiege Babylon, Nabonides, the king, met him, and gave him battle; but losing the victory, he, in a panic, retreated to Borsippe, and abandoned the defence of his capital. Beros. apud Jos. con.

App. l. The citizens were in the utmost consternation. Isai.

xiii. and xxi., &c. C. --- But the wicked tremble at the prospect of temporal losses, (M.) and at shadows, while they boldly affront the Deity. Unbelievers find difficulties in the Catholic doctrines, which are frequently attributed to their own mistakes. H. --- The pagans would not believe in God, but trembled before idols; which cannot hurt the faithful. W.

Ver. 6. Man, who wished sincerely to practise his religion, like Daniel, &c. Such you have persecuted, and hence God has filled you with alarms, and will punish you. C. --- Some persevere in justice, amid the general contagion and insults of men. W.

Ver. 7. Sion; which God has chosen for his sanctuary. H. --- Salvation, or the Saviour, whom Jacob expected. Gen. lxix. Bert. --- This Redeemer would fill all, both Jews and Gentiles, with joy, who should embrace his faith. S. Aug. &c. ---

The prophet seems to foretell the restoration of the ten tribes to the kingdom of Judea, as it took place after the captivity. C. Diss. --- But he sighed for, and designated more particularly, (H.) the Saviour of the world; who would redeem man from the tyranny of the devil, to the great joy of those who strive to supplant every vice, and to contemplate God, (W.) as some interpret the names of Jacob and Israel. H. --- The Gentiles will then be ingrafted into the stock of Abraham, (M.) into the true olive-tree. Rom. xi. H.

PSALM 14

PSALM XIV. (DOMINE QUIS HABITABIT.)

What kind of men shall dwell in the heavenly Sion.

Ver. 1. David. The word psalm being appropriated to some, while others are styled hymns, &c.

does not hinder the latter from being also psalms or spiritual songs, to be set to music: so the insertion of David, "the beloved's name," in some of these divine canticles, is no proof that the rest were not written by him. W. --- The author describes the perfection of priests, &c. contrasts the sanctity of those who shall inherit Jerusalem with that of the wicked mentioned in the last psalm. Some copies have To the end in the title, while others omit it, with the Heb. S. Chrys. &c.

--- Hill. The Jews comforted themselves with the hopes of seeing Jerusalem rebuilt, Ps. cxxxi. 1.

The prophets describe those who should return from captivity, as holy people, (Isai. xxvi. 3.

Soph. iii. 13. C.) a figure of the Church. H. --- Heaven is also styled a tabernacle and mountain, (Apoc. xv. 5. Heb. xii. 22. Bert.) and is here chiefly (H.) meant.

See ver. 5. W.

Ver. 2. Justice. These two things characterize the true Israelites. C. --- We must avoid sin, and do good, in thought, word and deed, v. 3. W.

Ver. 3. Heart, as he thinks. H. --- Those who sincerely love truth, will not deceive others. C. ---

We must be attached to all revealed truths, and avoid all the disorders of the tongue. --- Up, which would otherwise have fallen to the ground, &c. Bert. ---

Reproach. Rashly giving credit to injurious reports, (C. S. Aug. Ex. xxiii. 1.) or speaking with insult, (Theod.) even in giving correction, (S. Hilary) or listening to detraction. W.

Ver. 4. Nothing. He despises all wickedness, though done by kings, whose power he considers as the means of destruction. 1 K. xv. 26. Lu. xxiii. 9. The wicked dares not appear before an upright judge, like David. Ps. c. 2. Heb. may be "the wicked is despised." S. Jer. H. --- Those who follow the Jews, have "he thinks meanly of himself," which is very good; but the sense of the Vulg.

seems more pointed, (C.) though the other contains a noble maxim of the gospel. Bert. ---

Prot. "in whose eyes a vile person is contemned." The sinner is the only person who is truly vile, in the opinion of the just, who forms not his opinion on outward appearances. H. --- Lord. Glory is the reward of good works. W. ---

Neighbour. This sense is conformable to the Heb. without points, (Geneb.) and more beautiful than that of the Rabbins, "against his own interest," (Jun.) "to do evil," (Ainsworth) "friendship," (Sym.) or "to afflict himself." S. Jerom. ---

We find such vows strongly enforced. Num. xxx. 3. Deut. xxiii. 21. C. --- Prot.

"that sweareth to his own hurt, and changeth not." H. --- It were to be wished that oaths were not necessary. C. --- But when they are, the Lord must be the arbiter of truth, and not idols; as by swearing, we testify that we believe God is the sovereign truth, and thus honour his name. See Lev. xix 12. Mat. v. 33. H.

Ver. 5. Usury. This was always blameable, though Moses tolerated it with respect to the Jews lending to the Chanaanites. Deut. xxiii. 19. Lu. vi. 35. The Roman law condemned the guilty to pay double as much as the thief, who was to restore twice the value of what he had stolen. Cato 1. --- Under the semblance of kindness it does a real injury; (S. Hil.) etiam his invisibilibus succurrere videtur. Columel. præf. C. --- Bribes, (munera) "presents." Even these are dangerous, as they tend to prepossess the judge. H. --- Both usury and doing wrong for bribes exclude from heaven. W. --- A judge must shake such things from his

hands, (Isai. xxxiii. 15.) as he cannot take them to give either a just or a wrong sentence. His duty requires him to give the former; so that the innocent would thus be purchasing what was his own. C. --- The same maxims must be applied to all in authority, (H.) to witnesses, &c. C. --- Those who have not failed in any of these respects, must be possessed of faith, and all other necessary virtues, before they can enter heaven. For when the scripture attributes salvation to any one virtue in particular, it does not mean to exclude the rest. --- For ever. All terrestrial things are mutable; and of course, the psalmist speaks of heaven. If so great perfection was required, to appear in the tabernacle, how much more must be expected of the candidate for heaven! W. --- The good Christian who has not yielded to temptation, may there enjoy undisturbed repose. Isaias (xxiii. 15.) uses similar expressions, when describing the state of Jerusalem, after the defeat of Sennacherib. C.

PSALM 15

PSALM XV. (CONSERVA ME DOMINE.)

Christ's future victory and triumph over the world and death.

Ver. 1. The inscription of a title. That is, a pillar or monument, stelographia: which is as much as to say, that this psalm is most worthy to be engraved on an everlasting monument. Ch. ---

Mictam. Prot. "Michtam." Marg. or "golden psalm of David," or most excellent.

S. Jerom, &c.

have divided the word into two: "of the humble and upright David." H. --- It may signify

"inscribed." C. --- But there seems to be no reason for abandoning the Sept.

who were well acquainted with the original. The ps. is in the form of a prayer, which David pronounces in the person of Christ, to whom the

apostles apply several verses; and, as the rest seem to be of the same nature, we must understand all of the Messias, praying, in his sacred humanity, (Bert.) that his body may remain incorrupt. It may refer to Ezechias, to the captives, or rather to David, persecuted by Saul, and provoked to serve false gods. 1 K. xxvi. 19.

But then many expressions must be explained figuratively, (C.) and this would tend to weaken the prediction, (Bert.) which all the Fathers have understood of Christ suffering. C. --- The thing most worthy to be noted, (stilographia) by the prophet David, is our Saviour's crucifixion; (W.) the memory of which must be perpetuated. Job (xix. 24.) wished that what he said about the resurrection, might thus be engraven on flint. H. --- Preserve. David acknowledges his infirmity, and that all good comes from God. C. --- Jesus was heard praying with tears, &c. Heb. v. 7. In his humanity, He might use these expressions, (H.) as He was the head of a new people, whom he wished to sanctify and instruct.

Bert. --- He often prayed, as the gospel informs us. W.

Ver. 2. I have. Heb. "Thou, my soul, hast said." But S. Jerom agrees with us. ---

Goods. Heb.

"my good is not above thee." I can desire nothing greater. Bert. --- Aquila and Vatable seem to have the same idea as the Sept. We reap all the profit from our piety. C. --- The redemption was entirely for man's benefit, (W.) though it gave the greatest glory to God. H. --- Since God, therefore, wants nothing, I will shew my kindness (Bellar.) to the poor. H.

Ver. 3. Saints. Heb. "the magnificent" priests, God himself, (Ex. xv. 11. Calmet) and ceremonies of religion, (H.) for which David had a wonderful affection. C.

--- But Christ has displayed the greatest love towards all his converts, and they had need of it. Bert. --- God here speaks, shewing that Christ

should make known his wonderful charity to the apostles and other saints.

Ver. 4. Haste. Men who are convinced of their own infirmities, hasten to find a remedy. W. ---

No sooner had fallen man been redeemed, that he strove to advance in the ways of perfection.

Bert. --- The sins, to which the saints sometimes yield, tend to make them more cautious (C.) and grateful to their deliverer, like S. Peter. Persecutions likewise cause them to cling closer to God, and fill them with interior joy. Acts v. 41. H. --- If we explain it of the wicked, chastisement often makes them repent. Ps. lxxvii. 34. C. --- "Their idols have been multiplied after their followers, I will not join in their libations of blood." S. Jer. --- David was continually exposed to such temptations, among the idolaters; but out of contempt, he would not even pronounce the name of the idols. C. --- Blood, or bloody. D. --- The pagan (W.) and Mosaic sacrifices shall cease. Christ will unite us (Bert.) by a more excellent oblation of his own body and blood. H. ---

Christians shall be distinguished by a fresh appellation, being styled children of light and of God, in opposition to the sons of men, (S. Aug. &c. C.) and pagans.

Ver. 5. Cup. Eternal happiness consists in seeing (W.) and enjoying God, (H.) and is promised to the patient. Though Christ was truly king of Israel and exercised jurisdiction, (Jo. xii. and xviii.

37. Matt. xxi. &c. W.) yet it was not of a temporal nature; (H.) and his chief inheritance was the Lord, who would reward his merits. He has taught all clergymen to make this happy choice; as they declare when they become such. Man may call God his inheritance, as he was made for him; and though he may have fallen, if he rise again, his title will be restored, and he may obtain felicity, whether he live in the world or retire from it. W. --- David alludes to the custom of allotting each his portion of wine and meat, which was greater in proportion to the

person's dignity. He rejects with disdain all worldly and sensual joys. C. --- God in not "a part," but the whole portion of a good man. ---

It is, &c. S. Jer. "Thou art the possessor of my lot." I trust in thee for all. H. 1

Pet. i. 4. 2 Tim. i. 12. In the ancient sacrifices a part was reserved for the offerer. But Jesus keeps nothing back.

Ver. 6. Lines, with which land was measured. Bert. --- Christ expresses his satisfaction with his church, which is gathered from all nations, to manifest the choicest virtues. Tit. ii. 14.

Euthymius, S. Jer. &c. C. --- This was his inheritance, not measured out with lines, (Jos. x.) but reaching to the very ends of the earth. Ps. ii. H.

Ver. 7. Understanding. Heb. "counsel." In the night of tribulation God directs the reins, or affections of the soul. Christ might speak thus concerning his human nature. Bert. Lu. ii. 40.

Heb. v. 7. David also gives thanks to God for enabling him to make so happy a choice, and to avoid being seduced. C. --- He derives instructions from pain.

W.

Ver. 8. That I. Heb. "I shall not," &c. The sense is the same, but S. Peter agrees with us and the Sept. Acts ii. 25, &c. It is not of faith that the seven preceding verse regard Jesus Christ as the following do; but as the same person speaks, we may rationally infer that all should be explained of him. Though he always enjoyed the beatific vision, his soul had the affections of other men, and always tended to keep in God's presence. So the angels who see God, desire more and more to contemplate him. 1 Pet. i. 12. How earnestly ought we to strive always to keep in the divine presence! (Bert.) then we should constantly advance in virtue, and fear no dangers. The patriarchs thus walked with God, and arrived at such perfection. H. --- The father was always at the right hand of his Son, to support and glorify him; and the Son,

having continually performed what was pleasing to God, (Jo. viii. 29.) was placed at his right hand at his ascension, though his divinity had never been separated from him. C. --- He had always God in view, and has left us a pattern how to behave. W.

Ver. 9. Tongue. Heb. "glory." Yet Prot. translate, "tongue," (Acts ii.) as S. Peter follows the Sept.

(H.) and he surely understood the force of the Heb.; so that his testimony in their favour is very strong. Commentators observe that the tongue manifests the joy of the heart, (Bert.) and the same word is used for the soul. Ps. vii. 6. C.

--- Yet very different words signify the tongue and glory; and we follow the text, adopted by the apostle. Joy naturally flows from the presence of the best of friends. Bert. --- Our Saviour sometimes suspended this joy, that he might suffer the more for us. C.

Ver. 10. Soul in hell. Beza, (in his 1st. edit. which he corrected afterwards) would translate

"more corpse (cadaver, or carcass) in the grave;" for which he as been justly blamed. For, though the corpse is sometimes called soul, as it has been animated by it, (H.) and the soul and blood are often used synonymously, yet we shall find no instance of the body of any one still living being styled a soul.

When speaking, therefore, of a person's future death, the soul means either life or the spiritual substance. Gen. xxxvii. 22. Ps. xlix. 16. Hence the explanation of the Fathers, who understand this of Christ's descent into hell, to free the saints who were detained in limbo, is more probable. Bert. --- The instances which are adduced to maintain the opposite sentiment, which Calmet, &c.

assert is more literal, either prove nothing, or they relate to people deceased, whose bodies were not to be touched. See Gen. ix. 5. Lev. xvii. 11. and xxi. 11.

Num. vi. 6. and xix.

13. Agg. ii. 14. Christ speaks of his body in the following part of the verse, (H.) calling it Holy, because it was never separated from the divine nature. Bert. ---

The erroneous interpretations or corruptions of Beza and Calvin on this head, opposing themselves to the consent of all the ancient Fathers, who believed this passage related of the descent into limbo, are noted. Gen. xxvii. Acts ii. 1

Pet. iii. The Prot. edit. vary. Some retain the word hell, others the grave; remarking that

"this is chiefly meant of Christ, by whose resurrection all his members have immortality." And (Acts ii.) they paraphrase, "Thou shalt not leave me in the grave;" wresting that which regards the body, rising from the grave, to the soul, which was never there. W. --- The last edit. of Jas. I.

agrees however with us, in both places. "Thou wilt not leave my soul in hell, neither wilt thou suffer thy holy one to see corruption." It is observable that in the Heb. editions, (except Stephen's and some few others) we find the word chasidic in the text, though the last i be properly omitted in the margin; as the word would otherwise signify "saints:" and thus make the apostles false witnesses. Acts xiii. 35, &c. H. --- "But who shall lay any such thing to their charge? Other men may be deficient in their knowledge, and in their honesty; but inspired apostles could neither be deceived nor deceive. All the ancient versions, the Masorets," who order the word to be read in the singular, though printed plural in the text, and many of the best MSS. vouch for their veracity.

Moreover it is not true that God will not suffer his saints to see corruption; and, if this were the meaning of the words, they would not predict the resurrection of any particular person: yet "these words, the apostles observe to the Jews, are a prophecy of some particular person, whose soul was not long to continue in the place of departed spirits, and

whose body was not to be corrupted, both being soon to be reunited. Now David, say they, did not speak this of himself, &c. Have the apostles imposed a prophecy upon the Jewish people, and upon the world?" Kennicott. Dis. i. ---

This learned author was greatly encouraged to go on with his ten years' labour, in examining Heb.

MSS. over the world, by finding many of the so favourable to the Christian religion, though it had been confidently asserted that all the MSS. were perfectly uniform. We may rejoice to see that he also approves of the Catholic explanation of this passage, and does not refer the whole to the burial of Christ. In effect, the Apostles' Creed clearly distinguishes this article from that of the descent into hell. --- One. Mont. ventures to follow Keri, "thy merciful one." H. --- Corruption.

"Neither wilt thou permit that sanctified body, by which other people are to be sanctified, to become corrupt." S. Aug. --- Christ rose again before the holy women had embalmed his body, (Lu. xxvi. 53. Mark xvi. 1.) that no one might attribute the incorruption to that cause. His appearance was so glorious, as to dispel every doubt from the minds of those who would attend to reason. His descent into hell was not in consequence of any weakness, or that he might suffer, (C.) as Calvin blasphemously asserts, (H. T.) but he descended in triumph, to liberate the souls of the holy Fathers, (C.) or to announce to them the glad tidings of peace, the fruits of which they should shortly enjoy at his ascension, when he would open the gates of heaven to all the faithful.

H.

Ver. 11. Of life. The observance of the commandments, (S. Jer.) or the method of obtaining happiness by patience and humility. S. Aug. --- Thou hast opened a new track to me (H.) in the resurrection, unknown to mortals. Euthym. Bellar.

--- For though some had been already raised to life, Christ is still called the first-fruits of those who sleep, or of the dead; because none had

raised themselves to life, as he did. H. Jo. x. 18. --- Yet he attributes all the glory to the Father, either because he is the origin of the Deity, or because Jesus considered himself as man, and was in all things obedient to his Father. Bert.

--- His sacred humanity was now glorified, and beheld the face of God in a more perfect manner than any mere creature can do, tasting inexplicable delights for ever. C. --- We must die and rise again, (W.) before we shall perfectly comprehend the ways of life. Then we shall form a true judgment of all terrestrial things. H.

PSALM 16

PSALM XVI. (EXAUDI DOMINE JUSTITIAM.)

A just man's prayer in tribulation, against the malice of his enemies.

Ver. 1. Prayer. This psalm contains the model of a fervent prayer, (H.) which may be used by any person under affliction. W. --- The Rabbins say David expresses too much confidence in his own integrity, and therefore was soon after permitted to fall; while others assert that he spoke thus after the murder of Urias, to avert God's wrath from his army before Rabbath. But this supposition is improbable, (C.) as well as the other. H. --- The Fathers think that this psalm was composed during the persecution of Saul, and that it contains the sentiments of Jesus Christ and of his Church, under the persecution of infidels. There are some very difficult passages in it. C.

--- My justice. Heb. "attend to justice," (H.) which amounts to the same thing; as no one would make this petition, unless he supposed that he was in the right. "Here the justice of my cause."

Principes. Bert. --- "Hear the just man. " S. Jer. H. --- Lips. I do not attempt to deceive thee, like the hypocrite; or rather I have not acted with deceit, or endeavoured to excite rebellion, as I have been accused. C. --- In my just cause, hear my unfeigned petition. W.

Ver. 2. Countenance. Pronounce sentence, (Est. i. 19. C.) if I have done wrong. I do not refuse punishment. Ps. vii. 5. H. --- The Gr. and Lat. copies vary. Some read correctly with the Heb.

"Let thy eyes behold what is wrong." Yet S. Jer. (ep. ad Sun.) has "right," with the Syr. &c.

Others more commonly read, "Let mine eyes behold justice." C. --- Montanus, however, substitutes rectitudines for iniquitates, as Pagnin had rendered mesharim, and Prot. "the things that are equal." H. --- "Holy preachers are the eyes of Christ...let them see what is just...and fulfil the justice which they preach." S. Jer. --- God sees all things, and will pass a just sentence. W.

Ver. 3. Fire. I have experienced all sorts of misery. C. --- Iniquity. Heb. "Thou hast not found; I have thought." But the same word without points, zamothi, (H.) has the sense given by the Sept.

and they knew nothing of these points. Bert. --- We may also translate, "Thou hast not found in me any criminal thoughts. My mouth has not transgressed thy orders. " If some thoughts of taking revenge by killing Saul, presented themselves involuntarily, David repressed them; (C.) and when he was alone with him at night in a cave, he would not suffer him to be hurt, 1 K. xxvi.

7. Theod. --- He asserts that he had gone through tribulations without offending. Those who are innocent or penitent, may pray with this confidence; as the Church may, which has always some saints, on which account she is styled holy. W.

Ver. 4. Men. Houb. "My mouth shall not pass to the pretexts of Adam." I will not seek for excuses in sin. H. --- "My mouth utters not vows to the vain works of men." Prin. disc. --- But these versions are singular. Bert. --- Hard. Heb. "way of the robber." Purits, or prits, (S. Jer.

H.) means also "fracture." Bert. --- David was ordered by God to retire into the wilderness, and to caves, where he was obliged to live like

robbers, (C.) and was branded (C.) with the title of a fugitive slave by Nabal, 1 K. xxv. 10. H. ---

Yet the actions of David were very different from theirs. Bert. --- He did not speak about the works of men, in power to condemn Saul, or any other, being averse to all detraction, and prescribing to himself the strictest laws, (C.) which God had ever promulgated. Prot. "I have purposed that my mouth shall not transgress. (4) Concerning the works of men, by the word of thy lips, I have kept me from the paths of the destroyer." The division of the verses is arbitrary. H. --- David kept the narrow path of virtue. W.

Ver. 5. Perfect. Heb. "support" me in these hard ways, where I am in continual danger of falling.

C. --- A Deo est incipere, a Deo est finire. S. Jer. --- God's grace enables us to begin and to perfect every good work. H. --- None can walk right of themselves.

W.

Ver. 6. Heard me, of former occasions. This encourages me to pray with more confidence (Bert.) and fervour. Bona vota quoties effectum percipiunt, multiplicantur. S. Greg. Mor. xxxv. 3. ---

Heb. also, "thou wilt hear me favourably." S. Jer. H.

Ver. 7. Mercies. We become accustomed to the ordinary effects of grace, which are always admirable; and we are astonished only at miraculous conversions and occurrences. Orig. ---

Some such manifestation of the divine power seemed now requisite, to deliver David from such a powerful rival as Saul. C. --- Syr. "Lord, make thy holy one appear as a prodigy, as the Saviour of those who hope in thee." S. Jer. --- "O

thou Saviour of those who hope." H.

Ver. 8. Eye. God has shewn particular attention to protect the apple of the eye.

He watches still more over his servants, (Zac. ii. 8.) for whom all things procure good. Rom. viii. 28. Saul had declared himself against David, because he had been chosen to succeed him, and thus he opposed the designs of God.

C. --- The prophet prays that he may never give way to such impiety.

W. ---

Wings, as a hen does her chickens. H. --- Defend me from the furious countenance of my enemies. W.

Ver. 10. Their fat. That is, their bowels of compassion: for they have none for me. Ch. --- They have become fat, and have given way to greater insolence, as we see too often verified. Deut.

xxxii. 15. Job xv. 26. Ps. lxxii. 7. Chal. C. --- Proudly. Libertines are often prompted by vanity to speak as they do against God and man. H. --- If Collins, Tindal, &c. had been cast upon some desert island, they would probably never have written such irreligious works as there would have been none to applaud them. Bert.

Ver. 11. Earth, to testify their wrath. So Virgil describes Juno.

Diva solo fixos oculos aversa tenebat. Æn. l.

--- Hebrew, ashurenu, is rendered "by out step," (Mont.) or contemplation. But the Sept. have explained it as a verb, as well as S. Jerom, (Bert.) who reads,

"marching against me; now they have surrounded me," (H.) like wild bulls. C.

--- Sym. "blessing me, they have presently cast down their eyes, they have prepared snares, to throw me down upon the ground." They have sought my ruin both by craft and by open force. Even those who were

once my friends and admirers, are now turned against me. H. --- He alludes particularly to the courtiers of Saul. C. ---

They intend utterly to destroy me, even to the ground. W. --- Heb. "by our step they have now surrounded us," (Mont.) conformably to Keri; though the text, followed by Pagnin, has, "In our path, they have surrounded me."

Ver. 12. They have taken me, is not expressed in Heb. H.

Ver. 13. Disappoint. Heb. "meet him," as an enemy. Lev. xxvi. 23. --- Thy sword.

The wicked are employed by God to chastise the just, and will then be thrown into the fire. Isai. x. 5. Jer. l.

23. C. --- They little think that they are subservient to the designs of Providence, as they attribute their success to their own might. Whether we beg that God would take his sword from the wicked, or that we may be freed from their malice, is much the same. Bert. --- Hebrew may express the latter sentiment, "Deliver my soul from the wicked, thy sword, (14) the men of thy hand, worldings, whose portion is temporal, in this life," &c. H. --- Many other versions may be given: (C.) by they all tend to shew the fleeting pleasures of God's enemies, who are thus rewarded for their transient virtues, and reserved for eternal torments. H. --- Man is not sufficient to resist that power, which they exercise by God's permission. Hence David begs that it may be taken away. W.

Ver. 14. Divide them from the few, &c. That is, cut them off from the earth, and the few trifling things thereof; which they are so proud of, or, divide them from the few; that is, from thy elect, who are but few; that they may no longer have it in their power to oppress them. It is not meant by way of a curse or imprecation; but, as many other similar passages in the psalms, by way of a prediction, or prophecy of what should come upon them, in punishment of their wickedness. ---

Thy hidden stores: thy secret treasures, out of which thou furnishest those earthly goods, which with a bountiful hand thou hast distributed

both to the good and the bad. Ch. --- Of children.

Heb. "their children are satiated." Houb. Bert. --- Some copies read ueion, (Rom. Sept.) instead of uion. "They have been filled with hogs' flesh." The mistake was easy in Greek. C. S. Jerom agrees with the Vulg. H. --- A numerous family was the great desire of the Jews. David is willing to forego every temporal advantage, and only prays that he may live in his own country, and attend the divine worship in the tabernacle. This was the glory of Israel, v. 15. 1

K. iv. 21. C. ---

He predicts the final separation of the wicked from the elect, which sometimes begins in this life.

Their worldly joys are hidden or disapproved by God. W. --- The feed on the poor servants of our Lord, (H.) whose life is hidden. M.

Ver. 15. Appear. S. Jer. "I shall be filled, when I shall awake in thy likeness," (H.) at the resurrection: (Phil. iii. 21. and 1 Cor. xiii. 12.) or "when thy likeness, the Messias, shall rise again:" or (as the same expression is used by the Sept. as Num. xii. 8.) David begs for actual inspiration, "thou wilt comfort my with the prophetic spirit." C. --- Perhaps he might also desire to see the tabernacle again, or even now prepare to erect a temple unto the Lord; (2 K. vii. 2. H.) or he begs for the gifts of grace and glory, which will restore the image of God, effaced by sin. 1

Jo. iii. 2. Bert. --- Then the just being approved, will taste that joy which alone can satiate the heart of man, when he shall behold God. W.

PSALM 17

PSALM XVII. (DILIGAM TE DOMINE.)

David's thanks to God for his delivery from all his enemies.

Ver. 1. This title is almost wholly taken from the book of Kings, except Unto the end for; instead of which we read, And David spoke, &c. (H.) which are the words of the inspired writer; so that Ferrand is very rash in rejecting both these titles. David wrote this psalm after he had subdued the Moabites, &c. C.

--- He was inspired to write it (W.) twice, with some variations, (Bert.)
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in number, (Aberbanel) or many more, if we believe Kennicott, who lays them to the charge of transcribers, perhaps, (H.) with greater reason. C. --- We cannot doubt but this psalm regards David. But there are some passages which refer to Jesus Christ and his Church more directly; and in general, David must here be considered as only (Bert.) the figure of the Messias, and of the just in his Church. W. --- James Paine has endeavoured to prove, with great ingenuity, that the whole must be explained of Jesus Christ, and that the name of Saul stands for "the grave;" as the points which are of modern date, only need to be changed. Thus the sufferings of our Saviour, and the punishment of the Jews in the last siege of Jerusalem are described; and thus it is clear that S. Paul (Rom. xv. 9.) has cited this ps. in it proper sense. Bert. --- See v. 10. 41.

--- SS. Jerom and Aug. explain it of the victories of David, of the Messias, and of his Church. C. --- Saul may be particularly mentioned, because he was the most powerful. W.

Ver. 2. I will love thee, as a mother does her son. He that loves has fulfilled the law. This word is omitted 2 K. xxii. 2. C. --- Strength. Ibid. --- Rock. H. --- The Sept. have inserted some alterations in the Psalms, giving the sense of the Hebrew. W. --- Others attribute the variations to David, or to the mistake of transcribers. H.

Ver. 3. Firmament. Heb. "rock and my citadel, and my deliverer. My God, (or strong one) my rock." S. Jer. "my strong one." The two words which are rendered "my rock," are salhi and metsudathi. H. --- David frequently retired to such places for safety. The idea was

beautiful and striking. Such multiplicity of titles shews the gratitude (C.) and affection which David felt. C. ---

Here are nine, and we may add the three metaphorical Heb. terms, "rock, citadel, and buckler."

Can we refuse to love One from whom we have received so many favours? ---

And in, &c. These words are most probably cited by S. Paul, (Heb. ii. 13.) though they occur also in Isai. viii. 18. ---

Protector. Heb. "buckler." Bert. --- Horn. This title is given to Jesus Christ, Luke i. 69. It is an allusion to beasts which attack their opponents with their horns (Theod. Deut. xxxiii. 17.) being an emblem of strength (W.) and glory. C.

--- And my, &c. (2 K.) he lifted me up and is my refuge; my Saviour, thou wilt deliver me from iniquity. Heb. "violence."

Ver. 4. Praising. Heb. "praised;" and (2 K.) the Lord, who is worthy to be praised. H. --- Chal.

agrees here with the Sept. and Vulg. which seems more natural. C. --- The sense is the same.

Bert.

Ver. 5. Sorrows...iniquity. Heb. "cables...Belial." By these figurative expressions, David declares to what dangers he had been exposed. They seem to be more applicable to our Saviour's agony. Bert. --- The wicked were constantly laying snares for both. We have the same idea enforced in the next verse. H. --- The words are put into the mouth of fallen man, in the mass for Septuagesima. W.

Ver. 7. Called. All these words are in the future, 2 K. and Heb. H. --- But as they relate to an event that was past, they seem to be as well expressed here as they are in Duport's Greek Psalms.

Bert. --- Both are true; as David had prayed, and would continue to pray, for God's protection; otherwise he would have deserved to lose it. We must always pray, and never faint. H. ---

Temple, "from my heart;" (S. Aug.) from the tabernacle at Gabaaon, (Lyran) or from heaven.

Chal. Euseb. C. --- Earnest prayer is the best remedy against temptations and affliction. God will not fail to hear those who are sincere, as he did the prophet.

W.

Ver. 8. With them is not in Heb. Lo, illi refers to God. Furor fuit ei. Mont. --- "He was wroth."

Prot. Yet he displayed his power on the mountains, as if he had been displeased with them, or with the enemies (v. 4.) whom he would thus strike with awe. H. --- These expressions are not to be taken in a gross literal sense.

C. --- God shewed himself as earnest in the protection of David, (H.) as if he had been in a rage; (C.) or as if the elements had all conspired to defend him.

Theod.

--- This most pompous description (C.) alludes to the wonders wrought at Sinai, and the terrors which would happen at the death and resurrection of Christ, and at his last coming. Some moderns think that the overthrow of the Babylonians, and other enemies of God's people, are also denoted. The sinner, touched by divine grace, implores mercy, and feels the remorse of conscience, the ropes or sorrows of hell, and a dread of God's just judgments hanging over him.

Bert. --- These cause the most haughty and obstinate to tremble. W.

Ver. 9. By it. This relates to the clouds, thunder, and lightning. Muis. --- God's wrath is compared with smoke, fire, a dark night, or mist. W.

Ver. 10. Feet. A violent storm of rain. Hence the Pagans borrowed: Jupiter et læto descendit plurimus imbri. Virg. Ec. 7.

--- The prophets Isai. (xxix. 6.) and Nahum (i. 3.) speak in the same lofty strains; (C.) and shall any one despise the language of Scripture? Nothing can exceed its sublimity. Heb. is rather more expressive, (v. 9.) "a fire devoured;"

(v. 11.) "on a cherub, and flew; he flew most swiftly;" like and eagle. Bert. ---

Heb. vida. H.

Ver. 11. Winds. God mounts his chariot, as it were, (Ezec. i. 4. &c.) to come speedily to David's assistance. Æscylus, and other pagan authors, seem to have imitated his description. Euseb.

præp. evan. xiii. 13. --- The Fathers explain the former verse of Christ's incarnation, or of his second coming; and this of his ascension. S. Athan. &c.

--- They may also (H.) intimate that God is ready to pardon as well as to punish.

W. --- Plato (Phædro) represents the Deity on "a winged chariot, directing and taking care of all things." H.

Ver. 12. Pavilion. Job xxii. 14. and xxvi. 9. The Jews had this idea of God's throne, of which we behold only the less brilliant side, as the Egyptians did that of the cloud. Ex. xiv. 19. The poets represent Jupiter surrounded with clouds and darkness. Hesiod. op. 125 and 255. Iliad O. --- Air.

The parallel passage, (2 K.) seems more accurate. Dropping waters out of the clouds of the heavens. Heb. "waters bound up in darksome

clouds." C. --- God is incomprehensible in himself, and his counsels are inscrutable. W.

Ver. 13. Clouds. 2 K. The coals (Heb. "flames") of fire were kindled. Two words, habaw haberu, his clouds removed, (H.) omitted in this passage, are here supplied, as the former word is found in Syr. and Arab. But then hail and coals of fire seem improper for "they kindled into coals of fire;" and in the next verse they are redundant; being therefore omitted in 2 K. xxii. in the best editions of the Sept. and in the old Italic of Blanchini. Capel supposes they have been inserted from the preceding verse, which is rendered more probably by the Heb. MS. 5. Kennicott Dis. 1.

--- They have been inserted in some editions of Sept. from the Heb. of Theodotion, (C.) or Symmachus. Montf. --- This unusual third hemistic occurs in a smaller type in Brettinger's (Ken.) and Grabe's Sept. but they indicate thereby that it was not in the Alex. MS. as it is not in that of the Vatican. If it were in its proper place, we should read at least grandinem, &c. This magnificent description of a thunder-storm (H.) may allude to that which routed the Philistines. 2

K. v. 24. Is. xxviii. 21. C. --- The lightning seemed to dispel the gloom. Theod.

Flamin. ---

Though man is overpowered with God's majesty, yet he is instructed how to act by those whom God has commissioned to teach. W.

Ver. 15. Arrows. Thunderbolts. Tela reponuntur manibus fabricata Cyclopum.

Metam. Hesiod Theog. 708.

Ver. 16. Discovered. The earthquakes were so great, that such dreadful effects might have been expected. These phenomena sometimes make the sea retire, and new islands appear. Pliny i. 84.

and xxxi. 5. &c. --- The Jews supposed that the sea was the common source of all fountains, and that the earth was founded on it. Ps. xxiii. 2. Eccle. i. 7. C.

Ver. 17. Sent his angel, &c. --- Waters, which often represent multitudes, (Apoc.

xvii. 15. C.) and afflictions. W. --- David seemed in danger of perishing. C.

Ver. 18. For me. He may allude to the giant Jesbibenob, or to Saul, who surrounded him on all sides; (1 K. xxiii. 26. and 2 K. xxi. 15. C.) and, in general, to all his temporal or spiritual adversaries. W.

Ver. 19. Affliction, when my friends joined Absalom. Theod. --- In the rest of this psalm, the prophet chiefly uses words in the obvious sense, yet mystically speaks of Christ, and of the faithful. W.

Ver. 20. Place, where I was not hemmed in by my enemies. H. --- Saved me, by repentance, out of his infinite mercy, (Euseb. S. Athan.) without any deserts. W.

Ver. 21. Will reward. S. Jerom, "hath rewarded," (C.) yet the edition of 1533

reads retribuēt. H.

--- Justice, with respect to my enemies, whom I have not injured; (C.) or my sincere desire to serve God. Theod.

Ver. 23. Judgments. Commands, or treatment both of the just and of the wicked.

Ver. 24. Him, by his grace. W. --- Iniquity, and be careful not to relapse. Others explain it in the past time. I have not shed the blood of my enemy when I could have done it. 1 K. xxiv. 6. 14. C.

--- Fui immaculatus. S. Jer. H. It seems most probable that David composed this before his fall, as Aberbanel, one of the most learned of

the Jews, asserts.

If he be only a figure of Jesus Christ, we may easily conceive how the latter might speak thus of his innocence, and declare his abhorrence of all sin, though he was made a sin-offering, having undertaken to expiate the iniquities of mankind. Bert.

Ver. 25. And. He repeateth, (v. 21.) that God will render to every one as he deserves. W. ---

Matt. xvi. That all sins are equal is the error of the Stoics. H.

Ver. 27. Perverted. No version can properly express this idea. God turns away from those who abandon him, treating every one according to his works. If we do not advance in piety, it is a sign that God perceives something amiss in us.

Bert. --- He cannot but abhor duplicity, and resist the wicked. Lev. xxvi. 23. 40.

Prov. iii. 34. He will make the craft of men turn against themselves, as he evinced in the case of Laban, Joseph's brethren, Pharaoh, and Saul. Sinners complain of him without reason, Ezec. xviii. 25. C. --- Some improperly use this text to shew, that people will adopt the manners of those with whom they associate, (H.) though it means that God will treat the good liberally, and the wicked with severity. Lev. xxvi. 23. 24. Amama.

Ver. 28. Proud, as thou hast already done. C. ---

Insignem attenuat Deus,

Obscura promens. Horat.

Ver. 29. Lamp, giving me hopes of redress, and of the Messiah. C.

Ver. 30. Temptation. David was almost continually assailed by enemies. C. ---

Sept. peieatesion, signifies "a place of pirates;" denoting what crafty foes he had to encounter, (Bert.) or "a place or time to learn the military exercise," a warfare. Job vii. 1. But gedud, (H.) means "a troop,"

designed to make incursions, as those under Jephthe and David. Heb. "In thee I will run armed;"

(S. Jer.) or, "at the head of my troops." C. --- "I will break, (Pagnin) or, run through an army."

Mont. --- No fortification can hold out. H. --- He alludes particularly to the wall of the Jebusites, which Joab first mounted, though extremely high. 2 K. v. 6. C.

--- With God's help, every difficulty may be surmounted. W. --- Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation, as our Saviour admonishes.

Ver. 31. As for, might be omitted. H. --- The conduct of God towards men is irreproachable. He will treat all according to their deserts, and will fulfil his promises of protecting the just. Euseb.

--- Heb. "He is the strong God...his words are pure as gold...He is the shield,"

&c. Bert.

Ver. 32. Our God. Will any one then hinder Him from doing as He has said? H.

--- Heb. "Who is the rock but our God?" Bert. --- God is often styled a rock, tsur. Yet S. Jerom and Pagnin render it "strong," or "the strong one." H. ---

There is only one Lord and Saviour of all. W.

Ver. 33. Blameless. Whatever good is in me, comes from his grace, v. 21. 24. H.

--- God has prevented me from killing Saul and Nabal; He has rescued me from the abyss into which I had fallen. C.

Ver. 44. Harts. Prot. "hinds." H. --- The Hebrews generally prefer to specify the female. Harts are remarkably swift, and this quality was greatly esteemed in a warrior. Asael is praised for it; (2

K. ii. 18.) and Homer styles his hero "the swift-footed Achilles." C. --- As harts trample serpents under their feet, says Theodoret, so I treat my enemies. ---

High. Heb. "my high places," where I have so often baffled the efforts of my persecutors. H.

Ver. 35. And thou. Chal. gives the same sense. "He strengthens," &c. C. --- Heb.

"and a brazen bow is broken by my arms." Mont. --- Prot. "a bow of steel."

Perhaps not knowing that the ancients had the art of making brass answer the same purposes. See Proclus, Hesiod, &c. H. ---

They made all sorts of weapons of it. Job (xx. 24.) seems even to insinuate that it was harder than iron. Our brass is too brittle. To break a bow, often means to obtain a victory. 1 K. ii. 4. Jer.

xlix. 5. C. --- David gained many over a lion or a bear, over Goliath, &c. W.

Ver. 36. Of thy. The latter word is omitted in some copies of the Sept. while others change it into

"my." But the Heb. is agreeable to the Vulg. C. --- End. Thou hast preserved me by salutary correction. S. Aug. H. --- Heb. "thy goodness shall multiply me"

with children. Sym.

conformably to 2 K. xxii. has, "my obedience shall lift me up." C. --- The Heb.

may, however, admit the sense of the Vulg. --- And thy, &c. is a paraphrase of the former sentiment, or it is borrowed from Theodotion. Bert. --- Grabe marks from unto the end, &c. as omitted in Heb. H.

--- Luther and the Dutch translate, "When thou humblest me, then thou exaltest me," to shew the salutary effects of suffering. But there is nothing of the kind in the original. Amama.

Ver. 37. Weakened, or tired. Chal. H. --- I am now free from danger. All my enterprizes have succeeded. 2 K. viii. 6. and 1 Par. xviii. 13. See Prov. iv. 12. C.

Ver. 38. I will. Bellarmine would supply " I said I will;" and thus all is connected.

But these future victories relate more to Jesus Christ. Bert. --- David also continued making fresh conquests, (H.) and so entirely subdued his enemies all around, that they were not able to make head, even against his successor.

Ver. 40. Against. me. No prince was ever more courageous than David, as the single combat with Goliath evinces. We know not that he ever lost a battle. He refers all the glory to God. C.

Ver. 41. Upon me. An expression often used to denote a fight. Jos. iii. 12. &c. C.

--- God strengthens his servants, and weakens their enemies. W.

Ver. 42. Lord. This must be understood of Absalom, who offered sacrifices, (2

K. xv. 12. Bert.) or of Saul, who, receiving no answer, consulted a witch. The Philistines also brought their gods with them, so that they were

taken and burnt; (2 K. v. 21.) and the other pagans, finding no aid in their idols, might in time of danger, invoke the Lord. C. --- This is "the testimony of a soul naturally Christian," as Tertullian (Apol. xvii.) speaks, to have recourse to the great and only God, in the utmost distress. H. --- Deus ut subveniat oratur; ipsa veritas, cogente naturâ...erumpit.

Lac. Inst. ii. 1.

Ver. 43. Streets. Thus he treated the Ammonites, &c. 2 K. viii. 2. and xii. 31. C.

--- Jesus Christ will rule over his enemies with a rod of iron. Bert.

Ver. 44. Gentiles. Here he begins to predict the glory of the Messias, though what he says may be applied to himself. David's own people began to revolt, under Absalom and Seba; after he had subdued the most powerful nations around, 2 K. xx. 1. The chosen people rejected Christ, (C.) while the nations were converted. The reprobation of the former was prefigured by those rebels.

W.

Ver. 46. Faded, (inveterati sunt) "are grown old." H. --- The Jews had been long the objects of God's favours: yet they fell away. Thus we often see priests outdone in piety by simple laics.

Bert. --- David continues in the comparison of a tree which bears no fruit; (C.) thus lying, as it were, and frustrating the just expectations of the owner.

Subjects do the like, when they revolt; (Isai. xxx. 9.) and thus deserve the title of strange. Prot. "the strangers shall fade away, and be afraid out of their close places;" (S. Jer.) "shall flow away, and be contracted in their straits;"

while I shall be at large, v. 37. The last verb gachregu, (H.) occurs nowhere else. It may signify

"shall be withered," or burnt, from carar. C.

Ver. 47. Liveth. This is my consolation, though it must fill the obstinate sinner with dismay. H.

--- In a sort of transport, David wishes all happiness to his great benefactor. He may also speak of Christ's resurrection. C. --- My God. Heb. "rock:" a title frequently applied to God, in acknowledgment of his stability and protection.

Bert.

Ver. 48. Avengest, or "grantest me revenges," (H.) and the victory; inflicting a just punishment on the wicked. David was too well informed to delight in sentiments of revenge. 3 K. iii. 11. Jesus Christ takes vengeance on his enemies, but this is done without passion. The love of justice is his only motive. David approves of this conduct. C. --- Enraged enemies. Vulg.

iracundis. H. ---

Sept. have thus explained aph, "wrath;" others join it with the following verse,

"But (C.) or yea,"

(H.) etiam. The former version is, however, very accurate. Bert.

Ver. 50. Nations. S. Paul (Rom. xv. 9.) adduces this to prove the vocation of the Gentiles. C. ---

We cannot doubt but the great things announced in the psalm pertain to Christ. Bert. --- We see the completion of this prophecy, as there is no Christian nation which does not use the psalms of David to praise God. Theod.

&c. --- This practice is very common (Pref. W.) in all places where either Jews or Christians are found.

Ver. 51. Great. This is intimated by the plural salutes, "salvations;" as David had experienced innumerable favours. H. --- He speaks of himself in the third person, to lead our minds to the Messias, in whom this was more gloriously accomplished. The greater honour of this chief family of Israel, consisted in giving birth to so great a personage, in whom all are blessed. C.

Isai. xi. 1. Ezec. xxxiv. 23. --- For ever. The true Church will never perish; (H.) God still protecting it, as he did David, v. 48. W.

PSALM 18

PSALM XVIII. (CÆLI ENARRANT.)

The works of God shew forth his glory; his law is to be esteemed and loved.

Ver. 1. David. It is not known when this was composed. David praises the works and law of God. Some passages are applied to Jesus Christ and his apostles, Rom. x. 18. C. --- When any text of a psalm is thus quoted, many judiciously conclude that the whole must be understood in the same sense, as the harmony will thus be greater. It seems there are two literal senses here, one regarding the law, whither natural or Mosaic; the other pertaining to the apostles and the law of the gospel; (Bert.) the "beloved" David of the latter days. W.

Ver. 2. Firmament. Heb. "expansion," or region of the stars, far above our atmosphere. Bert. ---

These two sentences express the same idea, unless the former may denote what we behold, and the firmament be explained of the higher heavens, (H.) where we imagine the throne of God to be placed. Some have taken these expressions in a gross sense, and asserted that the heavens are animated.

Job xxxviii. 7. But we must allow that they are figurative expressions, which seem to give a soul to plants, stars, &c. C. --- The beautiful works of God extort our admiration. H. ---

The silence of heaven speaks louder than any trumpet. S. Chrys. --- "Who can behold the heavens, and yet be so foolish as not to acknowledge that a God exists? said Cicero, (H.) a learned pagan; (Arusp. and Nat. Deo. 2. C.) though they cannot determine of what nature the Deity may be. Leg. i. M. --- Hands.

Chal. "Those who look up at the heavens, publish the glory of the Lord; and those who raise their eyes towards the air, announce his works." C. --- The silent works declare God's Majesty to those who consider them, and his preachers make the same known to their hearers by word of mouth. W. --- S.

Paul reproaches the philosophers of paganism for not understanding the language of the creation. Rom. i. 20. Job xii. 7. H. --- The Church, which is so often styled the kingdom of heaven, makes God known, not only as a Creator, but also as a Redeemer. The figure is here most beautifully preserved. Heaven denotes the Church, as the stars represent apostolic men, who cease not to perform their duties day or night, in happier days as well as under persecution.

Jesus Christ is the true sun of justice, enlightening every man that cometh into the world. S. Jo. i. --- The Fathers have made these remarks. Bert. --- What a consolation must it be for Catholics to think that the true doctrine will never cease, no more than the succession of day and night! We have received our creed, our orders and mission, from the apostles. The chain of succession has never been broken. Unhappy those who make a religion of their own to damn souls! who run, though God send them not! H.

Ver. 3. Utterth, with great force and abundance, eructat. --- Knowledge of God.

Bert. --- Our knowledge is always on the increase. Abenezra. --- The vicissitudes of day and night prove the wisdom of their author. Euseb. - -- They seem to sing in succession the praises of God. Bellarm.

--- This evinces the power of God, as the perpetual propagation of the gospel does that of Jesus Christ, whose Church will last till the end. W.

--- All the chief reformers acknowledged that there was no salvation out of the one true Church, and that the Church of Rome is such. Nightingale, p.

263. H.

Ver. 4. There. Sym. joins this with the preceding. "Will announce knowledge.

Not by words or speeches, the sounds of which are not heard," so as to be understood. H. --- "They are not languages or words, the signification of which is unknown;" or Heb. "never has their voice been heard." Beli, "not," may also signify absque, "without;" and thus we may render, "no speeches, (or country) where their voice has not been heard." Bert. --- The sight of the heavens is sufficient to convince any one of the existence of God. H. --- No nation, however barbarous, can plead ignorance. The Fathers have explained this of the gift of tongues, by means of which the apostles spoke languages which they had not studied. Acts ii. 4. S. Aug. &c. --- Some of every nation have heard, (W.) or will embrace, (H.) the Christian religion. W.

Ver. 5. Sound. So, S. Paul reads this text, though the Heb. have, "line." Yet there is no reason why we should suppose that the Sept. read differently, or that the Jews have corrupted their copies, as they could derive no advantage from so doing (Bert.) here, unless it were to discredit the apostle; as infidels assert the truth of the Old Testament, to vilify the new. Kum (H.) may signify a

"line," (Bert.) or "writing." Abenezra. --- The greatest exactitude has been observed in forming the world, as if all had been measured by an architect. But the sense of the Vulg. is preferable, and is adopted by Sym. S. Jer. and the Syr.

C. --- Prot. "their line." Marg. "their rule or direction." Kolam, "their voice,"

occurs in the preceding verse. The l might easily be lost, (H.) or omitted by a poetical licence. Genebrard. M. --- Their, refers to the heavens

representing the apostles, as S. Paul explains this text, to prove that all were inexcusable who would not believe the gospel. Bert.

Ver. 6. Sun. Here God seems to reside, (Ferrand) and the magnificence of his works shines forth, insomuch that almost all nations have offered divine honours to the sun, and even the Manichees adored it, imagining that it was the very body of Jesus Christ. S. Aug. con. Faust. xiv. 12. and xx.

6. --- Heb. "For the sun he has place a tent in them," the heavens, (S. Jer. H.) or the ends of the world. The Jews supposed that the heavens rested, like a tent, upon the earth. C. Diss. --- The Heb. preposition l, may have (H.) different meanings, ad solem posuit, &c. "He placed a tent in them, at or for the sun."

The idea of the Vulg. is more noble, but we would not exclude the other, which is very good, (Bert.) and obviates the gross mistake of the Manichees. Amama.

--- The Vulg. may admit the fig. hypallage, (M. Geneb.) as good authors say dare classibus austros, and thus it may signify "he placed the sun in his tent."

H. --- This vast body stands in need of no vehicle, or tent, but itself. Diodorus.

--- It was placed in the firmament at first, (Gen. i. 16.) and still performs its revolutions exactly. H. --- Giant. Moderns would render "a strong man;" and Bythner remarks that the bulk of a giant would render him less fit for running, as if the stoutest wrestlers were not often the most active. Bert. --- The sun is represented as a hero at some of the ancient games. S. Aug. and S. Jer.

explain all this of Jesus Christ, who diffuses the light and warmth of his grace throughout the world. C. --- He always resides with the Church, and is never divorced from her. W.

Ver. 7. Circuit. So the Heb. word is rendered "revolution." Sept. and Vulg.

"meeting" occursus, may insinuate that the sun is found in the centre, while the earth moves daily and yearly round it, according to the Copernican system.

But we must be more attentive to the life and motions of Jesus Christ, in whom the Deity resided corporally. Bert.

Ver. 8. The law. As the sun gives light to the world, so the law serves to direct mankind, and is another most powerful motive for us to praise God. This raises our hearts and minds still more perfectly to him, recalling us from our wanderings, and confirming our knowledge. Light is necessary for the body, and the law for the soul. The prophet admires eight characteristics of this divine law, which he designates by different names; as in the 118th ps. some thing relate only to the evangelical law, which converts souls, (Bert.) and lasts for ever. v. 10. H. --- The law of nature and of Moses are nevertheless also commended, (Theod.) inasmuch as the morality is always the same; and some faith in Christ, to come, or already past, is requisite under every dispensation.

Hence he is called the Lamb slain from the beginning. Implicit faith would suffice for the less informed, before our Saviour's coming; but now, under the light of the gospel, we must express our belief in his incarnation, as well as in the blessed Trinity. More is required of those to whom more has been given. H.

--- Unspotted. Heb. and Sept. "irreprehensible." C. ---

Who indeed could pretend to find any fault with it, since it comes from God? H.

--- The laws of men are imperfect, and liable to change. Those of Draco were too sanguinary, and gave place to Solon's, which were deemed too mild, &c.

How happy would all be if they would embrace the law of the gospel!
Bert. ---

Converting. Heb. "tranquillizing souls," (M.) by keeping the passions under. H.

--- Testimony, declaring the will of God to men. --- Little ones. The simple, and the wicked; as both are so called. C. --- Pethi, "easily persuaded." M. --- It directs the former, and keeps the latter in awe by punishment. C. --- All, in general, must confess their ignorance, and want of the divine law, to reap any benefit from it. H. --- This is the first lesson which it imparts.

Bert. --- The law is most pure in itself, whether we understand that given to Moses, or the gospel.

But the latter makes the observers unspotted, by the grace which the Holy Ghost communicates to them, though all who barely read and know the law, have no share in this happiness. God is the author of salvation, sweetly inviting all by the perfections of his law, which confers light and gladness, to co-operate with grace, that they may obtain the promised reward. v. 12. and 2

Tim.

iv. 6. W. --- The like grace was offered from the beginning, so that none will ever be punished who has not deserved it, having had the means to perform his duty. H.

Ver. 9. Justices. The law displays what is just, and renders those who observe it agreeable to God, (S. Greg. Naz.) filling their hearts with joy, by the testimony of a good conscience, and the prospect of felicity. C. Prov. vi. 23.

Ver. 10. Fear; or "the law accompanied with fear;" of which he is speaking. This fear is filial and pure, such as a child must have of displeasing his father. Bert.

--- Yet even servile fear, which restrains us from committing sin, lest we incur punishment, is a gift of God, and prepares the way for charity. Trid. Sess. xiv.

4. But we must not stop here, like Achab and Antiochus. If we understand by fear, the moral law, it will subsist as long as there shall be men. --- Themselves.

Sept. epi to oto, "by that very thing," that they are the judgments of the Lord, (H.) who cannot do wrong. Dan. ii. 27. C. --- Heb. "truth itself, is justified altogether." H. --- Infidels acknowledge that the morality of the Gospel is excellent, but they reject the dogmatical part. Would He, who has prescribed such noble rules of conduct, lead our understanding astray, by requiring us to believe what is false? Bert.

Ver. 11. Stones. So S. Jerom renders the Heb. Prot. "than gold; yea, than much fine gold." Paz (H.) denotes the finest gold of Uphan, or of the Phison; which is probably the river Phasis. Gen.

ii. 11. C. --- Yet many explain this word of the topaz or chrysolite, which is of a golden colour.

The Vulg. expresses topaz, (Ps. cxviii. 127.) where the Sept. have, "a precious stone." ---

Honeycomb, as the English and German versions have it, though the Heb.

signify, "the dropping of the honeycombs;" which is the most excellent honey.

Bert. --- This interpretation is inserted in the Prot. margin, and answers to S.

Jerom's favum redundantem. Nothing can be more delicious, or more magnificent. H.

Ver. 12. For. I speak from experience. C. --- If I had no other inducement, I would observe this law for the consolation, (H.) and repeated advantages which I have derived from it. Theod. ---

Those who keep the same, and content not themselves with reading or hearing only, may feel the same impressions. --- Reward: on which account the prophet declares that he observed the justifications; (Ps. cxviii. 112.) though that passage is corrupted in the Prot. version. W. --- Heb.

"wherefore thy servant shall teach them;" (S. Jer.) or rather, "is instructed by them, and convinced that in keeping them there are frequent falls. Who," &c.

13. C. --- Hekeb may indeed signify "a fall," or tripping up the heels. But it is more commonly rendered "a reward," (as Prot. Mont. &c.

here agree) or end, as 1 Peter (i. 9.) has it. H. --- The instruction, which the observer of the laws obtains, arises from that observance, inasmuch as "he is attentive to them." Sept. phulassei auta.

This must therefore be understood, and is well expressed by Custodit. Taste, and see that the Lord is sweet. Ps. xxxiii. 9. Berthier.

Ver. 13. Sins. Who can always decide when a sin is only venial? H. --- Though I may have avoided the grosser transgressions, how can I be assured that my heart is innocent? C. --- This assurance is reserved for Methodists, who seem to look upon it as essential, before a person can obtain salvation. But where does God specify this condition? We know that (H.) we are to work out our salvation in fear and trembling; and that S. Paul though conscious to himself of nothing said: yet in this I am not justified, &c. 1 Cor. iv. 4. and ix. 27. Phil. ii.

12. Heb. speaks of

"ignorances," which might not however be wholly blameless. Bert. --- Ones, or enemies: "...and from the proud preserve." Sym. Chal. But he alludes to the distinction of sins of ignorance and of pride, (Lev. iv. 2.

Num. xv. 30. C.) or malice. H. --- David had not fallen into many sins of the latter description, though his adultery and murder were such. But the former are daily sins, into which even the just fall frequently. C. --- None can be assured of their state, (Eccles. ix.) but are kept between hope and fear. W.

Ver. 14. Those, &c. Or "from strangers," alienis, whose company we cannot avoid with too much caution. H. --- Heb. "the proud." It is conjectured (Bert.) that the Sept. read r for d, in mizzedim. H. Amama. --- But this is not necessary, as they might include the proud, and all the wicked, under the name of

"strangers," which term is particularly applicable to idolaters, (Isai.

xiii. 11.) and all scandalous sinners, who are strangers to the law; and from whose society and dominion we may all beg to be delivered. Bert. --- Spare.

Heb. "free," (S. Jer.) or "withhold."

Nature is so prone to evil, that the prophet prays earnestly for grace to resist, or to be kept out of danger. H. --- All sins cannot be avoided, but preserve me from wilfully committing any enormous crime. Rivet. --- Deliver me from the devil's power. Theod. --- Those who are in authority have much to dread, lest they be answerable for the sins of others, which they ought to have prevented; as all must fear giving scandal, &c. and so being accessory to another's crime.

H.

--- Delicta aliena affigunt me. S. Aug. --- Yet sins of frailty, and of malice, are here meant; (Bell.) which last ought to be strange, or very uncommon. --- Over me. Sept. mou. H. --- S. Aug. reads dominata, which agrees better with delicta.

If my secret sins, or those of others, do not oppress me, I shall pray with confidence, and be heard. C. --- Yet dominata refers to alienis, strangers, or proud people, (Bert.) who are continually alluring to evil,

both by word and example. How great must be the influence of such over their subjects, when even their equals take the infection so frequently! Vulgate might be rendered,

"If my own had not ruled;" in which sense Pius IV. used this explanation on his death bed, knowing that his kindred had abused their power. Du Thou, B.

vi. A.D. 1549. H. --- Sin, pride; the source of all evil. S. Jer. --- "Let men at last blush to be proud, for whose sake God was humbled." S. Aug. --- If mortal sin be absent, the soul is just, and will be, one day, free from stain. W.

Ver. 15. Always. Heb. "to thy regards," such as thou mayst approve. H. --- He joins mental with vocal prayer, speaking like an evangelist. Bert. --- Helper.

Heb. "rock." C. --- S. Jer. and Prot.

"strength." H. --- Grace is requisite to persevere, as well as to be converted. W.

PSALM 19

PSALM XIX. (EXAUDIAT TE DOMINUS.)

A prayer for the king.

Ver. 1. David. This psalm was to be sung when he or his successors went to battle. In a higher sense, it may allude to the victories of Christ, and of his Church. Bert. --- Christian must offer up this prayer for their governors. W. --- It was probably composed when the Ammonites and Syrians made such great preparations for war, v. 8. and 2 K. x. 6. 18. C.

Ver. 2. Hear thee, the Ruler; or Jesus Christ praying for his people. W. -
--

Tribulation. War is always such. The victors themselves suffer, and many souls perish. C. --- Name. The Messias, as the Jews often explain

the expression, (Hooke, Prin.) or God himself, as others have it. *Nomen ejus ipse*. C. --- The blessed Trinity is all one God. The name of the Lord is a strong tower, &c.

Prov. xviii. 10. It was made known to Moses, to give him confidence. Ex. iii. 13.

H. --- Great was the honour conferred on the patriarchs, that God should be styled the God of Abraham, &c.!

But ours is not less, since we are authorized to call Him Our Father. Bert.

Ver. 3. Sion, where God was supposed to reside, in the tabernacle; though he was also in heaven, v. 7. C.

Ver. 4. Sacrifices. Heb. *mincha*, a sacrifice of flour, or unbloody; a figure of the Mass. W. ---

Minchothec, "thy presents" (Mont. H.) of fruits, &c. --- Fat. Heb. also, "ashes,"

by miraculous fire, (Bert.) to testify God's acceptance; as at the sacrifices of Abel, (H.) Elias, &c. Lev. ix. 24.

and 3 K. xviii. 31. and 1 Par. xxi. 26. God forbade lean victims to be offered, as they might shew a want of respect; (Mal. i. 8.) though he always regards the heart (C.) and faith of the offerer more than the victim. Heb. xi. 4. H. ---

Sacrifices were offered before every important enterprize. 1

K. xiii. 12. C. --- Fat here intimates what would be acceptable. W. Dan. iii. 40. M.

Ver. 5. Counsels. We must suppose that those of a pious prince are right. C. ---

This condition is always understood. H.

Ver. 6. Salvation. Jesus Christ, who gives us the victory over all our spiritual enemies, (C.) or in thy prosperity; (W.) which we shall attribute to God. The first words may also be addressed to Him. We shall rejoice if thou grant us the victory, and we will return thanks. Heb. "we shall praise, or be praised, for thy salvation; and in thy name we shall lift up the standard." C. --- But there is no proof that nodgol, (H.) which occurs nowhere else, has this signification. It is probable that the Sept. read nogdol; and Houbigant adopts their version. S.

Jerom has, "we shall dance." All the versions denote joy. Bert.

Ver. 7. Hath saved. The prophets speak of future events as past. Bert. -- - The people were convinced of God's protection, (C.) and anticipated what they would say at their triumphant return. --- Anointed (Christum) the king, (C.) priest, (W.) or our Saviour, at his resurrection, (S.

Athan.) after he had subdued his enemies. W. --- Powers. That is, in strength.

His right hand is strong and mighty to save them that trust in him. Ch. --- The plural is often used to denote something most excellent, (H.) great strength, or heavenly forces. W.

Ver. 8. Call upon. Sept. Rom. Syr. &c. read, "we shall be exalted,"

megalunthesometha, (C.) as v. 6. Some call upon or trust in chariots, &c. H. ---

Heb. "remember," which often implies to confide, (C.) and such we call upon as we hope will be able and willing (H.) to protect us. Bert.

--- Let our enemies assemble all their forces and auxiliaries, we shall not fear as long as God is for us. C. --- The Jewish kings were forbidden to multiply horses, that they might not be tempted to confide in them. H.

Ver. 9. Bound. Their chariot wheels are entangled. Ex. xiv. 25. C. --- Those who trust in the power of man, fall into captivity. W. --- Their feet are ensnared. Bert.

--- The king. Heb. "Let the king hear us when we call." Prot. (H.) "our king shall hear," &c. Syr. "Word of the Lord, redeem us; Potent king, hear," &c. But the Sept. is preferable, and the best critics often deviate from the Jews; (Muis. C.) though here the sense is very good, and adopted by S. Jerom. God is styled king in Heb. H. --- This title is commonly given to the Messias. Bert. --- The Chal. seems to have had the second person of the blessed Trinity in view, as many of the Jews were acquainted with this mystery, particularly after the propagation of the gospel, when the paraphrase on the psalms was probably composed. H. --- When the head is safe, the body is also preserved. W. - --

We must pray for our superiors, that we also may lead a quiet life. 1 Tim. ii. 2.

Their welfare is for the public good. H.

PSALM 20

PSALM XX. (DOMINE IN VIRTUTE.)

Praise to God for Christ's exaltation after his passion.

Ver. 1. David, after his victory over the Ammonites; (Du Pin. C.) though many passages relate only to the Messias, as the Chaldee and even some of the modern Jews confess, (Kimchi. Muis.) with the holy Fathers, who explain all of Him. C. --- Those who overcome the devil, are here concerned. W.

Ver. 2. King. Chal. adds, "the Messias shall reign; and how shall he rejoice when thou shalt have delivered him!" The people had promised to return thanks in the former psalm. H. --- Christ our king as man, having by his divine power overcome his enemies, rejoiceth. W.

Ver. 3. Will. Heb. aresheth, "the proof or request," (H.) which manifests the will.

The term occurs no where else. Bert. --- Our Saviour's greatest desire was the glory of his Father, (H.) in man's redemption. W.

Ver. 4. Sweetness. Heb. "of goodness," the effects of thy mercy. H. --- Thou hast made David a king according to thy own heart, and granted him victory, and many favours, even before he had asked for them. The humanity of Jesus Christ was still more glorified, (C.) by a gratuitous predestination." S. Aug.

Prædest. 30. Persev. 24. &c. --- Stones. Heb. "fine gold or the topaz."

Ps. xviii. 11. Bert. --- David took the crown of Melchom, weighing a talent. 2 K.

xii. 30. C. ---

God gave him the victory on every occasion. Eccli. xlvii. 7. H. --- He crowned Jesus Christ, the martyrs, and all those who have been ready to suffer for him.

W.

Ver. 5. And ever. David was much favoured, and reigned a long time, as well as his posterity. 2

K. vii. 12. 29. But this was literally verified only in the Messias, (C.) who was his son; (H.) and founded his Church on a rock, to endure unto the end. C. ---

What do we ask for on earth? All will be lost if we have not life; and this we cannot obtain for ever, without rising again. Therefore Jesus said, I am the resurrection and the life. Jo. xi. 25. --- We must live in him by faith, (Bert.) and suffer before we can expect a crown.

Ver. 7. To be, (in benedictionem.) Thou shalt inebriate him with a torrent of thy blessings. H. ---

Blessing shall take hold of him, if we may so speak, (Bert.) and embrace him for ever. H. --- All the saints receive glory. But Christ alone can impart it to others, as all are blessed in him. Gen.

xxi. Jo. i. W. --- When people wish any happiness to their friends, they need only desire that they may be like David. See Gen. xviii. 18. and xlviii 20. Gal. iii.

16. C.

Ver. 9. Thy hand. O king, Messias, or God. No earthly monarch can always punish his enemies.

But none can escape the hand of the Almighty. He will bring all to judgment.

Bert. --- The just approve of God's decree in punishing. This is all a prediction.

W. --- Let thine enemies find thy power, so as to return to good. S. Jer. - -- To find, often means to attack, (Jud. i. 5. and 3 K. xiii.

24.) or to accomplish with ease. Deut. xxxiii. 1.

Ver. 10. Anger. Lit. "face;" (vultus. H.) which sometimes intimates favour, v. 7.

This passage may allude to the vengeance (C.) which David exercised upon the Ammonites, whom he burnt in kilns, (2 K. xii. 31. Geier. Vat.) or to the destruction of Sodom. Gen. xix 28. Lam. iv. 6. C. ---

It is a terrible thing to fall into the hands of an angry God, who will punish his enemies in a fire; to which S. Paul (Heb. x. 27.) attributes rage, (H.) or emulation, as it will seem to strive to surpass all others. O that we may meditate on this fire! that the love of God may consume all our defects! ---

Trouble. Heb. "swallow up;" which is more energetic.

Ver. 11. Fruit of the womb, or all their possessions. The family of Herod was presently extirpated. Bert. --- The works of the wicked must burn. S. Aug. ---

The severity shewn to the Ammonites was perhaps without example, v. 10. C.

--- But this will be more fully verified in the judgment of the wicked, whose schemes against Christ and his Church will fail. W.

Ver. 12. Intended. Heb. "turned aside," like a torrent. The Ammonites had violated the law of nations, and had attempted to raise up very powerful enemies to invade David. C. --- Establish.

Hebrew leaves thee sentence imperfect, to shew the utter weakness or impotence of God's enemies. Bert.

Ver. 13. In thy remnants thou shalt prepare their face: or thou shalt set thy remnants against their faces. That is, thou shalt make them see what punishment remain for them hereafter from thy justice. Instead of remnants, S.

Jerom renders it funes, that is cords or strings: viz. of the bow of divine justice, from which God directs his arrows against their faces;" (S. Jer.) or

"thou wilt prepare thy arrows on thy bow-strings, " &c. But as bemetharic (H.) may also have the sense of the Vulg. in thy remnants, we need not abandon this version; as it implies that after God shall have put his enemies to flight, he will turn their faces to receive "the last" of his arrows or blows; (Bert.) or He will meet them everywhere. H. --- There seems to be some transposition in Heb.

and the Vulg. as if we should read in reliquis eorum præparabis vultum tuum.

"Thou wilt execute thy vengeance upon their children;" (C.) or, as this transposition is unnecessary, "thou shalt make them look at thy

children;" (H.) the elect, to increase their rage. Bellar. Jans. --- To behold the glory of the just, which might so easily have been their own, will greatly mortify the reprobate at the last day. H.

Ver. 14. Exalted. God can receive no increase; but he manifests what he has.

Theod. --- Power.

Lit. "powers." H. --- While the wicked perish, the just sing God's praises. W. ---

We must beg that the kingdom of righteousness may spread over the world, (H.) and never cease to acknowledge the divine favours. Bert.

PSALM 21

PSALM XXI. (DEUS DEUS MEUS.)

Christ's passion: and the conversion of the Gentiles.

Ver. 1. Protection, susceptione. Heb. ayeleth, hathuchar, or "for a speedy interposition," or succour. See v. 2. 20. 25. --- S. Jer. "the morning stag." H. ---

Many of the titles are almost inexplicable, and this is one of the most puzzling; (C.) but is of no service to understanding the psalm, which certainly speaks of Jesus Christ, as the apostles have quoted several texts, and Theodorus of Mopsuesta was condemned for asserting that it was only accommodated to him.

Conc. v. col. 4. Bert. --- Grotius comes too near this system, by explaining it of Christ only in a figurative sense. We ought to do quite the reverse, if we allow that some verses regard David, as a figure of the Messias; (C.) or rather, as the same person speaks throughout, we must understand the whole of Him. Bert.

t. ii. --- The Jews were formerly of the same opinion, (Lyran) but seeing the use which was made of this psalm by Christians, they have

explained it of David, or of the miseries of the nation. Sept. seem to intimate that this psalm was sung at the morning service, (C.) or referred to the coming, or resurrection of our Saviour, (S. Aug. W. Ps. iii. 6. M.) after the long night of infidelity. Didymus.

--- He is represented as the hart, or beautiful hind, whom the Jews hunted unto death, v. 17. Some band of musicians might be styled, after "the morning hind," as another seems to be after "the mute dove;" (Ps. lv.) and the wine presses, or "band of Geth;" (Ps. viii. &c.) though we cannot pretend to give a reason for these titles. Many, who are unwilling to confess their ignorance, say that these terms allude to some musical instrument, or favourite song, &c. C.

--- It would be as well to speak plainly that these things are hidden from us. H.

Ver. 2. O God. Our Saviour repeated these words as they are in Heb. though the vulgar tongue was Syriac, (C.) or Greek mixed with the Abamean. Paulus.

--- Eli (or Eloï. S. Mark) lamma sabacthani. So he pronounced what the Jews would now read, Eli...lama (or lamach. T.) hazabtani; (C.) and in our method, ali...lome azbocthani. But it must be admitted (H.) that the true pronunciation is irretrievably lost. The Masorets vary from the ancient versions, (Masclef.

Capel. Houb. Mr. C. Butler. Hor. Bib. 4 edit. p. 69.) and from one another; so that after being at the immense labour of learning their rules, we shall be no more secure of attaining the truth. H.

--- It were, therefore, greatly to be wished that the learned would agree about some characters to express uniformly the Hebrew in modern languages, as it would greatly facilitate the knowledge of the sacred writings. Kennicott. Diss. i.

p. 243. --- We have only attempted to use such as might inform the reader what letters were in the original; and yet we are sorry to find that z, or the long á and é are often printed without the mark above;

which shews the inconvenience of so many points, introduced by the Masorets. H. --- Look upon me, are words admitted by Christ,

"because (says Eusebius) they are not in Heb." But this reason is not conclusive, as he might have left them out, though they were in the original.

The Sept. may have rendered one ali, in this sense, "to me," as they have not added my to the first mention of God: or, they may have anticipated from v. 20

(Bert.) this explication. Christ speaks with reference to his sacred humanity, as his divinity suspended its beatific influence, that he might drink the bitter chalice.

Theod. S. Jer. --- He also speaks the language of his afflicted members, who think they are abandoned. S. Aug. C. --- Sins. That is, the sins of the world, which I have taken upon myself, cry out against me, and are the cause of all my sufferings. Ch. --- An ancient psalm of S. Germ.

reads "lips," instead of sins. Heb. "roaring." S. Jer. C. --- "Prayer," Sixt. Edit.

"Why art thou so far from helping me, and from the words of my roaring?"

Prot. H. --- the Sept. seem to have read shagathi, whereas the Heb. places the g after the a, or they have substituted the cause for the effect; as sin was certainly the cause of Christ's affliction, and of his Father's not granting present relief. Indeed our Saviour did not ask for it, but only expressed the sentiments of suffering nature, which he corrected by the most perfect submission, to teach us how to behave. Bert. ---

God is the God of all creatures, but more particularly of Christ, by personal union. W. --- The latter tenderly expostulates, (H.) that he is not comforted like other saints, (Mat. xxvii. 64.) since he had undertaken to die for the sins of the world, and reputed them as his own. W. --- Delicta nostra sua delicta fecit, ut justitiam suam nostram

**justitiam faceret. S. Aug. --- He speaks in the name of his members. S.
Tho. 3. p. q. 15. a 1. --- Christ could commit no sin: (1 Pet. ii.**

21. and 2

Cor. v. 21.) but as long as he had taken our iniquities upon himself, to expiate with his own blood, he could not be at ease till he had perfected the work.

David was convinced that his own sins were punished by the rebellion of Absalom, as Nathan had declared. 2 K. xii. 10. C.

Ver. 3. Folly. My cry proceeds not from impotent rage. Lu. iv. 28. Euseb. Agel.

M. --- I know that thou wilt grant my request. C. --- I shall not cry in vain.

Theodor. --- It is not for my own folly that I suffer. Geneb. --- "Many cry and are not heard, yet it is for their advantage, and not out of folly." S. Aug. --- Christ prayed on the cross, as he had done in the garden, to have the bitter chalice removed. But this was not blameable, as it was done with entire submission.

W. ---

The cry of the lips, or of human nature, which would be free from suffering, was not heard: (H.) because the cry of the heart, which desired that the justice of God should be satisfied, was much louder; and this petition was granted by Him who denied nothing to his Son. Jo. xi. 41. C. --- This should be our model.

Submission and perseverance will always be crowned. Heb. has now d instead of r, in the word dumiya, "silence," which is also good; "there is no silence for me." In the night (Bert.) of death, (H.) God granted the petition. Bert. --- Aquila gives this idea, non tacebis, as S. Jerom observes: "thou wilt do what I desire." Heb. may also mean: I have no rest, or I cry incessantly. C. --- The prayer of Christ for relief, was

conditional. He absolutely desired God's will to be accomplished, and thus he was heard, v. 25. Heb. v. 7. He was our pattern.

S.

Aug. ep. 120. W.

Ver. 4. In the, &c. Heb. "the Holy one inhabitest the praises of Israel," or "Thou holy, sancte, inhabitant, the praise," (S. Jer.) or, as the plural intimates, the source and object of all "the praises of Israel," (H.) and of the Church. W. ---

This may be connected with the preceding, or following verse. Thou art in the midst of us, so that thou canst not be ignorant of my situation, like the idols; or thou hast shewn great favours to our ancestors, v. 5. Theodoret and S.

Jerom seem to take these words to be addressed by the Father or by the prophet to Jesus Christ, who inhabited a body so free from sin. C.

Ver. 6. Confounded. He interests his Father, by calling to mind the ancient patriarchs, (Ecclus. ii.

11. Bert.) who obtained their requests. W.

Ver. 7. No man. Heb. ish, "a great man," vir, (Mont.) so far from being treated as a nobleman, I am not even respected as one of the meanest of men, (adam.) H. --- "Why not a man?" says S.

Aug. "because he is God. Why a worm? because a mortal, born of the flesh, without generation."

The ancient naturalists supposed that worms were not generated; and though this be now deemed inaccurate, the Fathers applied this notion to confirm the doctrine of our Saviour's being born of a virgin, which had been clearly revealed. C. --- People. God afforded Christ no exterior (H.) or common consolation, while the wicked persecutors treated him as a worm. W. --- The rights of humanity are respected in

the greatest criminals. But the enemies of our Lord added insult to torments. Isai. lii. 14. Bert. --- It would be difficult to apply this to David. For even in the depth of his misery, when reviled by Semei, and dishonoured by Absalom, he was attended by the priests, and by a powerful army. C.

Ver. 8. All. This often denotes only the greatest number. S. Jer. --- For surely the blessed Virgin, and some others, must be excepted. H. --- But almost all joined in persecuting Christ, (W.) while his disciples left him. C. --- These two verses are quoted by the three first evangelists. ---

Spoken. Heb. "opened or distorted." Bert. --- "They shoot out the lip." Prot. ---

These signs and expressions (H.) mark the greatest contempt, v. 14. Job xvi. 4.

&c.

Ver. 9. He hoped. Heb. "roll, or he (C.) rolled himself on the Lord." Prot. margin.

--- But the text is conformable to ours. "He trusted on," &c. S. Matt. xxvii. 43.

He trusted in God, let him deliver him now if he will have him. Ci, which is here rendered quoniam, "since," (H.) may also mean "if," as it is in the Prot. marg.

Thus both texts agree. Many passages are thus quoted, without adding, as it is written. Bert. --- God permitted that these blasphemers should use the very language of the prophet, that the completion of what he said might be more conspicuous.

Chal. "I have sung praises to the Lord, and he has withdrawn me from danger."

This explanation is not contemptible. C. --- But it is foreign to the context, and to all the other versions, as well as to the evangelists. H. --- The collating of this psalm with the history of Christ, must convince every sincere person that he who was thus ignominiously treated, was the object of God's complacency, and that the Christian religion is true. Bert.

Ver. 10. Womb. David might say this as a figure of Christ, in consequence of the many favours which he had received. Theodoret. C. --- But none could use these expressions with propriety, but Jesus Christ, who had no man for his father, and who had the perfect use of reason, so that he could call God his God from the very first. All others are born children of wrath, except the blessed Virgin, whose privilege was still the fruit of redemption. Bert. --- She conceived and bore her son, remaining a pure virgin. Euseb. S. Athan. &c. ---

The synagogue rejected the Messias, but God received him, and made him head of the Church. S. Aug.

Ver. 11. Cast. This custom is noticed, (Gen. xxx. 3.) and frequently in Homer.

Thou art my only Father, (C.) as I am born miraculously, and have been hitherto protected. I now suffer death, but thou wilt raise me to life again. Ps.

xv. 9. W.

Ver. 12. Help. This Christ might say a little before he expired, foreseeing the distress of his Church, (C.) or he might use these words in his agony; (S. Jer.) as this agrees with the sequel. C.

--- Almost all have abandoned me; and those who would, are not able to protect me. W.

Ver. 13. Calves. The insolent Jews and soldiers. --- Bulls. The more inveterate enemies, the priests and Pharisees. S. Aug. &c. --- Heb.

"strong bulls of Basan," (Prot.) a fertile country east of the Jordan, where the finest cattle were found. Amos iv. 1. C.

Ver. 14. As, is supplied by all the versions. Bert.

**Ver. 15. Water, in the agony, or on the cross, fainting away. Jos. vii. 5. --
-**

Bones. In extreme pain, (C.) they have been dislocated. H. --- The bones signify the apostles, who were scattered through the world, to propagate the gospel.

S. Aug. --- Heart. Which lives and dies first, is now like wax in the fire. W.

Ver. 16. Jaws. So that he said, I thirst. Bert. W. --- He would answer Pilate nothing in his own vindication. --- Death. The region of blessed spirits, (S. Jer.) or into the grave, where other bodies turn to dust. C.

Ver. 17. Dogs. The pagan soldiers, who were instigated by the Jews, (Matt. xv.

26. C.) or the latter are here styled dogs, as they are by S. Paul. Phil. iii. 2. S.

Jer. --- The evangelists could scarcely have explained the authors, and manner of our Saviour's death more particularly; so that we might entitle this "the Passion of Jesus Christ, according to David." W. --- Dug. The Jews have here, and God knows in how many other places, corrupted their text; reading "like a lion,"

though it have no sense, to avoid so clear a prophecy. W. --- They deep cari in the text, though it (Amama) or the margin had formerly the proper reading, caru. The Chal. has both, "they have bitten like a lion," &c. in some editions only; which shews the antiquity of this variation, (H.) as the author, Joseph the blind, is supposed to have lived in the 4th century, though this is uncertain.

C. --- All the ancient versions of the Sept. Syr. &c. agree with us, as the Prot. do likewise. Even the Masora intimates that cari has not here the sense "of like a lion," as it has Isai. xxxviii. 13; and, though it might be pointed so as to signify the same as caru, they have rejected that punctuation, and obstinately maintain their reading, in opposition to many MSS. seen by Ben.

Chaim, &c. Bert. --- Kennicott mentions another MS. in the Bod. Lib. which has caru, with cari in the margin; and observes that Dr. Pocock, nevertheless, maintains the accuracy of the Heb.

edit. in this, as well as in every other instance, asserting that car is perfodit, and cari the part.

Benoni, perfodientes, with the m omitted. "But as this omission is very irregular, and never proper but before a suffixed pronoun, or in construct.; and as the ancient versions express it...as a verb, there seems to be but little doubt that this word was originally cru or caru, with an a inserted to express the kametz." Dis. 1. p. 500. The proposed interpretation would be rejected by the Jews, while they would exult in their error being countenanced by us. C. Diss.

--- This reason is perhaps (H.) weak, as their conversion is not expected; if by means of it, the Heb. Bible may be reconciled with the versions; "the council...hath besieged me, digging my hands." Bert.

--- But this expedient is at least doubtful; (H.) suggested only by Prot. who maintained the integrity of the Heb. text, which is now given up; and the Jews seem inexcusable, though the variation might originally arise (C.) from a mistake of transcribers. Houbig. --- They ought not to have rejected caru even from the margin, which they confess was once in the text, as it is still in very correct copies. Drusius informs us that a Jew threatened Bomberg, when he designed to adopt this correction, that if he did, he would prevent any of his brethren from purchasing a single copy. The pusillanimity of Christians, and the obstinacy of the Jews, keep therefore the text in its present state. Amama, p. 461. --- Ximenes had the courage to insert caru in his Polyglot. C. ---

In the edition of S. Jerom, 1533, caru appears indeed in the margin; as he translated fixerunt,

"they pierced," and cru in that of Mont. with o over cari, perhaps as a sing that the former was formerly in the margin, or should be translated, as it is by Pagnin, foderunt; though Mont. alters it for circumdederunt me, sicut leo manus meas, in obedience to the Jews. H. --- Thus we behold what dissensions the alteration of a single u or i may occasion; (Ps. xv. 10.) and yet these are letters which the Jews seem to have treated with little ceremony, (H.) changing in 100 instances, (C.) or omitting them, since the introduction of the vowel points; (Houbig.) and they are so easily mistaken, that the greatest attention is requisite to make the distinction. However, one jot or one tittle shall not pass of the law till all be fulfilled. Matt. v. 18. H. See Zac. xii. 10.

Ver. 18. They. Heb. "I shall or may tell all my bones," (C.) they are so dislocated. H. --- Syr.

"my bones have howled," as in mourning. C. --- Upon me, out of contempt, (Eus.) or to prevent my escape, (Orig.) or deriding my naked condition. M. ---

David experienced nothing of the kind. S. Justin. apol. ii.

Ver. 19. Vesture, or inner garment, which was all of a piece. C. --- The soldiers perceived that it would be rendered unserviceable by cutting. H. --- "Heretics attempt to divide the Church, but in vain." S. Jer. --- Lots. This was verified above 100 years afterwards, in the person of Jesus Christ. Bert. --- Let the Jews shew how it was accomplished in David. They assert themselves that nothing which had belonged to their kings was used by others. Their thrones, garments, &c.

were all burnt. Maimon. &c. --- Though this be doubtful we may employ this testimony against them. C. --- At Siceleg the effects of David were indeed plundered; but David was absent, and not under torments, like the person here described. Our goods must be divided, either before of after death. Let us be solicitous to obtain the second covering, which may never be taken from us. 2

Cor. v. 4. Bert.

Ver. 20. Thy help. So some editions of the Sept. read, but S. Jer. approves "my help," as it is in the Com. edit. conformably to the Heb. (C.) which seems more animated, though the sense is the same. Bert. --- The humanity here addresses the divine nature, to obtain a speedy resurrection. S.

Jer. --- Heb. "O, my strength, haste thou to help me." What is man when left to himself! The whole of a spiritual life consists in keeping close to God, and being convinced of our own infirmity. Bert.

Ver. 21. Dog. All my enemies are united to persecute me, in my desolate condition. Unicum meum, "my desolate one, " the soul, which is the only thing which ought to fix our attention; since if we lose it, all is lost. This only one, self, is often, however, the most dangerous enemy. Bert.

Ver. 22. Lowness. This sense appears to be preferable to the Heb. "hear me from," &c. C. --- Yet some who render the orig. literally have, "save me from the throat of the lion, and from the horns of the unicorns; thou hast heard me."

This seems very striking, as Christ henceforth recounts the glorious effects of his sufferings. The Sept. have explained hanithani as a noun, though it properly signifies, thou hast heard, or humbled. Bert. --- They may not have read the last n. C.

--- Yet S. Jer. has, exaudisti me, "thou hast granted my request." H.

Ver. 23. Brethren. So Christ styles his disciples, principally (C.) after his resurrection. Matt.

xxviii. 10. Jo. xx. 17. Heb. ii 11. S. Paul quotes this passage, which may convince us that this psalm relates to our Saviour alone; and he informs us, that we are brethren of Christ, because we spring from Adam, (Bert.) and are adopted by God: whence the apostles assume the title of children of God, after baptism. Rom. viii. 15. and 29. Eph. i. 5. C. --- We are willing to be coheirs with Christ, but dislike the condition.

Rom. viii. 17. --- Church. This he will never cease to do. After the resurrection, he communicated many instructions to his apostles, which all tend to honour God. H. --- S. Aug. here refutes the Donatists, who pretended that God's church was confined to a small part of Africa, and that he had abandoned the Catholic Church. He shews that this conduct would be injurious to God, and contrary to his solemn promises, as well as to this prediction, which speaks of all, and of a great Church, praising and fearing Him, v. 24. 26. 28.

and 29. The Church can, therefore, neither be destroyed nor hidden, though it may be persecuted.

It will always be great, in comparison of any separate congregation which may pretend to the truth; and this appears not only with respect to the Donatists, but also to the Lutherans, &c. W.

Ver. 24. Fear. Thus the Gentile converts are designated. Acts x. 2. 35. and xiii.

16. 26.

Ver. 25. Israel. This may be something more general, as all the holy nation went under this name. --- Supplication. Heb. also, "the lowliness of the afflicted."

Bert. --- When I. Heb. Chal.

and Syr. "he," (C.) Jesus, of whom the prophet speaks; (Bert.) though, according to the Vulg. He speaks himself which seems more agreeable to the context. H.

Ver. 26. Great Church; the Catholic Church, dispersed throughout the world, in which many adore God in spirit and truth. S. Jer. --- Here Jesus Christ praises his Father by the mouth of his priests and faithful, in whom the spirit works.

Heb. "From thee shall proceed my praise," in the great Church. C. --- Prot.

"congregation." H. --- The Vulg. may have the same meaning, as the desire to praise comes from God. The Church which Jesus founded immediately after his resurrection, to pay his vows, must last unto the end; otherwise this service would be interrupted.

This can only be verified in the Catholic Church, as she alone can prove her uninterrupted existence. She alone is spread throughout the earth, united under the same pastors, and partaking of the same sacraments. If the Church failed after three or four centuries, the vows of Christ must have ceased. Yet he assures us, that he will pay them as long as his kingdom shall continue, v.

29.

--- Fear him. Houbigant would substitute "thee." This change of persons is however very proper and remarkable, as Christ no longer addresses his Father, but gives a description of the worship which should be exhibited in his Church. Bert. --- The eucharistic sacrifice is the vow here specified, which Christ offers by his priests daily. It is the only sacrifice of the new law, and the most perfect means of acknowledging God's supreme dominion, &c. S. Aug. S.

Jer. &c. C.

Ver. 27. Poor. Heb. hanavim, means also, "quiet and modest men," such as our Saviour calls poor in spirit. Mat. v. 3. These alone ought to partake of the holy sacraments. H. --- The psalmist may allude to the feasts prescribed by the law, (Deut. xii. 7. and xxvi. 11.) and imitated in the love-feasts of the primitive Christians. The sacrifices of thanksgiving were symbols of that of the blessed Eucharist, of which the Fathers explain this text. Theod. S. Aug. &c. C. ---

Indeed, as it speaks of the times of the new law, this must be the meaning. H.

--- It describes that part of the Christian worship, which consists in participating of those sacred mysteries which give life to the humble and worthy receiver. Jo. vi. Prot. explain this eating, to mean "instruction."

But that may be given any where; and the psalmist alludes to the public service, which is to be performed in the midst of the Church. Calmet would understand it of David, and of the sacrifices of the old law: which throws all into confusion. Bert. --- The apostles clearly refer the text to Jesus Christ, who promised to institute the blessed Eucharist, after he had fed the multitudes, (Jo.

vi.) and he fulfilled his promise at the last supper. S. Aug. ep. cxx. 27. --- This holy doctor observes, that the rich, or the fat ones, have eaten and have adored, (v. 30.) but yet are not filled, because they disdain to be humble. He speaks not of mere bread and wine, which cannot be lawfully adored; not of Christ's body on the cross, or in heaven, which "is not eaten, but as it is in the forms of bread and wine on Christ's table, the altar." W. --- Those who approach unworthily sign their own condemnation, which they bear about in their bodies. H. --- Their. Heb. "your,"

though S. Jer. Chal. Syr. &c. agree with us. The sense is the same. My friends shall partake of the victims in abundance, after my restoration. "But the text is more naturally explained of the food...which we receive in the blessed Eucharist," and which imparts life eternal. The strong may partake, but they must first become mean in their own eyes. C. --- The faithful and humble only derive benefit from this great sacrament. Its effect is a glorious resurrection in eternal life. W. ---

The sounder Prot. maintain that Christ is to be adored "in the symbols, before receiving."

Thorndike. See Ans. to Slack, p. 14.

Ver. 28. Remember. Our Saviour says, Do this in remembrance of me. H. --- We must recollect what Christ has suffered and done for us, what was the condition of the world at his coming, and what the behaviour of his first disciples. These reflections will surely fill our breasts with love, admiration, and shame. The first Christians met together to break bread, they preached to word, and brought many to the faith. Bert. --- We cannot explain this of David, except in a very exaggerated sense. But all is clear if we understand it of Jesus Christ, whose faith many nations have embraced, assembling to celebrate his sacred mysteries, and the festivals of his birth, &c. C.

--- The Gentiles shall enter into themselves, when they shall hear his doctrine, and embrace the true religion. W. --- In his. Heb. "in thy." The sense is the same. The German version follows the Vulg. which Houb. also approves. Bert.

Ver. 29. Nations. God placed David on the throne. He caused both Jews and Gentiles to submit to Jesus Christ. Matt. xxviii. 18. Rom. iii. 29. Theod.

Ver. 30. Fat ones. Many ancient psalters read, "the rich," which is the true sense. --- Adored.

This may be take as a prediction. C. --- Heb. is in the future, "they shall," &c.

Bert. --- The rich of this world have no relish for the sacred nourishment. C. ---

Those who understand, and comply with their duty, amid the riches with which they are not possessed, but only surrounded, find the greatest comfort in participating of it along with their poorest brethren, who may be equal, or superior to them, in the eyes of the common judge. The original dishnim, (H.) comes from a root, which signifies to reduce a victim to ashes, in testimony of approbation. It may here designate priests, as well as the rich, and princes. ---

Earth. Dying, (Bert.) or to manifest their adoration in the Church. Euseb. --- All shall adore Jesus Christ, particularly those who receive his sacred body at the hour of death. Heb. "who go down to the dust." H.

Ver. 31. Shall. Heb. "and his soul he will not vivify," which give no distinct meaning. Some join it with the preceding, All shall adore...yet he will not restore him to life. The living alone shall be able to sound forth God's praises, as it is often observed. Ps. vi. 6. Isai. xxxviii. 18. C. --- Chal.

"the Lord will not give life to the wicked; but the race of Abraham shall praise him." Others again explain it of Jesus Christ, "because he has not spared his life," he shall see a long-lived seed (Isai. liii. 10.) in the Church, which shall praise him for ever. H. --- V. sometimes signifies

"because," and though it is not clear that it has this meaning here, the explication is very beautiful. None of the Greek versions admit the negation.

They agree with the Vulg.; only Theod. reads, "his soul;" making the prophet speak instead of the Messiah. It is suspected that the Sept. read i instead of u, and lu for la. The Masorets acknowledge 15 places in which this change would be proper. The learned observe many more. Thus 1 Par. xi. 20. in Heb. we read that Abisai had "no (la) name among the three;" whereas it ought to be the reverse, (lu) ei nomen inter tres, "he was renowned," &c. Bert. --- S. Jerom agrees with the present Heb. "and his soul shall not live." Prot. "and none can keep alive his own soul." Sym. "whose soul shall live, and seed shall serve him." H. --- "The Messiah shall live for God, and his posterity shall serve him,"

(Bert.) as the faithful shall never cease to be influenced by his spirit, to testify their gratitude. H.

Ver. 32. To, or by the Lord, who opened the mouths of the prophets to foretell the propagation of the Christian Church. C. --- Prot. "It shall be accounted to the Lord for a generation: They shall come and shall declare," &c. H. ---

Heavens is added by the Vulg. to shew that the apostles, who are styled the heavens, (Ps. xviii.) shall proclaim these things. Bert. --- Sept. &c. omit this word, as well as many Latin copies. One generation shall deliver the true doctrine to another, as long as the world shall last. C. -- - Which. Heb. ci has this sense, (Bert. Gen. iv. 25,) whom Cain slew, as all the versions agree, and S. Jerom renders quem fecit. H. --- Yet many translate, "that he hath done these things, " (Bert.) delivering me from danger, and raising the Messiah to life again, &c.

C. --- Thus Jesus foretold, with his dying breath, the glory with should always be given to his Father, in his true Church. Bert. --- This is the generation which should be honoured with the title of children of God, and of Christ, (H.) and should partake of his sacraments. M.

PSALM 22

PSALM XXII. (DOMINUS REGIT ME.)

God's spiritual benefits to faithful souls.

Ver. 1. David. This psalm most beautifully describes the consolation which the just find in God's protection. H. --- It may be applied to the Israelites in the desert, (Chal.) to David persecuted by Saul, or rather C. settled quietly upon the throne, (Muis.) or to the Jews returned from Babylon.

S. Athan. C. --- The Fathers explain it mystically of Jesus Christ, the Shepherd of our souls.

Didymus, S. Aug. &c. The allegories of a shepherd and of a person giving a feast to his guests, are well supported. C. --- Ruleth, in Heb. Is my shepherd; viz. to feed, guide, and govern me.

Ch. --- Sept. poimainei, pascit, as S. Aug. and S. Jer. read. S. Greg.

Thaumaturgus understands this of the angel guardian. Paneg. in Orig. ---

Jesus Christ conducts us into the pastures of his Church, and feeds us W.

with his own body, &c. C. --- The saints never complain of want. Bert.

Ver. 2. Place. Mont. "in the huts of grass, (or of young trees, germinis) he will make me lie down." See Cant. i. 6. Ezech. xxxiv. 15. H. --- Shepherds were accustomed to conduct their flocks to shady places, during the heat of the day. --- Refreshment. Heb. "still waters," like the pond of Siloe, (Is. viii. 6.) in opposition to the great streams of the Euphrates, &c. The fathers understand it of baptism; (S. Chrys. &c.) or of the truths of salvation. Euseb. C. --- Baptism is the first justification. W.

Ver. 3. Converted. Prot. "restoreth my soul" (H.) to her former tranquility, or bringeth me back from my wanderings. Bert. --- Justice. Those who have received baptism, must observe the law of Christ, (W.) as all indeed are bound to do. H. --- Sake. Not on account of man's deserving (C.) by the force of nature. God must begin and carry on the work of our conversion, by his grace; with which we must co-operate. H. --- The captives had been in the greatest distress among idolaters. They rejoice at the sight of the promised land, where they will fear no dangers. C.

Ver. 4. Walk. In the greatest temptations, we may resist by God's grace. W. ---

Midst. Heb. "in the valley." The greatest darkness, and the most horrible precipices, give no alarm to those who are under God's protection. ---

Comforted me, as they have kept all enemies at a distance. The shepherd's staff or crook is designed for that purpose; and though it may be used to bring back the wandering sheep by beating them, yet it is not under that idea an object of consolation, but rather of terror. C. - -- The effects of timely correction are, however, comfortable; and it is a great mercy of God to chastise the sinner, lest he should run astray to his eternal ruin. H. --- Some distinguish the rod from the staff, and say that the former is to punish, and the latter to support. S. Jer. Muis.

--- We are generally too backward in having recourse to God in our distresses, though he invites us so pressingly. Isai. xli. 10, &c.

Ver. 5. Thou. Here the allegory of a shepherd seems less discernible, though it may allude to the provisions for winter; (Bert.) or rather it ceases, as feasts are made for men; (M.) and the second allegory of a guest here commences. H. ---

The enemy had reduced me to the greatest misery. C.

--- But God has admitted me to his table. M. --- This may be explained of the sacred mysteries received in the Church, (S. Amb.) or of the

Scriptures, which nourish our souls. S. Jer. --- No mention is made of the ancient sacrifices; and as this psalm must be understood in the spiritual sense, the prophet speaks of the blessed Eucharist, which imparts the unction of grace, &c. The enemy strives to make us keep at a distance from it. Bert. --- Christ has himself prepared this table (S. Cyp. ep. 63. Euthym.) against all spiritual adversaries.

--- Oil. Christians are also strengthened by the sacraments of confirmation, penance, holy orders, matrimony, and extreme unction. W. --- Three of these are administered with oil. H. --- It was customary to anoint the head of guests with perfumes, (Matt. xxvi. 6. Lu. vii. 46.) both among the Jews and Gentiles.

But the Fathers explain this text of chrism, used in confirmation. S. Athan.

Theod. C. ---

Chalice. The blessed sacrament and sacrifice of Christ's body and blood. W. ---

Inebriateth.

Heb. "overflowing;" being constantly replenished (Cant. vii. 2. Iliad iv.) with wine; as people are not inebriated with water. This term, however, only means to take as much as is requisite. Gen.

xliii. 34. "Thy chalice inebriating me," occurs in most copies of the Sept. in Sixtus V. &c. But the more correct editions of the Sept. and all the Greek interpreters, (S. Jer. ep. ad Sun.) agree with the Heb. and Vulg. --- How, &c. is added by way of explanation; or rather, the Sept. have taken two words from the following verse, *ac tob, verumtamen bonum*. C. --- Prot. "surely goodness and mercy," &c. H. --- Theodotion and Sym. were not acquainted with this division, which seems less accurate, though the sense be much the same.

Bert.

Ver. 6. Follow me, like provisions from the king's table. 2 K. xi. 8. C. --- "The grace of God prevents the unwilling to make him willing; and it follows the person who is in good dispositions, that they may not be in vain." S. Aug.

Ench. 32. --- Prævenit per fidem, subsequitur in custodiendo mandata Dei. S.

Jer. Continual and final perseverance is a special grace of God. W.

--- And that. Heb. "and I shall." The Vulg. expresses the effect of worthy participation of God's table, which leads to a happy eternity. Bert. --- This is particularly applicable to priests, both of the old and of the new law. C. --- Only those who remain in the house of God, in his church on earth, can expect felicity. H. --- Days, in eternal life. W. --- David always desired to be near the ark, (Ps. xxvi. and lxxxiii. M.) as the figure of heaven. H.

PSALM 23

PSALM XXIII. (DOMINI EST TERRA.)

Who they are that shall ascend to heaven: Christ's triumphant ascension thither.

Ver. 1. Week. This title was found only in the common edition of the Sept.

Theod. --- The Jews say the psalm was used on Sunday; (Bert.) and the Fathers explain it of the resurrection and ascension of our Lord, whom it regards in the more sublime sense, though it may also be literally explained of the temple, or translation of the ark, 2 K. vi. 12. C. --- David appointed when the psalms were to be sung. Eccli. xlvii. 12. This speaks of the creation. M. --- S.

Paul applies the first verse to Jesus Christ, whom he styles the Lord, (1 Cor. x.

26.) and Creator, of whom David speaks. It is wonderful that so few have noticed this excellent proof of Christ's divinity. The authors of *Principles Discussed*, according to their general system of two literal senses, explain this psalm of the re-establishment of the Jews after the captivity, and of the propagation of the Christian Church; and it is not clear that two senses ought not to be admitted. But we must, at least, admit that the prophet speaks literally of Jesus Christ (Bert.) as well as of the ark, &c. ---

Therein. Though God be the Creator of all, he seems to have made a particular choice of Sion.

Before the coming of Christ, all, except a few Jews (C.) and enlightened Gentiles, like Job, (H.) were buried in sin and ignorance. But now his kingdom is propagated widely; and in every place the Father is adored in spirit and in truth. S. Aug. &c. --- All power is given to Jesus Christ, who rose again on the first day of the week. Not only the earth, but all that is in it, belongs to the great Creator. W.

Ver. 2. Founded, or created it (Bert.) upon (Heb. hal. "above, in, near, to, with,"

&c.; Amama) the seas, like a floating island. Prov. viii. 29. Jon. ii. 7. Job xxxviii.

11. This was the language of the ancients: *Ipsa natat tellus Pelagi lustrata coronâ*. Manil. Astr. 4. The earth was at first covered with water. Gen. i. 9. Ps.

ciii. 6. C. --- Seas and caverns have received part of it, which was poured out again at the deluge. Several have rejected the antipodes, falsely supposing that there is water all under the earth, which the Scripture does not assert.

Amama. H.

Ver. 3. Place. The punishment of the Bethsamites, and of Oza, had filled all with alarm, so that David durst not introduce the ark into his

palace. 1 K. vi. 19. C.

--- Though Christ created and redeemed all, yet only the just shall inherit felicity. W.

Ver. 4. Heart, whose faith and intentions are pure, as well as their actions. ---

Vain, by neglecting good works, (S. Jer.) or seeking after trifles; (S. Aug.) or rather, according to the Heb. "who hath not sworn in vain by his soul." 2 Cor. i.

23. and 1 K. i. 26. To take the name of God in vain, means to swear falsely. C. ---

Prot. "who hath not lifted up his soul unto vanity;" to swell with pride, (H.) or to swear by idols. Pr. in disc. --- To his, &c. This is not in Heb. but must be understood, (C.) as a person can only intend to deceive men. So Duport, who follows the Heb. so exactly in his Greek psalms in verse, (Bert.) reads, "Nor sworn an oath, that men he might deceive." H. --- These two verses contain an abridgment of the gospel, and shew that something better than Mount Sion is understood. Heb. xii. 22. When we approach to the tabernacle, and to the sacred mysteries, we ought to put these terrible questions to ourselves. Bert.

--- We must carefully employ ourselves in good works, (W.) by which alone we can make our calling and election sure. 1 Pet. i. 10. H.

Ver. 5. Blessing. David seems to have given the eulogium of Obededom, whose example taught him that the ark was only terrible to the wicked; and that it was a source of blessings to the just. 2

K. vi. 11. --- Mercy. Heb. "justice." But these terms are used synonymously, and denote that God gives a just reward; "when he crowns our merits, he crowns his own gifts." S. Aug. Theod. C.

--- Mercy goes before; good works must follow, to obtain eternal glory. W.

Ver. 6. The face. Heb. "Thy face, O Jacob, always." S. Jer. --- Prot. (marg. God of) Jacob. Selah.

H. --- Thus they intimate that the Heb. is imperfect. All the preceding virtues belong to Jesus Christ, who obtained mercy for us. The generation of Adam multiplied, (Gen. v. 1.) and soon forgot the Lord: but it shall not be so with the disciples of Christ, who must delight in fervent prayer, and in the constant practice of good works; and not merely serve him in certain fits of devotion.

Bert. See Prov. xxix. 26. M.

Ver. 7. Princes; or, "lift up your chief or highest gates:" portas principes. Heb.

"gates, lift up your heads." Here the gates themselves are addressed, while the Sept. and Vulg. turn the discourse to the porters or princes. Bert. --- The tops of the gates must be raised, to let the triumphal car pass through. Isai. vi. 4.

Amos viii. 3. and ix. 1. The Church has constantly understood this passage of Christ's ascension. The saints in his train address the angels, who appear to be filled with astonishment. Theod. Euseb. C. --- The gates of heaven are more properly styled eternal, than those of the temple, which were not yet erected; or of Jerusalem, which should be (Bert.) soon demolished. H. --- This apostrophe to the gates is very striking, commanding them to allow more room for the crowd to pass in the train of the conqueror, who was usually seated on a lofty chariot. C. --- The prophet contemplating the ascension of Christ, inviteth the angels to receive him; and by the figure, prosopopeia, speaketh also to the gates by which he is to enter. W. --- Homer (Il. 8.) represents the Hours as door-keepers of heaven removing a thick cloud, which obstructs the entrance. H. --- These gates are supposed to open, by being lifted upwards. The Greeks style them cataracts. Gen. vii. 11. Tournemine.

Ver. 8. Who. This is the question of the Levites, when the ark approached, or of the angels in heaven, who hold a dialogue with the

attendants of Christ. These return a satisfactory answer only at the second demand, having first given four titles to their great king. Bert. --
- Some of the Fathers suppose that the angels in heaven were not acquainted with the incarnation. S. Just. dial.

Theod. S. Jer. in Isai. lxiii. But the latter here asserts that the good and bad angels hold a dialogue, or that the former address the spirits in limbo, announcing to them their speedy deliverance in consequence of Christ's victory over the devil. The dialogue is rather (C.) between the angels in heaven, and the spirits of the just, (S. Athan.) or other angels, who accompanied Christ in his ascension. C. --- The angels express their admiration of the glory with which Christ, (W.) in our human nature, (H.) was environed; and the prophet replies, that he had overcome all his opponents, and again orders the gates to open. W. --- The angels were not ignorant, but gave occasion to a further display of the conqueror's dignity, and expressed their surprise that men should enter heaven. M.

Ver. 10. Hosts of all heavenly powers, (W.) and the arbiter of war. H. --- Both Jews and foreigners were convinced that God granted victory to his people, if they had not forfeited his favour by their crimes, as in the case of Achan, and of the sons of Heli. Jos. vii. and 1 K. iv.

Judith v. 24. The title of Lord of hosts, was very applicable to Christ after his victory. C. ---

Glory. S. Jer. adds, "for ever;" thus frequently sela seems to form a part of the sentence though it be neglected by the Vulg. &c. H.

PSALM 24

PSALM XXIV. (AT TE DOMINE LEVAVI.)

A prayer for grace, mercy, and protection against our enemies.

Ver. 1. David. This word alone occurs in Heb. Sept. and S. Jerom add also Psalm. H. --- S.

Aug. and Theod. agree with the Vulg. C. --- These variations prove that we cannot depend much on the titles; and the learned do not look upon them as the word of God. The psalm may have been composed, when David was persecuted by his son, (Bert.) or by Saul. It may also allude to the captives.

This is the first of the seven alphabetical psalms. The 33d, 35th, 110th, 111th, 118th, and 144th, are of the same description, being written in this manner (C.) on account of their importance, (Kimchi) or to help the memory, (Bert.) or for copies, to teach young people to write. Grot. --- Each verse forms a distinct sentence, not much connected with the rest. We perceive some derangement in the present Heb. copies of this psalm, as the letters are not in proper order, though it might easily be restored by altering the divisions (C.) than their Thalmudical songs. Pellican in Ps. lxxxv. 9. --- The Sept. and S. Jerom seem to have had better copies. Christ, the Church, (C.) or any pious soul, may address this fervent prayer to God under affliction. --- Lifted up in a true spirit of prayer, (Bert.) with fervour and confidence. Deut. xxiv.

15. Lam. iii. 41. C. --- Attention is requisite to obtain a petition, (W.) as well as fervour, &c. H.

Ver. 2. In thee. Heb. bec. Thus the second verse will properly begin with b, (Capel. Houbig.) though the Jews place my God first, as it is in the Vulg. Deus meus, in te, &c. H. --- Ashamed.

Sept. Compl. adds, "for ever."

Ver. 3. Laugh. Saying scornfully where is their God? C. --- Wait. This is often urged (Is. xlii.

23.) as comprising all the science of a spiritual life. We must neither despair nor omit the means of salvation. Bert. --- Those who hope for the accomplishment of God's promises, will not be disappointed. C.

Ver. 4. All, is not expressed in Heb. or some copies of the Sept. Bert. --- Cause.

No one can have reason to do so. But those who injure their harmless brethren, are more reprehensible, (H.) and the psalmist foretells that they will be put to shame. S. Jer. --- This manner of praying frequently occurs in the psalms, to signify the event, and the approbation of the just. W. --- Shew.

The forth verse ought to begin here with d, as in Heb. H. --- Paths. The mysterious ways of Providence, (Euseb.) or the law which is unknown to many, (S. Athan.) and practised by still fewer. C.

Ver. 5. And teach. If the verse were to commence thus, (C.) v would not be out of its place. H.

--- Without God's direction, we cannot walk in the narrow path. Bert. --
- Long.

We must never cease to desire the knowledge of true doctrine. W.

Ver. 6. World. God's truth or fidelity in performing his promises, and his tender mercies towards his people, are the motives most frequently urged. C.

Ver. 7. Ignorances. Heb. "defects," as youth is more apt to omit duties than to act very wickedly.

Yet it is difficult to decide how grievous such sins may be. Bert. ---
Passion and ignorance then concur to lead the inexperienced astray. H.
--- From the first use of reason, many are careless, and neglect to learn their duty. W. ---

Ignorance is sometimes a sin, though it may be more pardonable. 1
Tim. i. M.

Ver. 8. Righteous. Though he is always ready to receive the penitent, he will punish the obstinate with severity. C. W. --- Yet he points out the means of obtaining his favour. S. Aug. --- A law.

Heb. "will instruct." C.

Ver. 9. Mild. Only rebels are made the victims of justice. H.

Ver. 10. Seek. Heb. "keeps." But no one seeks after the law, who does not strive to keep it. Bert.

--- Jesus Christ shewed mercy at his first coming, and he will display truth at his second, judging all with equity. S. Aug. --- Testimonies. When God gave the law to manifest his will, he attested heaven and earth, that all might observe it carefully. C. --- The law is God's covenant, and the testimony of his will. He mercifully preventeth us with his grace, and will reward with truth and justice.

W.

Ver. 11. Great. "Original sin is common to all, and will not be washed away, except God be pleased to destroy it in baptism." S. Jer. --- David had committed adultery; and all must acknowledge their manifold guilt. C. ---

Though the guilt had been remitted, the punishment due to David's crime was to be endured in this life, and he ought daily to pray for pardon. Bert. ---

The aversion from God in sin is great, and standeth in need of his gracious remission. W.

Ver. 12. He hath. This may be understood either of God, or of man, who has chosen a state of life. Bert. --- Provided he be guided by the fear of the Lord, (C.) all thing will turn to his advantage. H.

Ver. 13. Dwell. Heb. intimates, "all night" at rest; yet so that he must only enjoy temporal goods like a traveller. Bert. --- We ought to look up to heaven as to our true country, (C.) or which Palestine was only a figure. Ps. lxxviii. M. --- The land, is not expressed in Heb. "his seed shall receive (good) for an inheritance." H. --- Five blessings are here promised to those who fear the God: instruction, a supply of necessities, a progeny to imitate his virtues, protection, and heaven.

W.

Ver. 14. Firmament, or strong support. H. --- Heb. "the secret of the Lord is for them," &c. He conceals nothing from his friends. C. --- Both these sense are good, (Bert.) and the Hebrew words are nearly allied. Robertson. --- All who fear God, ought to interest themselves, and pray that he would enlighten the ignorant, and convert sinners. Bert. --- The uncertain and hidden things of thy wisdom thou hast made manifest to me. Ps. l. 8. M.

Ver. 15. Lord. Our prayers are not heard, because they are not like this: fervant, incessant, and humble. We have all to fear from our passions, which are the most dangerous snares. Bert.

Ver. 16. Alone. Desolate, (Ps. xxi. 21.) without any assistant. H. --- Such is man destitute of God's grace. W.

Ver. 17. Multiplied. Heb. "enlarged." So in the gradual for the second Sunday of Lent, we read dilatatae. Bert. --- Afflictions must be endured. W. Sen. ep. 12.

Ver. 18. See. The word kum, "arise," may be wanting, as the verse should begin with k, (C.) unless it be lost. MS. 2, repeats the former verse, perhaps to fill up the space. Kennicott. ---

Forgive. Heb. or "bear." Bert. S. Jer. M. --- If the cause be removed, the affliction will have an end. W.

Ver. 19. Unjust. Heb. also, "cruel," (H.) or "violent." But S. Jerom agrees with the Sept. Our spiritual enemies are the most dangerous and unrelenting, and we are too often off our guard.

Bert. --- The wicked, through hatred of God, (H.) seek to draw others into sin.

W.

Ver. 20. Soul. David was most concerned for it; (Bert.) and those who sincerely place their confidence in God, will never be confounded. W.

Ver. 21. Adhered. Heb. "innocence, &c. have kept me." C. --- Those faithful subjects, who have accompanied me in my flight, stand guard to protect me.

Requite them, O Lord, and grant peace to all my people. H. --- My example encourages them to follow thy law, and they will be staggered, if thou grant not my request. M.

Ver. 22. Deliver. Heb. pede, "redeem." All the 22 (H.) letters of the alphabet are complete without this supplication for all Israel, or for the Church. W. --- It might form a part of the last verse, or belong to the next psalm; unless it be a conclusion like that of Ps. xxxiii. (C.) out of the alphabetical order. Houbigant.

--- Israel. S. Aug. and some ancient psalters read, "Me, O God of Israel, from all my tribulations." C.

PSALM 25

PSALM XV. (JUDICA ME DOMINE.)

David's prayer to God in his distress, to be delivered, that he may come to worship him in his tabernacle.

Ver. 1. David. Heb. and the most correct copies of the Sept. &c. have only "Of David." H. ---

The Comp. and Ald. edit. add indeed A psalm. But these form no rule, as the Vat. Sept. is allowed to be the best. Bert. --- The others may, however, be consulted, as in some instances they may be preferable. H. --- This psalm might be composed to counteract the calumnies propagated against David, while he lived among the Philistines; (Theod. Flamin.) or it may contain the sentiments of the captives, as well as the two following canticles. C. --- The Church, (S. Aug. &c.) or any afflicted soul, may this appeal to the justice of God, (Bert.) and

particularly the sacred ministers, when they are going to appear before him. --- Innocence. Only those whose conscience reproaches them with nothing, can hold this language. God is a just and unerring judge. C.

Weakened. Heb. also "slide," (Prot.) or "stagger." Sym. I am confident that my enemies will have no advantage over me. C.

Ver. 2. Burn, like gold in the furnace. Bert. --- Purify all my affections and thoughts with the fire of divine love. S. Aug. S. Jer. --- Make my dispositions known to the world. I have done no one any harm. C. --- I take thee for the arbiter of my cause with respect to Saul, whom I have not injured. Still, as I may not be innocent, do thou try me, as thou thinkest proper. W.

Ver. 3. Truth. Before such a judge, I fear no calumny. I have always endeavoured to imitate these divine perfections. C. --- Heb. "I have walked constantly in thy truth," which could not be without loving it. Bert.

Ver. 4. Council. Heb. "men." --- Doers. Heb. "men of darkness;" which means the wicked, (Bert.) who love darkness. Prot. "dissemblers." H. -- - The sacred minister ought to avoid evil company. C. --- David had often people of this description, like Joab and Abner, in his train; but he did not approve of their conduct. Some would restrain his words to idolaters: but this would make his declaration of little importance to Christians, as many would say the same, though they dare not say that they flee from wicked society. We must also banish all such thoughts as would destroy us. Bert. --- David was inspired to speak the sentiments of his soul, and praise his own sincerity more than ordinary men may do. He instructs us to have no society with the conventibles of any false religion. W.

Ver. 6. Innocent. Heb. "in innocence," avoiding every thing which may defile and render me unfit to approach thy holy altar. Many things (C.) of themselves innocent, (H.) excluded the priests of the old law from

officiating, and if they had partaken of any idolatrous sacrifices, they lost their dignity for ever. Ezec.

xliv. 12. How much greater ought to be the sanctity of Christian priests! The Jews carefully abstained from eating what the law forbade. Dan. i. 8. Tob. i. 12.

David would not sit down to a feast with the proud. Ps. c. 5. It was customary to wash before meat (Mat. xv. 2. and Mar. vii. 3.) and prayer. Aristeas informs us that the Sept. washed their hands every morning, before they began to translate the Bible, to shew what purity of soul was requisite. Pilate used the like ceremony, when he would have no hand in the condemnation of our Saviour; (Matt. xxvii. 24. C.) and thus people declared their innocence. Deut.

xxi. 6. M. ---

People entering the house of God, and priests at the altar, adopt the same symbols of interior purity, and ought to be penetrated with the like sentiments.

H. --- David opposes the society of the good to that of the wicked, knowing that the former is a great inducement to virtue, and he declares that he will wash or converse with such. Bert. --- These words are recited by the priest, to put him in mind of the purity required. Lev. xvi. 4. W.

Ver. 7. Hear. Heb. with points, "publish." Bert. --- S. Jerom agrees with the Sept.

--- Thy praise.

The former word is not expressed in the Vulg. or Heb. (H.) but is understood; and occurs in some editions of the Sept. as well as in the Syr. Houbig. &c. ---

Worldlings come to the assemblies of the faithful, but often without piety or advantage. Priests themselves but too frequently dishonour the

altar, which they serve. Bert. --- If they were careful to perform their sacred duties well, (H.) and had a sincere love for the spouse of Christ, many profanations would be avoided; (C.) as God suffers no greater injury from any, than from bad ministers. S. Greg. &c. H. --- They ought to be recollected, and join mental with vocal prayer in their sacred offices. W.

Ver. 8. Beauty. The ark. 1 K. iv. 22. Sym. "the palace." C. --- Heb. "the dwelling."

The psalmist desires to imitate those fervent Levites, who chose always to attend the tabernacle.

Deut. xviii. 6. C. --- Mehon, when applied to the "dwelling" of God, may be properly rendered a temple, heaven, &c. Deut. xxvi. 15. Bert. --- No one who reflects on the blessings dispensed in God's house, can fail to be struck with admiration. W.

Ver. 9. Take; lit. "destroy," (H.) or suffer me not to be contaminated or lost. W.

--- Heb. "gather."

Prot. or "take not away." Marg. and S. Jer. H. --- Heb. may be more expressive, and agrees with the parable, where God orders the cockle to be gathered into bundles, to be burnt. Bert. --- Treat me not like the wicked and murderers, who are cut off before their time. C. --- David alludes to a future state, as he knew that the wicked were not always punished here. Bert. --- O God is not in Heb.

Sept. or S. Aug. C. --- But it is understood. H.

Ver. 10. Gifts, to bribe; or rather, which the judges have received. Bert.

Shochad is always used in a bad sense for "a bribe." C. --- Est munus a lingua...a manu...et ab obsequio. S. Jer. --- The wicked use their worldly goods to corrupt others. W. --- Jugurtha leaving Rome, said, "O venal city." Sallust.

Ver. 11. Innocence. He opposes the integrity of his proceedings to that of the wicked. C. --- Yet still calls for mercy. H. --- Every one should strive to be innocent, and to avoid the company of worldlings. W.

Ver. 12. Direct, (directo.) Prot. "in an even place," (H.) in the court where the Levites sung.

Vatab. --- I have followed the paths of justice, and hope soon to be able to praise thee in thy temple. C. --- These seven last verses are daily recited at Mass. But do we reflect what innocence and fervour are required of the sacred ministers? I cannot assert that my paths have never strayed from the right way. Pardon my transgressions, and enable me henceforth to live so that I may be worthy to sound forth thy praise, and to appear in thy sanctuary. Bert. ---

Thee.

Heb. "the Lord." H. --- The psalms of David are now used in every Christian Church. Euthym.

M.

PSALM 26

PSALM XXVI. (DOMINUS ILLUMINATIO.)

David's faith and hope in God.

Ver. 1. Anointed. Heb. has only, David. The rest of the title occurs only in some copies of the Sept. (Euseb. C.) and is not of divine authority. Yet if any attention be paid to it, we must suppose that David composed this psalm before his second anointing, as he speaks of great dangers. But this is all uncertain. Bert. --- For dangers threatened David even after he had been declared king. H. --- Before Samuel anointed him, he was not endued with the spirit of prophecy.

See 1 K. xvi. 13. 2 K. ii. 4. and v. 3. C. --- Some suppose that he alludes to the entertainment given him by Abimelech, (v. 5 and 12. Theod.) or

to that night when, fearless of danger, he took away Saul's cup; (Ferrand) while Abenezra and De Muis rather believe, that he composed this psalm when his people dissuaded him from going out to battle. 2 K. xxi 17. It expresses the sentiments of the Levites in captivity, (C.) and most beautifully consoles the just in distress.

David did not write this for himself alone, but for all future generations. Hence it is not necessary to discover the particular circumstances of his life, to which this and many other psalms allude; nor is there any difficulty in explaining away the various imprecations, as they are not directed against any individual, but relate to all the enemies of the soul; while they foretell what the wicked shall suffer. Bert. --- Afraid. "Find one more powerful, and then fear." S. Aug. ---

God both giveth light and strength, so that no enemy can hurt his servants. Lu.

xxi. 15. W.

Ver. 2. Flesh. This expression marks the fury of his enemies. See Job xix. 22.

and xxxi. 31. C.

--- That. Heb. and Sept. "and my foes." This may denote domestic, and the former word public, enemies. H. --- Weakened. Hebrew also, "have stumbled."

Those who came to take Jesus Christ, verified this prediction. Jo. xviii. 6. C.

Ver. 3. This; God's protection (H.) and light, (M.) or in the very heat of battle: *prælium*. Sept.

express the Heb. fem. pronoun, as they do with the Vulg. v. 4, *unam*. There is no neuter in Heb.

which commonly uses the feminine, instead. C. --- It may be deemed too scrupulous an exactitude, to express this in a version. The word petition may be understood. Bert. M. --- The one petition of David comprised every blessing; as he had his mind bent on heaven. D.

Ver. 4. House; the tabernacle, (H.) or temple, (C.) unless he may rather allude to God's presence and union, or his enjoyment in heaven. Bert. -- - He had already expressed a similar wish. Ps.

xxv. 8. C. --- "When we love what God approves, he will surely grant our request. S. Aug. ---

David esteemed it as a special benefit to be in the Catholic Church, which is the only true house of God. W. --- Delight; beauty and sweetness, as the Heb.

implies. Many of the ancients read,

"the will," voluntatem, with Sixtus V. &c. But the edition of Clem. VIII. agrees with the Heb. and Oriental versions. C. --- To comply with God's will, is the only means of arriving at his beatific vision. H. --- David was more grieved at being kept at a distance from the tabernacle, than from his own family. He envied the happiness of those who could attend the divine worship. M.

Ver. 5. Tabernacle; in the Catholic Church, so that the enemy can either not find, or at least cannot hurt, my soul. W. --- I hope one day to enjoy rest in the temple. C. --- The verbs are in the future, in Heb. both here and in the following verse. But they may be as well explained in the sense of the Vulg. Those who find themselves in danger, must still have recourse to God's presence, (Bert.) where, as (H.) in the asylum of the tabernacle, (M.) or of the temple, they will be protected. C. --- God rewards those with glory in death, who have suffered for his name. W.

Ver. 6. Round. Heb. "my enemies around." But the Sept. understand it of David, (Bert.) or of the priest, who poured the blood of the victims on different sides of the altar. H. --- Jubilation: singing and music,

which are styled the fruit, or calves of the lips. Is. lvii. 19. Os. xiv. 3. C. -
--

David diligently recounted God's benefits, with all his heart and voice. W. --- He offered sacrifices by ministry of the priests, on the altar of holocausts, which was not in, but before, the tabernacle. M.

Ver. 7. To thee, is understood in Heb. and the Rom. Sept. H.

Ver. 8. Face hath. Heb. pointed, "faces seek ye." But Sept. S. Jer. Chal. &c. take no notice of these points; and even Prot. marg. has, "My heart said unto thee, Let my face seek thy face;"

(Bert.) though in the text they derange the words, and add, " When thou saidst, Seek ye my face, my heart said," &c. H. --- Seek. "I have sought for no reward besides thee." S. Aug. --- I have earnestly desired to see thee face to face. 1

Cor. xiii. 12. W.

Ver. 9. Decline not. Heb. "put not away." Prot. But the Vulg. seems preferable.

--- Forsake.

Sept. (Compl. and Ald.) me aposkorakises, "send me not to the crows," an expression borrowed from profane authors, who said, "to the crows," when they held a person in sovereign contempt.

Theod. Bert. --- Grabe substitutes this word, though the Alex. and Vat. MSS.

agree with us. H.

--- There seems to be a gradation in the condition of the reprobate here observed. God hides his countenance, withdraws, abandons, and despises them; and they only perceive their misery, when it is too late. Bert. --- David implores aid in this life, and deprecates the divine anger,

looking upon himself as an orphan, whom God takes under his special protection. W.

Ver. 10. For. Heb. "Though." David's parents fled to him. 1 K. xxii. 1. Yet they had made small account of him, till Samuel called him forth. 1 K. xvi. 10. The father-in-law and mother-in-law may be also designated. When a saint is deprived of every human advantage, he may still say with S. Aug. "They have taken from me what God gave, but they have not taken God from me, who gave those things." Bert. --- Though I am like an orphan, I hope for all good from God, my father. Is. lxiii. 16. C.

Ver. 11. Enemies, who strive to pervert me. Keep me in the right path, which thou hast already made known to me. W.

Ver. 12. Will. Lit. "souls." H. --- Some ancient copies have, "the hands." ---

Unjust. Heb.

"false." H. --- To itself, ought not to be urged no more than eat sibi, vade tibi.

Gen. xii. 1. Cant.

i. 7. C. --- It is a Heb. idiom. H. --- Many find fault with the Sept. and Vulg. in this place, but without reason; and they do not agree in their versions. Sym. and S.

Jer. come near to us. Puach means to breathe, or entangle; and our version intimates, that "iniquity has entangled itself:"

vipheach chamas, "and open lying." S. Jer. Bert. --- The accusers of Susanna, and of our Saviour, could not agree in their testimony. The Chaldees continually calumniated the captives.

Isai. lii. 4. Jer. l. 33. C. --- Worldlings still do the same, (Matt. v.) delighting in lies, which will prove their own ruin. W.

Ver. 13. I. Heb. "But I believe that I shall see." S. Jer. --- "I had fainted, unless,"

&c. Prot. H.

--- Living, or of promise, as this country is often designated, (Muis. T. Du Pin.

C.) or rather in heaven, (Bert. M.) where death shall be no more. H. --- The Fathers explain it in this more elevated sense. C. --- The just are comforted by God, and by the hope of heavenly rewards. W.

--- The land of the living may be opposed to the grave, where none can worship God. H.

Ver. 14. And let. Heb. "and he will strengthen my heart, and wait" (instead of and, Prot. put, without reason, "Wait I say) on the Lord." We must do our utmost: yet all our strength must come from God. H. -- - The prophet encourageth his own soul to exercise patience, fortitude, and longanimity (Ps.

xxx. W.) unto the end. M.

PSALM 27

PSALM XXVII. (AD TE DOMINE CLAMABO.)

David's prayer that his enemies may not prevail over him.

Ver. 1. Himself. The Heb. and Sept. (Rom. and Alex.) have simply "of David." ---

Ledavid. H.

--- The psalm appears to be a sequel of the preceding, and we may adopt the rule of the Jews, who refer the psalms which have no title, to the same author and events as those which go before. It may relate to the captives, (C.) or to David under persecution, though the Fathers explain it of Christ suffering, &c.

and rising again. --- My God. Heb. "rock." This term is so often applied to God, that it might be added to his other ten titles. Bert. --- Lest...to me, is not in the Rom. psalter.

Euthym. &c. --- Pit, grave; though it also denote "a prison." C. --- S. Jerom has

"be not deaf to me," &c. M.

Ver. 2. Pray. Heb. "cry...to the recess of thy sanctuary, (H.) or to thy oracle."

Sept. place the whole for a part. The tabernacle was often styled temple. 1 K. i.

9. To lift up the hands was customary in prayer, (1 Tim. ii. 8. Lam. iii. 41. Bert.) to testify whence our aid must come. H.

--- The Jews turned towards the holy place in prayer, (3 K. viii. 48. Ezec. viii.

16.) even after the temple was destroyed. C.

Ver. 3. Draw. Sextus V. reads tradas, "deliver," &c. But the present trahas, is more conformable to the original. C. --- Sept. add, destroy me not, as the Heb.

might also signify. Suffer me not to follow bad example. They often paraphrase, to render the text clearer. A similar petition occurs, Ps. xxv. 9. ---

Hearts. Such double dealers are abominable, and quite opposite to the candour of a Christian. Jo. i. 47. and 1 Pet. ii. 22. Bert. --- The psalmist prays that God would comfort and support him, as he knew that God tempteth no man. Jam. i. W.

Ver. 4. Reward. He speaks prophetically, (v. 5.) or of spiritual enemies. Bert. ---

"If they do not understand by kindness, make them understand by torments."

S. Jer. --- He alludes to the calamities of the Babylonians, who had made such havoc, (C.) as well as to that of all who persecuted or rebelled against David.

H. --- His zeal prompts him to approve of their chastisement. W.

Ver. 5. The works, (in opera.) The preposition seems redundant, though (H.) it was probably in both places, to insinuate that attention is requisite. The Jews perished, because they would not know the things that were for their peace.

Lu. xix 42. Their city in ruins, is an emblem of the sinner's utter destruction. ---

Thou shalt. Heb. "he will." Bert. --- The Chaldees gave supreme honour to idols, neglecting the true God. Their punishment was at hand. Kimchi. C.

---Ignorance will prove no excuse, when people might be informed. God will save none, without their co-operation. W.

Ver. 6. Blessed. This energetic epithet is generally applied to the Lord, and as it is also given to Christ, he must be true God. Rom. ix. 5. &c.

Ver. 7. Protector. Heb. "buckler," to defend me from external enemies, as his grace enables me to do good. --- Flesh. Heb. "heart." But joy would manifest itself over the whole body: (Prov.

xvii. 22. Bert.) and the Syr. agrees with the Sept. "My flesh shall bud forth, and I shall sing his praises in glory." C. --- Will. Heb. "canticle," which was dictated by the will. It is suspected that the Sept. read differently. Only the saints taste true joys, so that they alone might be styled sensual. But this worldlings cannot understand. 1 Cor. ii. 14. Bert. --- The Fathers explain this text of Christ's or of our resurrection, (S. Jer. &c.) which was prefigured by the return from captivity. C. ---

Interior comfort causes the body to be refreshed; and the psalmist gladly (W.) expresses his gratitude. H.

Ver. 8. People; (hoz lamu) instead of which the Heb. has lamo, " their strength;" though the people of God had not been mentioned. S. Jerom translates, "the Lord is my strength."

Houbigant shews that the Vulg. is most accurate. Bert. --- Prot. marg. "his strength." ---

Salvation. Lit. "salvations," as he had many times protected David, as well as (H.) the priests and prophets, and all the chosen people. 1 Pet. ii. 9. C. --- God causeth the good endeavours of the king for his subjects to prosper. W.

Ver. 9. Exalt, or carry on thy shoulders, like the good shepherd. Lu. xv. 5.

Restore thy people to prosperity. This was the wish of the carnal Jews. The Christian must raise his thoughts higher.

C. --- S. Jerom and Prot. "feed...and lift them up for ever." Here the progress of justification appears. H. --- God redeems and conducts us to eternal bliss.

Bert. --- As in Ps. xix. &c. the subjects pray for their superiors, so here the ruler offers up his petitions for those committed to his charge. W.

PSALM 28

PSALM XXVIII. (AFFERTE DOMINO.)

An invitation to glorify God, with a commemoration of his mighty works.

Ver. 1. Finishing. Sept. exodiou or exodou, may also signify "the going out;"

(H.) as if the sacred ministers exhorted their successors to perform their duty in the ensuing week, or on the last day of the feast of tabernacles. Lev. xxiii.

36. C. --- Heb. has only "A canticle of David,"

(H.) and the rest was not in the Hexapla in the time of Theodoret, so that many pay no attention to it. The author seems to have supposed that the psalm was composed when David had finished the tabernacle, on Sion. C. 2 K. vi. and 1

Par. xvi. --- But the psalmist had in view things of far greater importance, the propagation of Christianity among many great potentates. W. --- The Fathers explain it in this sense, though it may literally allude (C.) to the storm procured by the prayer of Elias, 3 K. xviii. 1. 41. H. --- It might be composed in a thunderstorm, and used on similar occasions, (Muis) when a person had to go from home. H. --- The seven voices may allude to the seven sacraments, or trumpets. Apoc. x. 3. Bert. --- God. Sept. seem to have read Aleim, or they have taken elim in the same sense, as it signifies "the mighty" as well as "rams."

On account of this ambiguity, a double translation is given either by the Sept.

or rather by some later writer, who may have inserted the explanation, O ye children of God, bring ye to the Lord; (H.) which has crept from the margin into the text. Amama. --- It is marked as superfluous by Grabe, (H.) not being found in the best Greek copies; or at least have an obel, (Euseb.) to insinuate that it was not in Heb. in which state it appears in the Gal. Psalter, published in S.

Jerom's works. C. --- It is not contrary to the original, though more explicit, (Bert.) as the address is made to all the faithful, (M.) or to the priests and nobility. H. --- The apostles are styled rams, because they beat down error with the two Testaments; whence bishops' mitres have two horns.

Lombard. Amama. --- "Give praise to the Lord, ye troops of angels; render to the Lord glory and strength." Chal. C. --- Be grateful for the favours which are here recounted. W. --- Most people now translate, "sons of the mighty." Yet S.

Jerom and Houbigant have, "offspring of rams;" filios arietum. Bring lambs to the Lord, as the original may certainly mean; though many who are attached to the Heb. allow also sons of God. Bert. --- Montfaucon says that Origen marked with a lemniscus, what he judged "a better reading," and thus obelized the first of these versions, and added the second with an asterisk. This liberty has been attended both with good and bad consequences. Ken.

Ver. 2. Honour. Heb. "strength," which we must acknowledge. H. --- The first design of sacrifice is to adore God in spirit. W. --- Holy court. Heb. "in the holy beauty." 1 Par. xvi. 29.

Even the priests were obliged to remain in the court, where they adored God, as sitting upon the Cherubim, in the most holy place (C.) in the Catholic Church. W. --- External worship must be observed. Bert.

Ver. 3. Voice. Separating the waters from the earth at the beginning, as the six other voices may denote the other works of the creation; or all these voices may signify the various effects of thunder, or may allude to the terrors preceding the last judgment, (Apoc. x. 3.) or attending the establishment and liberation of the Jewish and Christian Churches. The first voice was heard when Jesus was baptized, (Mat. iii. 17.) as the rest may intimate the instruction and efficacy of the other sacraments. It is evident that something posterior to the reign of David is prefigured; (Bert.) and the Fathers have generally understood the psalm of the propagation of the gospel by the apostles, two of whom are styled sons of thunder. Mark iii. 17. C. --- The psalmist speaks of greater things than attended the translation of the ark. He represents our Saviour preaching with great power and majesty, (Mat. vii. 29.) and subjecting the most powerful monarchs to his dominion. W. --- Thunder is often styled the voice of God, and is occasioned by the collision of the clouds, (H.) which Moses calls the waters above. S. Bas. C.

Ver. 4. Power and magnificence. The sacraments of confirmation and the blessed Eucharist, or the wonderful propagation of the Church, amid violent persecutions. Bert.

Ver. 5. Libanus. Which were the most famous. H. --- Storms often tear up trees by the roots. C.

--- The effects of the gospel and of penance, may be described, or the terrors of the last day, when Jesus Christ will destroy the proud. Bert.

Ver. 6. Shall reduce them to pieces, &c. In Hebrew, shall make them to skip like a calf. The psalmist here describes the effects of thunder, (which he calls the voice of the Lord) which sometimes breaks down the tallest and strongest trees; and makes their broken branches skip, &c.

All this is to be understood mystically, of the powerful voice of God's word in his Church; which has broke the pride of the great ones of this world, and brought many of them meekly and joyfully to submit their necks to the sweet yoke of Christ. Ch. --- Calf, or "branch," as the Greek word also implies. But Heb. seems more naturally to signify "a calf; Libanus and Sirion, (or Sarion.

Deut. iii. 9.) as the son of the unicorn." These two mountains are represented jolting together. C. --- The violence of an earthquake has sometimes produced such effects. Pliny ii. 83.

See Ps. cxiii. 4. Judg. v. 5. Hab. iii. 10. C. --- And as. The construction & dilectus, seems rather to make this only nominative, "the Lord shall, &c. and the beloved, (H.) the Messias, like the son of the unicorn," shall perform the like wonders. It seems probable that the Sept. have read Jeshurun for Shirion, (Bert.) or vissron, instead of ussriun; as i would onlybe a little transposed.

H. --- Jeshurun is a title of Israel, (Deut. xxxii. 15. and xxxiii. 5. 26.) who was a figure of the Messias, the beloved of God. Bert. --- "And he will scatter them as a calf would do; Libanus and Sarion, are in motion, like the son of the rhinoceros." S. Jer. H. The most powerful submit to Christ, who works these wonders. W.

Ver. 7. Fire. Lightning, which deals destruction around. C. --- The Holy Ghost appeared in the form of parted tongues of fire, to enable the apostles to convert the desert of the Gentile world, and the Jews, represented by the desert of Cades, (W.) which was near their country, (H.) on the frontiers of Idumea. Num. xiii. 27. C. --- Holy orders were instituted by Christ, to confer grace to the sacred ministers, according to their different stations or exigencies; (Bert.) or extreme unction, which prepares the soul for her separation from the body, may be here meant, if we follow the usual disposition of the sacraments; as the following sentence may allude to holy orders, which shakes or causes the desert to fructify, (H.) unless these words be rather applied to matrimony. Bert. --- Shaketh and shakes. S. Jer. has parturire faciens, making the desert bring forth." Chal. "frightens the serpents." All nature is alarmed at the sound of thunder. H. --- The deserts then appear most terrible. C.

Ver. 9. Prepareth. Heb. "delivereth," as a midwife (S. Jer. 5 Edit. Aquila)

"maketh the hinds to calve;" (Prot. H.) or "to leap, (from éul; Bert.) or frighteneth." Hinds are supposed to bring forth with great difficulty. But the reverse seems to be the case. S. Chrys. in Job xxxix. 3. C. --- They are very swift, and trample serpents under their feet, nature having given them this power. S. Jer.

Pliny vii. 32. The text may be understood of the last sacrament, which prepares us for our passage; (Bert.) or of matrimony, by means of which the world is peopled with rational beings, whose duty it is to glorify God in his temple. H.

--- This is also the effect of grace, and of the preaching of the gospel, (Bert.) which inspires people with a desire of running on in the way of perfection.

Christ explains to them hidden mysteries in his Church, to which he bring multitudes, like the waters, ruling over them, and enabling them to overcome all temptations, till he crown his elect with eternal peace.

W. --- Glory. Running thither through fear, or to thank God for rain after a drought.

Ver. 10. Dwell. Chal. explains this of the deluge, which continued a long while upon the earth, to punish mankind. Heb. may also signify, "the Lord sitteth upon the flood," or clouds, as the Lord of nature. --- Strength, or abundant rain, (Jos. xxxviii. 6.) with all other blessings; (C.) making his people as terrible to their enemies as the storm which has been described. M.

PSALM 29

PSALM XXIX. (EXALTABO TE DOMINE.)

David praiseth God for his deliverance, and his merciful dealings with him.

Ver. 1. Dedication, when David sung after he had (H.) built a magnificent palace, 2 K. v. W. ---

David's ledavid, or "to David," which some rather join with Psalm, (Muis) and explain the house of the tabernacle or temple; though it seems more probably to relate to the altar, which David erected, after the pestilence (C.) had destroyed 70,000. 2 K. xxiv. 25. There seems to be nothing respecting a dedication in the psalm; whence we may conjecture that the title is not very authentic. The Greeks (Bert.) prefixed "unto the end," in the Rom. Sept. but not Grabe's, &c. H.

--- The Rabbins inform us that this psalm was used when people brought their first fruits to the temple, and that it will be sung at the dedication of the temple, which they expect the Messiah will erect. Selden. Syn. iii. 13. --- The Fathers explain it of Christ's resurrection. C. --- It may be put in the mouth of a just man leaving this world. Bert. --- The title of Psalm, most properly belongs to those which were played upon instruments; as a canticle refers to vocal music. When the instrument preceded, it was called A psalm of a canticle; as a canticle of a psalm intimated that man gave out the psalm, and instruments followed. W. --- These distinctions are given by S.

Chrys. &c. M.

Ver. 2. Extol. Or publish thy great goodness and power, (H.) in the same sense as we say Hallowed be thy name. Bert. --- Though God can receive no increase of glory, we must shew our gratitude. W. --- Me. Thou hast not suffered my people to be wholly destroyed, nor myself to perish in consequence of my vain curiosity. C. --- David sings this psalm in thanksgiving for his many deliverances. W.

Ver. 3. Healed me. I expected to die every moment, and I had made choice of the scourge of pestilence, that I might not be more screened than my subjects, 2 K. xxiv. 13. C.

Ver. 4. Hell. Preserving me from great dangers of sinning, (W.) or from death. ---

Saved. Heb.

"granted me life." This may all be explained of Christ's resurrection. C.

Ver. 5. Saints. Heb. "who have obtained mercy." Priests and faithful people come to return thanks, because God has turned away the scourge. C. ---

Memory, or name. Ex. iii. 15. C. --- It is from God, and not from ourselves, that holiness comes. W.

Ver. 6. Wrath, which is a short fury. M. Isai. liv. 7. --- Heb. "momentary is his indignation;" or rather, "from his indignation comes destruction," roga, as the Sept. constantly (H.) agree. Job xx.

5. Is. xxviii. 12. &c. C. --- "The miseries which are inflicted, are in consequence of his indignation." Prin. dis. Bert. --- We are not miserable unless we have deserved it. S. Aug. ---

Even in chastising, God considers our welfare. W. --- He takes no pleasure in our torments, but delights to crown us with life and

happiness. H. --- Eternal joys are the fruits of the short sorrows of this world, (Bert.) which is represented as one night or evening. H. --- A few moments ago Jerusalem expected nothing but destruction. Thus the apostles grieved till Christ rose again; (C.) and the life of the just is a constant vicissitude of sorrow and of comfort. W.

Ver. 7. Moved. David thought himself invincible; and, out of vanity, ordered his subjects to be numbered. God shewed his displeasure only for three days, and all was in confusion, v. 8. C. ---

Though we may imagine that we are firmly established, we must acknowledge that all our strength is derived from God, who sometimes leaves us to experience our own weakness. W.

Ver. 8. Beauty. So Sept. and Syriac have read ledre, (C.) instead of leharri, "my mountain,"

Sion, which David had taken from the Jebusites. The sense is much the same, though the reading of the Sept. seem more natural. Symmachus has followed another copy. Bert. --- "Thou hast given strength to my first father." C. --- The present Heb. is rejected by Houbigant, (Bert.) though it be conformable to Aquila, S. Jerom, &c. How necessary is it for us to be convinced, that all we have is the gift of God! H. --- In prosperity man is too apt to give way to presumption.

Bert. --- David had yielded to this temptation, not being sufficiently aware how jealous God is of his rights. C. --- He confesses this mistake. Heb. "I was terrified." M.

Ver. 9. Will I. We must not cease to pray, (W.) as we are always beset with enemies. H. --- This text may be explained, "I prayed," that I might suffer instead of my people. 4 K. xxiv. 17. C. ---

But here the prophet seems rather to beg that he may not die, in order that he may publish God's praises. H.

Ver. 10. Profit. The wicked on his death bed, cannot pray thus, as the justice of God is interested to punish his crimes, and to prevent their

continuance. After death there is no merit; so that we ought to make good use of our time. Bert.

--- Corruption. The Fathers explain this of Jesus Christ. What good will my death procure, if I do not rise again? Orig. S. Jer. --- Truth. See Ps.

lxxxvii. 11. Bar. ii. 17. C. --- The dead cannot make their voice heard in this world, though they may praise God in the other. M.

Ver. 11. The Lord. Heb. points determine, "Lord, hear," &c. But the Greek interpreters agree with the Vulg. which seems better. Bert. --- S. Jerom, however, make this a prayer. "Hear," &c.

H.

Ver. 12. Joy. When thou orderest the angel. 2 K. xxiv. 16. C. --- Sackcloth, of human nature, which was cut, and the price of our redemption came forth. S.

Aug. S. Jer. --- Thou hast changed my mourning weeds for robes of joy. D.

Ver. 13. Regret. Or be filled with grief, compungar. H. --- Heb. "that glory may sing thee, (or thy praise) and may not be silent." S. Jer. Sym. H. --- Glory often signifies the tongue. D. ---

My is added, to shew that this was David's glory, (H.) who considered God in all events. Bert. ---

Prot. supply the word my. H. --- Chal. "that the great ones of the world may praise thee incessantly." --- Ever. In this my happy change. W. --- Those who suppose that David sung this, when he purified his house from the abominations of Absalom, explain his illness (v. 2.) to mean the anxiety caused by that revolt. 2 K. xvi. 21. Bossuet. C. --- He gives thanks for the favour which God had shown him on that, or on any other occasion. H. --- He might consider this purifying as a sort of

dedication, as it was customary to dedicate even private houses. Deut. xx.

5. C.

PSALM 30

PSALM XXX. (IN TE DOMINE SPERAVI.)

A prayer of a just man under affliction.

Ver. 1. Ecstasy. This word is not in Heb. nor in some of the best Greek copies.

Theod. --- It seems to be taken from v. 23. (C.) and intimates that the just may recite this psalm in the latter times, (W.) when they shall be in the greatest perplexity. H. --- David composed it when he was obliged to flee from court, (1

K. xix. 1. and xxvii. 1. C.) or in the desert of Moan, seeing himself in the most imminent danger; (1 K. xxiii. 25. Kimchi. Du Pin) though some refer this psalm to the conspiracy of Absalom, (Theod. M.) or to the unpremeditated fall of David, (Euseb.) or to the captives. S. Chrys. --- Our Saviour repeated part of v.

6. upon the cross; and he may perhaps be the object of the whole psalm. The Church prescribes only the six first verses to be recited at Complin. Bert.

Ver. 2. Justice. Sym. "mercy." Thou art the judge between us. C. --- How grievous soever I may be afflicted, yet I trust in thee. W. --- "I fear that confusion which lasts for ever." S. Aug. D.

Ver. 3. A God. Heb. "a rock of strength." Sept. "a God who holdeth his shield over me,"

uperaspisten. H. --- Refuge. Heb. "fortress." C.

Ver. 4. Nourish. Heb. guide. H. --- Sym. "take care of me." C.

Ver. 5. Snare. The order to appear at court, after Saul had manifested his ill-will, could be considered in no other light. C.

Ver. 6. Spirit. Heb. ruach. Our Saviour determines the signification of this word, and shews that the saints of the Old Testament believed that the soul survived after its separation from the body, which some commentators have unguardedly said could not be clearly proved. This text may be applicable both to David and to Jesus Christ in a literal sense, as nothing contradictory would ensue, no more than from the prediction, out of Egypt I have called my son, being verified both in the Israelites and in the Messias; as both may truly be styled sons of God, though in a different sense. It is not so with that other prophecy, Behold a virgin, &c. which some say related both to the wife of the prophet and to the blessed Virgin: which cannot be, as they would not both have children, and still remain virgins. When two literal senses are admitted, they must not be contradictory. The verb is here in the future, both in Heb.

Sept. and in the common Greek of the New Testament; (Lu. xxiii. 46.) though some MSS. of the latter have the present tense, which is adopted by Prot. &c.

Bert. --- David commits his cause to God, being convinced that his promises would not be in vain. S. Stephen said in like manner, Lord receive my spirit; (Acts vii.

58.) and "the saints use this prayer when they leave the body," (S. Jer. C.) as well as on any other important occasion, particularly when they receive the holy sacrament. W. --- Redeemed, by freeing me from many dangers. The resurrection of Christ might be called a redemption; for which he had paid the price. Bert.

Ver. 7. Vanities. Idols, (C.) superstitious practices, (Hammond) and lies. It may refer to Saul, who performed his promises so ill, and neglected the laws which he had made against witches.

C. --- Prot. "I have hated them that regard lying vanities." H. --- The ancient interpreters, with S.

Jerom, seem not to have seen the i, which changes the second into the first person, though here it would be less agreeable to the context. This i would appear unnecessary, if the present Hebrew were correct. Bert. Houbig.

Ver. 8. Humility. Heb. "affliction, thou hast known the tribulations of my soul."

S. Jer. H. ---

Thou hast often rescued me from my enemies; and canst thou behold my present distress without pity? C. --- When God knows his friend to be in misery, he does not fail to relieve him. Bert.

Ver. 9. Place. The psalms were commonly composed after the danger was over.

David had escaped the lance and the servants of Saul. C.

Ver. 10. Belly, or entrails. M. Lam. i. 20. Eccli. li. 29. H. --- David was filled with indignation at the conduct of his enemies. C. --- Both soul and body felt the effects of his great sorrow, (H.) which pervaded every part. W.

Ver. 11. Poverty. Sept. have read ani instead of haoni, "my iniquity," which seems less accurate, as David had not offended Saul. Sym. has "malice," (C.) or "ill-treatment," kakosin. H. --- We may form some judgment of David's distress, from his being obliged to eat the consecrated bread at Nobe. C. --- Yet without making any change to the Heb. we may explain it in the sense of the Vulg. as áve signifies to be "bent down." Bert. --- "Chastisements waste my strength." Pr. disc.

--- Jesus was a man of sorrows. Bert.

Ver. 12. Among. Lit. "above;" super. H. --- Houbigant would exchange l for m, in Heb. "to all,"

&c. which seems more agreeable to the sequel, and does not contradict the Vulg. Bert. --- David complains that none of his enemies were treated so severely as himself, (H.) though they were very wicked. M. --- They all looked upon him with disdain, and even his friends fled from him.

This is the picture of the world. A man fallen into distress is the object of general contempt. C.

--- Yet we ought rather to remember that such a one is sacred: *sacra res est miser*: and that he ought to excite our compassion. H. --- Fear. People are afraid to have it known that they were ever acquainted with me, (C.) lest they should be involved in my misery. H. --- My friends dare not converse with me.

W.

Si malè res cedit, superest tibi nullus amicus:

Omnia fortunæ sunt inimica malæ. Lucian Anthol.

If fortune frown, no friend dares shew his face,

All flee the wretched, and abhor their place.

Ver. 13. Heart, past recovery. Prot. "dead man out of mind." H. --- Vessel means, "any thing."

C. --- A broken pot is thrown away. M.

Ver. 14. About. They blame me to my face. Heb. "fear on every side." H. --- But *magor* signifies also "dwelling," as well as "fear;" and this dread arose only from the multitude of enemies. Bert. --- Life. I was proscribed by Saul, (1 K. xix.

1. H.) and they were only solicitous how to destroy me. C. --- They assembled to talk about my pretended H. faults, and to contrive my ruin. Jer. xx. 10. M.

Ver. 16. Lots. Sept. Rom. kleroi, as the same word, hittothai is rendered Judg.

xxi. 22. Others explain "times," with the Rom. Psalter, &c. in the same sense, to denote (Bert.) that all the vicissitudes of life, both prosperity and adversity, are at God's disposal. Theod. --- If he protects me, all my enemies will rage in vain.

C.

Ver. 17. Shine propitiously, so as to free me from this storm. C. --- Make me acquainted with the right path, and deliver me. W.

Ver. 18. Brought. Prot. "be silent in the grave," (H.) or "in hell." This is a prediction. When I shall ascend the throne, they will be covered with shame. C.

--- Let them enter into themselves before they die. H. --- Houbigant thinks that the Heb. had formerly, "let them be silent, and descend into the grave;" which seems judicious. David inveighs against his spiritual enemies, and against manifest impiety. Bert.

Ver. 19. Iniquity. Heb. "harsh things;" calumnies. C. --- Abuse. Sept.

exoudenosei, as if they

"made nothing" of the just. H. --- They seem to acknowledge no superior, and abuse their power.

W.

Ver. 20. Men. Thou comfortest thy servants internally, and often manifestest thy protection. H.

--- This thou wilt do when it is expedient, though the reward of the just in this life is generally hidden. They are, nevertheless, in great esteem with thee. W.

Ver. 21. Face. The malice of the wicked has its limits; while God defends his servants, admitting them as it were into his own presence and tabernacle, where none dare assault them. The Eastern princes did not allow any, but their great favourites to come into their presence. C. Est. v. and xv.

H. --- Disturbance. Chal. "troops of the strong." Heb. "from the pride or vexations." God will protect his friends, both from an open attack and from malicious speeches. --- Thy is not expressed in Heb. Bert. --- "From the harshness of the great ones thou wilt protect them in the shade, from the contradiction of tongues." S. Jer. --- How shall we avoid the danger of being seduced by contradictory teachers, unless we have recourse to the Catholic Church? Tu curre ad Eccles. Cath. et protegeris; &c. S. Aug. H. --- Those who are united to God by contemplation and love, cannot be disturbed by men.

Bellar. M.

Ver. 22. In a. Sym. "as in a city shut up" with fortifications. C. --- As seems to be understood, though some explain this of Ceila, (Bert.) or of Siceleg, which had been given to David for a retreat. He here apologizes for having recourse to an infidel. C.

Ver. 23. Excess. Sept. "in my ecstasy." Heb. "haste." Prot. "consternation."

Sym. H. --- In sudden danger I exclaimed that all was lost; but God presently relieved me. Thus He prepared David for his exalted station; having taught him by affliction, to have pity on others. C. --- He experienced for a moment a sort of diffidence, before he had time to reflect. But he presently turned towards God. A Protestant commentator, who, in general, is very guarded in his expressions, and who applies all this psalm to the Messiah, here falls into a horrible mistake, which he seems to have borrowed from Calvin: "The Messiah," he says, "was to experience once, what the damned will feel for ever. For the punishment of the damned properly consists in the consternation and grief which they will feel, to see themselves separated for ever from the sight of God." He refutes himself, by saying the Jesus

Christ shewed us how to pray, when we are abandoned in like manner. Does any one experience here the torment of the damned? or could Jesus ever be the object of God's hatred?

It would have sufficed to say that he was destitute of all exterior succour, and internally felt those torments which the gospel mentions. Bert. --- Eyes.

This he spoke in great agony of mind, which he would afterwards have recalled, like holy Job. C.

iii. and xlii. W.

Ver. 24. Saints. Heb. "merciful ones;" Assideans, priests, &c. --- Truth. Heb.

"will preserve the true;" (C.) or, "will observe the faithful." Bert. --- Abundantly.

Sept. "that act with great pride,"

as S. Aug. reads, and as Heb. and Vulg. may be rendered. H. --- The prophet exhorts all to persevere unto the end. W.

PSALM 31

PSALM XXXI. (BEATI QUORUM.)

The second penitential psalm.

Ver. 1. Understanding; (Prot. mascul. H.) shewing how he was brought to acknowledge his fault, and by penance to obtain pardon, (W.) justly giving the glory to God's grace. S. Aug. --- Sept.

Alex. ["A psalm] to David," of understanding; which is taken from some other copy. H. --- Some suppose this word has been inserted from ver 8. Abenezra.

--- But there are several other psalms which have this title, (H.) intimating either that they contain great mysteries, (Euseb.) or that they are easy to understand. Agellius. --- This is wholly of a moral nature. The Jews styled it the heart of David, because it displays his sentiments of contrition. C. --- He composed it most probably after Nathan had engaged him to confess his fault.

Bellar. --- It might be used on the solemn feast of expiation. Grot. Num. xxix. 7.

--- the Fathers explain it of the grace which we receive in baptism and in penance. S. Aug. S. Greg. &c. C. --- Are they. Heb. "The blessings of him whose iniquity." Pagnin. --- But the sense is the same, and S. Paul follows the Sept.

which gives their version the highest authority. Rom. iv. 7. --- Sins; or, "who is screened from the punishment of sin." Prin. disc. Sin has often this signification; and the psalmist would otherwise seem to say less than he had already expressed. Bert. --- Covered, by charity, (1 Pet. iv.) as a physician covers a wound, to remove it entirely; and we must cover our former transgressions, by doing good works. S. Greg. --- Then our sins will not appear at the day of judgment, (S. Jer.) nor be punished, as they are wholly destroyed.

The Pelagians calumniated Catholics, as if they taught that sins were only shaven, as it were, the roots still remaining; which S. Aug. (con. 2 ep. Pelag. i.

13.) says, "None affirmeth but an infidel." Thus the doctrine of Calvin is condemned; who abuses these texts to prove that sins are only covered, and still remain even in the most just; which is contrary to innumerable passages of Scripture, (Isai. vi. Jo. i. 1 Cor. vi. &c.) and injurious to the perfections of God, and to the redemption of Christ, as well as to the saints in heaven, who are thus represented as still infected with all their sins. W. --- This doctrine is now almost abandoned by Protestants, as it is contrary both to sound philosophy and divinity: for sin is nothing physical, but a want of moral rectitude. Bert. --- God cannot fail to punish sin, wherever it really subsists.

His spirit is surely free from guile. He cannot suppose that we are just by imputation of Christ's justice, unless we be really so. H. --- By means of the sacraments the sinner becomes just, and God sees nothing in him deserving of punishment. C. --- "If any one wishes his sins to be covered, let him manifest them to God, by the voice of confession." S. Greg. --- But, replies a Lutheran commentator, "God does not forget sin." What is this to the purpose, as long as the sin does not subsist in the offender? He allows that "the pardon of sin is inseparable from sanctification." Renew a right spirit within my bowels. Ps. l. 12. Bert. -- - The man who has felt real compunction, will be able to form a true notion of the happiness of a reconciliation. C. ---

Covering may allude to the custom of writing on wax, which might easily be effaced. Our sins are recorded in the book of God's justice. M.

Ver. 2. Spirit. Sym. has "heart," or "mouth." C. --- The latter is also in some copies of the Sept.

Euseb. --- The Rom. and Alex. Sept. have it, though Grabe substitutes spirit, (H.) which is recognised by S. Jerom (ad. Sun.), Heb. &c. Nothing is so contrary to true repentance as hypocrisy. S. Aug. &c. C. -- - If we do not co-operate with God's grace, our sins will never be effaced, though, before remission, our works can only dispose us to receive pardon. "God (and meritorious) works follow." S. Aug. W.

Ver. 3. Because I was silent, &c. That is, whilst I kept silence, by concealing, or refusing to confess my sins, thy hand was heavy upon me, &c. Ch. --- The cry was then only an effect of vanity, like that of the Pharisee, full of his own merits; (S. Aug. S. Jer. C.) or David was silent till Nathan made him know his fault, which he afterwards ceased not to deplore. Theod. --- It is supposed that he had continued impenitent for above a year. But he might feel remorse during that time. v. 5. Bert. --- Cried. Heb. "roared," like a lion. C. --- Because I acknowledged not my grievous sins, I was much afflicted. I prayed, but to little purpose. W. -- - Wishing to conceal the cause of my grief, (C.) I pined away, (H.

Lam. iii. 4.) and suffered greatly, because I did not confess. M.

Ver. 4. I am turned, &c. That is, I turn and roll about in my bed, to seek for ease in my pain, whilst the thorn of thy justice pierces my flesh, and sticks fast in me. Or, I am turned; that is, I am converted to thee, my God, by being brought to a better understanding by thy chastisements.

In the Hebrew it is, my moisture is turned into the droughts of summer. Ch.

Prot. H. --- But the Sept. may have taken I for a prep. before shaddi, as the Greek interpreters say nothing of this moisture, which is the interpretation of modern Jews; and S. Jerom has (Bert.) "I was turned or occupied, in my misery;" versatus sum in miseriâ meâ. There is no peace for the wicked. H. ---

God has not punished David exteriorly till after the admonition of Nathan, when so many evils poured upon him. But the king must have experienced cruel agonies of mind, till he was prevailed on by this wise physician to confess his fault, (C.) and thus let out the imposthume, which would not allow him to enjoy any repose. --- Fastened. S. Jer. "while the summer (or heat; æstas) was burning incessantly," sela. Heb. becharbone kayits means also in gladios spina. "The thorn has been turned into swords for my affliction;"

(Bert.) or I have been as grievously tormented, as if a thorn or sword had pierced me. H. --- Thy divine Providence chastises me, and my conscience tells me that I have deserved all my sufferings. W. --- Many of the ancients read, while the thorn is broken, confringitur, (Ps. Rom. S. Greg. C.) which causes the extraction to be more difficult. H. --- This thorn may denote sin, which like a weed, had infected David's soul.

Theod. C.

Ver. 5. Sin. Or as some psalters read, "of my heart," with the Sept. Cassiod. &c.

C. --- "I know that thou wilt readily forgive the sins which are fully laid open before thee." S. Jer. --- David no sooner perceived that he was the unjust man (H.) whom Nathan had described, than he exclaimed,

"I have sinned;" and at the same moment God forgave him. 2 K. xii. 7. C. --- If this psalm relate to his repentance, it seems he had already had recourse to God; but this is doubtful, as he appears to have entered into himself only after the prophet's reproach. Nothing can more effectually give peace to the soul than an humble confession, which costs human pride a great deal, when it must be made to our brethren. Bert. --- The Jews were sometimes obliged to confess to God's minister.

Lev. iv. 5. and Num. v. 7. M.

Ver. 6. Holy. Even the angels rejoice at the sinner's conversion. Lu. xv. 7. The saints take part in the welfare of their fellow creatures, and praise God for his mercies shewn unto them. C. ---

Time. During this life, (Is. lv. 6. Eccle. ix. 10. Chal. Muis.) or when they shall be treated in like manner. Piscat. --- As I now repent, so must those who are afflicted, pray that they may obtain pardon; then they will not be oppressed, though their miseries may appear very great, like a deluge. W. --- Yet. Heb. rak,

"surely." Bert. --- "Therefore shall every merciful one pray unto Thee, finding time; that when many waters shall inundate, they may not approach unto him."

S.

Jer. H. --- A deluge denotes great calamities. Is. xliii. 2. Even the terrors of the last day will not disturb the just, (C.) nor will they inspire the wicked with true repentance. H.

Ver. 7. Refuge. Heb. "hiding," (Ps. xxx. 21. H.) or asylum. C. --- Which. Heb.

"thou shalt surround me with songs of deliverance. Sela." Or "my praise saving, thou wilt environ me always." S. Jer. H. --- Perhaps thou may now occupy the place of me, as the Greeks all agree; and the sense is at least the same. Bert.

Ver. 8. Fix. Heb. "consult with my eyes concerning thee." The Vulg. better. C. ---

Prot. marg.

"my eye shall be upon thee." H. --- God thus engages to watch over, and direct his servant, (Gen.

xliv. 21. Jer. xxiv. 6. C.) giving him instruction, by means of chastisements. W.

Ver. 9. Do not. This may be spoken by God, or by the psalmist; as an admonition to hear the counsel of those divinely commissioned. C. --- Who come. Prot. "lest they come near," (H.) and threaten to bite or to run over thee.

C. --- But the Heb. may be the sense of the Vulg. qui non accedunt. S. Jer. --- It may be a prayer, that God would offer a sort of violence to restrain the sallies of the sinner, (H.) and to convert him; (W.) or God threatens the obstinate with rigour of his justice. Many delude themselves, thinking that he will always treat them with lenity, and be ready to receive them. Bert. Is. xxxvii. 29. But the prophet admonishes them not to follow their senses alone, nor to imitate brute beasts, as he had done with regard to Bathsabée and Urias. M.

--- The bit (camus) was a sort of muzzle, "to hinder horses from biting."

Xenophon.

Ver. 10. Many. Sinners deserve much punishment. But if they will repent they may find mercy.

W. --- This may be also the declaration of God, though the prophet seem to speak in the next verse. Bert. --- God humbles the pride of haughty monarchs, like Sennacherib and Nabuchodonosor, treating them like beasts. C.

Ver. 11. Glory, which is lawful when God is the object. 1 Cor. i. 31. My glory I will not give to another. Is. xlii. 8. C. --- Heb. "praise him." S. Jer. H. --- Joy is the end of true penance, to which the prophet invites all. W.

PSALM 32

PSALM XXXII. (EXULTATE JUSTI.)

An exhortation to praise God, and to trust in him.

Ver. 1. David. There is no title in Heb.; and the Greek copies vary. This psalm may be considered as a continuation of the former, with the last verse of which it may be well connected.

C. --- Some suppose that David composed it after he had been rescued from the giant Jesbibenob.

v. 16. 1 Par. xx. 4. Ferrand. --- It is not certain that he is the author; but as other psalms without a title are ascribed to him, we have no reason to deny that he wrote this. Bert. --- Many explain it as a thanksgiving of Ezechias. Theod. &c.

--- But we need not refer it to any particular event. C.

--- Upright. But it is not seemly in the mouth of a sinner. Eccli. xv. 9. W. Ps. lxix.

16. C.

Ver. 2. Psaltery. Heb. nebel, (H.) which does not resemble the modern psaltery.

C. --- We must carefully observe mortification, and the decalogue. W.

Ver. 3. New. Interesting, like the canticle of the lamb, or of redemption, Apoc.

Public worship and music are very useful, when performed with attention.

Bert. --- The prophet invites all to praise God for the blessings granted by Christ in the new law. W. --- Noise, proceeding from the heart, the cry of which alone penetrates heaven. H.

Ver. 4. Faithfulness. He always fulfils his promises, and his laws are just; (W.) therefore he deserves our praise. C. Ps. cxliv. 13.)

Ver. 5. Judgment. God joins these virtues together, (W.) as we ought to do. H.

Lu. vi. 36. Mat.

v. 48. --- He punishes the wicked, and rewards the good. But his mercy displays itself on the earth, as there is no misery in heaven. S. Aug. --- Its effects appear more since the coming of our Saviour. C.

Ver. 6. Mouth, by his command. Euthym. Gen. i. 6. --- The Fathers here find the blessed Trinity expressed; (C. M.) and the Council of Trent admonishes us to follow their unanimous interpretation, which is here adopted by Baumbgarte, a Prot. 1719. S. John informs us that all was made by the Word, from whom the Father and the Holy Spirit cannot be separated. Bert. ---

Seneca (consol. 8.) seems to have had some idea of this mystery. Quisquis formator universi fuit, sive ille Deus est potens omnium; sive incorporalis Ratio, ingentium operum artifex; sive divinus Spiritus, per omnia maxima et minima æquali intentione diffusus. The power of them may designate the stars and angels, which the Heb. styles "the army" of heaven. Is. xxiv. 21. Mat.

xxvi. 53. C. --- The word of God is omnipotent, (W.) "the Creator...both of visible and invisible things." Nic. Creed. H. --- Calvin rejects this proof of the Trinity as weak, (Amama) as he did not like the word Trinity, nor perhaps the mystery itself. H.

Ver. 7. As in. This is agreeable to S. Aug. and some ancient psalters; though the Sept. have "like a bottle" made of leather, osei askon. Moderns would translate, "like a heap." But Sym. and S.

Jer. agree with us, (see Ps. lxxvii. 13. C.) as well as the Chal. and Houbigant.

God has made the bed of the sea capable of containing such quantities of water, some of which evaporate and descend again from the clouds, to make the earth fruitful. Yet many take no notice of this admirable economy. Bert. ---

Theodoret and S. Athanasius understand the clouds to be meant by this vessel; but the former sentiment seems better. These waters, as well as hail,

&c. are instruments of God's vengeance. Deut. xxxii. 34. The depths have the same import. God calls them forth at pleasure, (Amos v. 8. Gen. vii. 11.) and confines them within bounds. Job xxxviii.

11.

Ver. 9. Created. Heb. "on foot," to express God's absolute dominion. C. --- This passage shews that bra means properly created out of nothing. Gen. i. Matter did not exist before God spoke.

Bert.

Ver. 10. And...princes. This seems to be lost in Heb. as all the Greeks have recognised it. Bert.

--- God prepares the causes and means when he forms his decrees, which are wholly independent.

He is not forced to wait for a favourable opportunity. C. --- He confounded the tongues at Babel, and his absolute decrees are always executed. W.

Ver. 12. Inheritance, in opposition to the Gentiles. 1 Pet. ii. 9. Bert. --- God made choice particularly of the Jews, as he does now of Christians. W.

Ver. 14. Prepared. S. Jer. "from his most established throne;" whence he beholds all the conduct of men, (C.) though he fill all places, and work in all.

Bert. --- His power and wisdom (v. 15.) are infinite. W.

Ver. 15. Every one, sigillatim. Heb. yachad, means also "together;" whence the Origenists inferred (H.) that all souls were made at first with Adam. S. Jer. ---

Thus they explained how they came to be all infected. Bert. --- But God rather creates them when he infuses them into the body.

Carthus. H. --- S. Aug. could never decide this important question. This text only proves that God is equally Creator of all; (Eccli. xviii. 1. C.) and He alone made the hearts and souls of all men, as katamonas implies. Ps. iv. 10. and Geneb. Amama.

Ver. 16. Giant. Or Heb. "strong man." Monarchs and the stoutest men have been overthrown by Providence, like Pharaoh and Sennacherib, and the giant Og. C. --- History proves that great armies have not always gained the victory.

Ps. lxxv. 13. and cxxvi. 10. Bert.

Ver. 17. Safety. Either of himself or his master. W. Prov. xxi. 31. --- This can only be attributed to God's protection. v. 18.

Ver. 20. Waiteth. Heb. "longeth." H. --- Protector. Heb. "shield." Infidels deride the confidence of the just, as an effect of pride, supposing it is beneath the dignity of God to take notice of so small a creature, which he governs so many worlds. But if there be other worlds besides this, God is sufficient for all; (Bert.) and he will not neglect the work which his hands have deigned to form.

H.

Ver. 22. Thee. All-perfect Being, shew thy protection to all who trust in thee. W.

--- He who wishes to receive much, ought to increase his hopes. C. --- "Who is so full of hope as boldly to say, by my hope measure thy mercy?" Theod, PSALM 33

PSALM XXXIII. (BENEDICAM DOMINUM.)

An exhortation to the praise and service of God.

Ver. 1. Achimelech. So Clem. VIII. corrects what Sixtus V. had printed Abimelech, conformably to the Heb. &c. Some editors have since pretended that the word, (C.) which is retained in Berthier and Calmet,

though we should think such changes improper, unless they were made by proper authority. H.

--- Many of the ancients suppose that Achimelech (who is also styled Abimelech, the high priest at Nobe) is here meant, from whom David concealed his real design.

Euseb. S. Athan. S. Jer. &c. --- Others rather think that the psalm was composed after David had escaped the great danger at the court of Achis, by counterfeiting madness. 1 K. xxi. 13. S.

Aug. Muis, &c. --- Achis alone is styled king among the Satraps. Those who ruled over the Philistines, generally bore the title of Abimelech, as the Egyptian monarchs had that of Pharaoh.

Bert. Gen. xxi. 22. C. W. --- This psalm is alphabetical. The last verse beginning with p, is supernumerary, and may belong to the next psalm. See Ps. xxiv. C. ---

There seems also to be something wanting in v. 6. (Houbig.) unless e and v have each only one hemistic. H. --- From the change of names, and of David's countenance, S. Aug. gathers the vocation of the Gentiles, the real presence,

&c. W. See 1 K. xxi. H.

Ver. 2. Mouth. The just praise God in adversity, as well as in prosperity. W. ---

David had lately been delivered in a wonderful manner. C.

Ver. 3. Praised. Heb. "glory." Ps. xxxi. 11. H. --- Others, seeing my treatment will give praise to thee, the Author of all good, (C.) and I shall be praised while I serve thee. W.

Ver. 4. Together, (in idipsum). "If you love God, draw all to the love of God." S.

Aug. --- The multitude will not diminish his attention to you. C.

Ver. 5. Troubles. Heb. "fears or straits;" angustis. S. Jer. H. --- The Vulg. adopts the Alex.

Sept. thlipseon: the Vatican copy has, paroikion, "habitations," at Nobe, Geth,

&c. Seek the Lord, while he may be found. Is. lv. 6. Those who entertain doubts about religion, who are in sin, or tend to perfection, must all strive to find the Lord. The matter is of the utmost importance.

Bert.

Ver. 6. Come, "by faith and good works." S. Jer. --- Enlightened. Heb. also,

"flow together." S.

Jer. --- You need not be afraid of impoverishing him. C. --- The points would require, (Bert.)

"They looked...and were lightened, (Prot.) or flowed unto him. " Marg. H. --- But the Sept. &c.

knew nothing of them, and Houbigant agrees with our version. Bert. --- And.

Here v comes in its proper place, though for only half of the verse. H.

Ver. 7. This. I myself, whom you beheld in the midst of afflictions. H. --- Poverty is a great inducement for God to shew mercy. Bert. --- The poorest may approach without fear. W.

Ver. 8. Encamp. Lit. "send." H. --- This is explained of Jesus Christ, by S. Aug.

and S. Jerom.

C. --- Heb. and Sept. (parembalei) intimate that the angel himself shall encamp round God's servants, so that no evil shall come near them. H. --- This has often been verified. Gen. xxxii. 1.

and xlviii. 16. and 4 K. vi. 16. &c. C. --- One angel is here represented as equal to a great army.

A Prot. commentator observes, that David attributed his escape to the protection of an angel, and was very thankful for it. We see, therefore, what advantages we may derive from the blessed spirit? What then should hinder us from addressing our prayers to them? Bert.

Ver. 9. Taste, in the blessed Eucharist, (S. Athan. S. Aug. Theod.) or by experience. C. 1 Pet. ii.

3.

Ver. 10. Want. In the old law, God was more particularly engaged to defend his servants from distress. Though, as they were sometimes under oppression, they knew that they were to look for more substantial blessings from heaven.

Hence they would not have exchanged their condition for that of the richest worldling. Such ought to be still more our sentiments, since we have beheld Christ dying naked on the cross, and his martyrs rejoicing under the most excruciating torments.

C.

Ver. 11. Rich of this world, (1 Tim. vi. 17. M.) are often poor in spiritual gifts. W.

--- Those who are poor in both respects, are truly miserable, (H.) since they cannot satisfy their craving appetite.

But the prophet admires those who are poor in spirit, whether they have many possessions or not.

Bert. --- The fear of the Lord is his treasure. Is. xxxiii. 6. The saint is content under every dispensation of Providence. H. --- Lazarus was truly rich even here; and in heaven his is covered with glory. Lu. xvi. 20. S. Jer. C. --- Heb. "the lions have wanted." S. Jer. --- This may have been the case: yet those who fear God shall be filled; or, the rich may be designated by the name of lion's whelps, on account of their power and avidity. C. --- The same term, cephirim, is often applied to men in power. Ezec. xix 2. Job iv. 10. Bert. --- Good. If the saints be sometimes deprived of provisions, they know that it is better for them; as God directs all for their good. H.

Ver. 12. Children; docile and free from pride and hypocrisy.

Ver. 13. Good days. S. Peter (1 ep. iii. 10.) adopts this sense, though the Heb. is rendered, "and desireth days, that he may see good." The apostles shews that heaven is here principally meant, though a virtuous life is the best to procure even present happiness. Bert. --- Many of David's followers probably confined their views to the latter. C. --- Every one desireth to be happy, but only the virtuous are really so. W.

Ver. 14. Guile. He very properly begins with regulating the tongue, as this member may prove very dangerous. Prov. xviii. 21. Jam. iii. 5. By detraction, it wounds three people; and it causes no less evil by flattery. C.

Ver. 15. Good. It will not suffice to refrain from criminal actions. Ps. xxxvi. 27.

--- Peace, both private and public. Jer. xxix. 7. C. --- A person may, notwithstanding, have much to suffer. But S. Peter prevents this objection, by proclaiming those happy who suffer for justice sake. v. 14.

Bert. --- Good works are necessary as well as faith. W.

Nam frustra vitium vitaveris illud

Si te alio pravum detorseris. Hor. ii. sat. 2.

Ver. 16. Eyes. S. Basil understands the angels. God protects his servants, (H.) while he treats the wicked with severity. C.

Ver. 17. To cut, &c. S. Peter leaves this out; perhaps because temporal punishments would not be so often inflicted upon the wicked under the new law; as God tries his faithful, and teaches them to wait till judgment, when all will be treated according to their deserts. Bert. --- He sees all men's actions, and will reward them accordingly. W.

Ver. 18. Just. This word is omitted in Heb. but it is supplied by al the versions; which shews that the original is not quite perfect. Bert. --- If this were left out, the passage would refer to the wicked, v. 16. Yet S. Jerom found the Heb. in this state. H. --- Troubles. Many experienced

the divine protection in a wonderful manner, and though others fell victims to persecution, (Heb. xi.

36.) yet they were perfectly resigned to God's will, (Bert.) and thus obtained their wishes, receiving a better reward in eternity. C.

Ver. 19. Them. Heb. "broken-hearted;" to the humble and distressed. H. --- God is very near to such. C. Ps. l. 19. and xc. 15. See S. Polyc. ad Phil. ii.

Ver. 20. Many. David was too well informed to promise that the just would experience no affliction? but it will not last for ever. C. Heb. xii. 6. --- If God seem to forsake them for a time, he gives them interior strength, and will at last crown his own gifts. W.

Ver. 21. Broken. Their virtue which is denoted by the bones, (M.) shall not sink under torments.

So Christ encouraged his disciples, by assuring them that a hair of their head should not perish.

Mat. x. 30. S. Aug. C. --- The elements of our bodies cannot be divided or destroyed by human force, so as to prevent their resurrection. The identical bodies shall rise again, though they may have been subject to many changes, reduced to ashes, or consumed by wild beasts. This mystery has often offended incredulous philosophers. Jesus Christ is the just, by excellence; and this prediction was fulfilled in his person, as S. John (xix. 36.) does not confine himself to the type of the paschal lamb. Bert.

Ver. 22. Evil, or "bad." Chal. Heb. also, "malice shall slay the wicked." They can attribute their misfortunes only to their own misconduct. Bert. --- Guilty, and shall be treated as criminals; a fate which the just shall never experience, v. 23.

The death of Saul seems to be foretold. C. ---

The wicked are forced to quit the world and their bodies which they have idolized, and are hurled into everlasting fire. S. Bern. --- In punishment of former transgressions, they are suffered to fall into more sins; while those who place their confidence in God's grace, will be preserved. W. ---

"Death is not indeed the last, but those torments destined for the profligate in hell, occupy the last place." Plato, Leg. ix.

Ver. 23. Redeem. This verse greatly resembles that which is placed, in like manner, out of the alphabetical order, at the end of Ps. xxiv. Heb. in both,

"Redeem, O Lord," &c. H.

PSALM 34

PSALM XXXIV. (JUDICA DOMINE NOCENTES ME.)

David, in the person of Christ, prayeth against his persecutors: prophetically foreshewing the punishments that shall fall upon them.

Ver. 1. David. Some of the Greek copies add, "psalm," and "unto the end." It was composed during the persecutions of Saul, &c. and is applied by the Fathers to Jesus Christ, who quotes v.

19, (Jo. xv. 25. C.) and it seems to be in the same state with several others, which speak of his sufferings. Bert. --- The expressions are very animated, and though vengeance was not so strictly forbidden under the old law, (Matt. v. 44.) yet we may explain them as predictions. Theod. ---

David always evinces the greatest moderation, (Ps. vii. 5.) and treated even Saul with the utmost respect. What he says, therefore, was dictated by a sincere desire of their conversion, and that they might prevent eternal torments. Asterius. C. --- His name implies one "beloved," &c.

inasmuch as he is a figure of Christ, the conqueror of death and hell. S. Aug.

W. --- Judge. Heb.

"plead." I do not wish them to be condemned unheard. C. --- A vindictive person does not thus commit his cause to God. Jesus Christ was all mildness.

But in the spiritual warfare, we may well address these words to God, (Bert.) who is often represented as a mighty warrior. Ex. xv. 3.

C.

Ver. 2. Arms. Heb. magen, "buckler," of a smaller size (1 K. xvii. 6, 7.) than the shield, (tsinna) which was used to cover the whole body. S. Jerom renders the latter word by hastam, "the spear."

C. --- But this text speaks of defensive weapons.

Ver. 3. The way. This may be implied by the word conclude, which Houbigant rejects, observing that S. Jerom has præoccupa, (Bert.) as it is in the Par. ed.

1583. H. --- But I fiind præcipita.

Bert. --- "Prevent" the designs, stop the passage, or "hurl my persecutors headlong." H. --- Take offensive weapons. He foretells the ruin of those who persecuted the Church. W. --- Salvation, though my enemies deny it. Ps. iii. 2.

Ver. 4. Let them. So most people render the Heb. though it may be understood in the future, (Bert.) as Montanus translates. H. --- Me. The wicked shall be confounded in the end, when the just shall triumph. W.

Ver. 5. Dust. Heb. mots, small "chaff." Ps. i. 4. Vatab. --- Angel. The evil spirits are employed to punish the wicked, as good protect the just. Ps. xxxiii. 8.

Some Fathers have supposed that every man was attended by a good and a bad angel. Hermes ii. Orig. xxxv. in Lu. S. Greg. Nys.

vit. Mos. Cassian viii. 17. and xiii. 12. --- But the Church admits the power of the wicked spirits only against those who take part with them, or "as far as God allows them" (S. Jer.) to tempt. The devil is like a dog chained down, which can bite none but those who come within its reach. S.

Aug. --- Both good and bad angels are ministers of God's justice. H.

Ver. 6. Slippery. The systems of infidels, who deny a future existence are of this nature. If they were even true, the just would have lost nothing by pursuing a virtuous course. Bert.

Ver. 7. Their. Lit. "the destruction of their net." H. --- Some would translate shachath, "the pit of," &c. But the Sept. is preferable; and chapheru means the have "covered with shame," as well as dug for my soul. Bert. --- Pit ought to be removed to the latter part of the verse. Saul laid many falsehoods to the charge of David, (C.) and insidiously sought his ruin. H.

Ver. 8. Fall. He foretells the destruction of Saul, and his own glory. C.

Ver. 9. Salvation. In the midst of troubles he is not devoid of hope, and after his deliverance he looks for eternal happiness. W.

Ver. 10. Lord. Some Latin copies repeated this, while others in the original passed over the word entirely. S. Jer. ad. Sun. --- Be thou my life whom I always seek." S. Aug. --- Poor, in general, or David, who was supplied by Abimelech with food, 1 K. xxi. 3. C.

Ver. 11. Not. Accusing me of disloyalty, &c. Flaminus. --- We must not imagine that David was cited to the bar. This is admirably explained of Jesus Christ at the tribunal of Pilate, (C.) and of the high priests. H. Mat. xxvi. --- God knows not what cannot be; (W.) and therefore Christ could not acknowledge what was falsely laid to his charge. H. --- The martyrs, &c. have often been exposed to the shafts of calumny. Bert.

Ver. 12. Depriving, sterilitatem. H. --- Heb. denotes the condition of one who has lost a husband or father. --- I had exposed my life for the welfare of the state, and of those who now seek my ruin. C. --- Yet David was not slain. This was verified in our Saviour. W. --- Sept. have ateknian, "loss of children;" as Christ was abandoned by his disciples. M.

Ver. 13. To me. Heb. also signify, "when they were sick," which manifests a more heroic charity; though yet it is more natural to suppose that David would assume these robes of penance when he was under affliction, as S. Jerom intimates, cum infirmarer ab eis. Bert. --- Our Saviour's life was a continual penance, though he stood in no need of it for himself. W. --- David was aware that the best method of avoiding the attacks of his enemies, was to make God his friend, by sentiments of humility, and by penance. S. Aug. C. --- Bosom. I shall reap the advantage from my prayer, if it be of no service to my enemies.

Geneb. Lu. x. 6. M. --- May what I wish for my enemies fall to my own lot. I have prayed for them in secret and with the utmost fervour. C. --- I have repeatedly urged my request, (Houbig.) or I am confident my prayer will be of some service, at least to myself. Bert.

Ver. 14. Please, complacebam, "treat lovingly." H. --- Vulg. follows the regimen of the Sept.

euerestoun, which may govern an accusative case. Heb. is plainer, I walked,"

(Bert.) or "behaved myself as though he had been my friend or brother." Prot.

H. --- So. Sept. seem to have explained am, "truly," instead of mother; as the points would determine the Heb. "like one who bewails his mother;" (Bert.) or,

"like a mother mourning, I bowed down in grief." S. Jer. --- An ancient Greek interpreter has, "like one mourning for a brother born of the same mother." I felt the affliction of my enemies and sympathized with

them, endeavouring to alleviate their distress as much as possible. C. --- Such was the conduct of David, the figure of the Messiah; so that the expressions which seem too strong, must not be taken for imprecations. Bert. --- Christ was the good Samaritan who relieved the wounded man. Luke x. W. --- S. Paul admonishes us to weep with those who weep. Rom. xii. 15. M.

Ver. 15. Against me. Heb. "in my distress," (Houbig.) or "infirmity." S. Jer. ---

Thus was my kind attention repaid. H. --- My enemies became only the more insolent, and stood beside me, to shew their contempt. C. --- Scourges. Heb.

also, "vile men." Mont. H. --- The Rom. psalters have "and they were ignorant,"

ignoraverunt. C. --- David could not think that he had given any offence: much less had our Saviour. H. --- He knew no just cause why the Jews persecuted him, as they were actuated by malice. W. --- David knew not personally those who afflicted him. M.

Ver. 16. Separated, and could not agree in their testimonies. This may be one meaning of charak, as it has several. Bert. -- "They did tear me, and ceased not, (16) with hypercritical mockers in feasts, they gnashed," &c. Prot. H. ---

Many of their attempts have been frustrated by thy Providence, yet they do not enter into themselves. Theod.

Ver. 17. One. Sept. "daughter." Aquila, "solitary," monachen. Prot. "darling," or my soul which is so desolate. Ps. xxi. 21. H. --- So Christ said, Why hast thou abandoned me? (Mat. xxvii.) not affording me such consolation as other saints enjoy in their agony. W.

Ver. 18. Strong, gravi. Heb. hatsum, numerous, (1 Mac. i. 1. M.) and "weighty,"

(H.) which is the consequence of great numbers, (Bert.) and of virtue. S. Aug.

understands the Church, which is not carried away like chaff before the wind.

Amama dislike this. H. --- The resurrection is foretold, (v. 17.) and here the Catholic Church is signified. W.

Ver. 19. Wrongfully. Heb. "liars," (S. Jer. H.) alluding to Saul, &c. C. Christ explains this of himself. Jo. xv. W. --- Who. Some supply a negation. Bert. --- "

Neither let them wink with the eye who." Prot. This sign might indicate friendship, or evil machinations. Prov. vi. 13. and x.

10. C. --- "They pretended by their looks what they did not entertain in their hearts." S. Aug. M.

Ver. 20. Spoke. Heb. adds lo, "not." But it may be better explained as an interrogation. "Have they not spoken?" &c. as the enemies used deceit.

Houbig. Bert. --- Earth. This word is omitted in the Sept. Rom. S. Aug. &c. But Theodoret reads it, and it is in all the other Greek interpreters, and in the Arab.

and Syriac. C. --- Heb. "they devise deceitful matters against them that are quiet (righe, divided, &c.) in the land." Prot. or "in the plunder of the earth they devise deceit." S. Jer.

H. --- They appear friendly, but when alone they talk to the earth, like people in deep study and full of passion. C. --- This terrestrial anger is the source of much evil. Bert. --- The Jews and Herodians said, Master, &c. designing to inveigle our Saviour. Mat. xxi. The priests and Pharisees also accused him boldly, and instigated the people to demand his crucifixion. W. ---

They were split into parties, and invaded those who were the reverse of passionate. M.

Ver. 21. Done, euge. Heb. heach. H. --- This term occurs ten times in Scripture, and here denotes the joy felt in the destruction of an enemy. Thus the Jews insulted over Christ expiring on the cross. Bert. --- Seen. No farther reserve is necessary: he is fallen, or we have accused him of nothing but what we have seen. C.

Ver. 22. Silent. I have chosen thee for my judge and protector. C. --- Pronounce sentence if they be in the right; and if not, rescue me from their fury. H.

Ver. 23. Attentive. Heb. "watch over." He implores present assistance. Bert.

Ver. 24. Thy. Many copies read "my," with S. Aug. Euthym. &c. But thy agrees with the Rom.

(C.) and Alex. Sept. and Heb. H.

Ver. 25. It is well, occurs only once in Heb. which may be imperfect, as many versions supply the second. Bert. --- Mind, as we could have desired. Prot.

"Oh, (marg. adds ah) so would we have it." H. --- Things go on well according to our mind. M.

Ver. 26. Great. S. Aug. reads, "malicious." C. --- At the day of judgment the wicked will be condemned. W. --- If this judgment were not to take place, religion would be a fable: as impiety is not always punished in this world. Bert.

Ver. 27. Them. The blessed in eternal glory. W. --- Justice. Or wish that sentence may be pronounced in my favour. C. --- Delight. Heb. "who delights."

S. Jer. H. --- But the Greek interpreters read as we do. Bert.

Ver. 28. Meditate. Heb. word is used to signify speaking with refection. C.

PSALM 35

PSALM XXXV. (DIXIT INJUSTUS.)

The malice of sinners, and the goodness of God.

Ver. 1. Himself. Psalm is understood. It is expressed in S. Amb. and S. Jerom, (C.) and is the Alex. Sept. H. --- Eusebius improperly assigns the cause of the omission to the piece being of a moral nature. Many suppose it refers to Saul, who had promised that he would give ear no more to the detractors of David, when the latter restored to him his spear and cup. 1 K. xxvi. Theod.

&c. --- But it seems rather to express the sentiments of the captives at Babylon, like the Psalms x.

xi. xiii. and lii. C. --- David gloried in the title of servant of the Lord, though he bore the sceptre.

Ps. xvii. Bert. Ps. cxv. 16. M. --- He applies this instruction to himself, and to all in the lowest stations. W.

Ver. 2. Himself. Heb. libbi, "in my heart." But this is visibly incorrect, and we should substitute lobu, as S. Jer. Chal. Syr. &c. have done. C. --- Yet Sym.

translates, "concerning the disorder of the impious within, my heart has said, there," &c. Heb. may also signify, "the transgression of the wicked saith within my heart." Prot. H. --- I am inwardly convinced how great the malice of the wicked may be. It touches me to the very heart. Both senses are good. The wicked are bent on evil, and this fills the virtuous with grief. Bert. --- Eyes.

They sin publicly, (Ps. xiii. 1. C.) and on purpose, preferring vice before virtue, (W.) and constantly bent on doing evil, so that they become

odious to all. M.

Ver. 3. Unto hatred. That is, hateful to God (Ch.) and man; (H.) or that he may be able to hurt, as Hebrew also may insinuate. Bert. --- Sept. "to find and hate his iniquity." But he acts not with sincerity. He wishes to defend his evil ways.

S. Aug. &c. --- He still flatters himself with impunity. Ps. ix. 25. or x. 11. To find, often means to punish. Gen. xlv. 16. &c. C. --- God frequently abandons those who sin through malice. W.

Ver. 4. Well, to those in distress. Ps. xl. 2. Though wise enough in worldly concerns, he seemed quite ignorant when any virtuous actions were proposed. C. --- Sometimes ignorance is excusable when a person does his best to obtain knowledge. But when he is negligent, the ignorance is gross, and sinful in proportion to the importance of the thing. If one desire to be ignorant to prevent remorse, this only increases the guilt, and God often leaves such destitute of the ordinary graces which he gives to others; so that they fall into a reprobate sense, and into more horrible sins. W.

Ver. 5. Set himself, "persevering" in wickedness. S. Aug.

Ver. 6. Clouds. The mercy of God is great, and his fidelity indisputable. Some think these were concealed till the coming of the Messias; (Ps. lxxxiv. 11. S.

Bern.) and many of the Fathers accuse Aristotle of confining Providence to the regions above the moon, by perverting this text.

S. Clem. strom. 5. &c. --- But Gesner has produced 30 passages from that author which prove both a general and particular Providence. C. -- God does not leave the most wilful sinner without some good motions, and sufficient grace, that they may repent if they do not harden their own hearts. He has promised such helps, and is most faithful and desirous to receive again the penitent sinner. W.

Ver. 7. Of God. A title which is often given to things of superior excellence. So divine condimenta of Plautus, (Pseudol.) denote ragouts or sauces of the best quality; (H.) and sacra fames of Virgil, means great hunger. See Jon. iii. 3.

Cant. viii. 6. --- Deep. After praising the mercy of God, the psalmist expresses his admiration of his inscrutable justice. Rom. xi. 33. C.

--- Preserve, salvabis. The latter are designed only for man's benefit, and will end with time. H.

--- But man is destined for eternal happiness, v. 9. C. --- God wishes the salvation of both the learned and of the stupid, (S. Jer. W.) of the Jew and Gentile, (Arnob. 1 Tim. iv. 10.) of good and bad. He makes his sun to shine on both. Mat. v. 45. Euseb. Piscat. C.

Ver. 8. O how. So the Heb. and Sept. read; quemadmodum may also (Bert.) signify "as." God has given such proofs of his great mercies to all. H. --- Of men. People must lay aside their stupidity and resemblance with brutes, to obtain the eternal joys which are prepared for men. W.

Ver. 9. House. In the temple, (C.) or in the Church of God. S. Amb. --- The pleasures enjoyed by this communion of saints, (H.) is but a foretaste of what may be expected in heaven. C.

Ver. 10. With thee, Lord, is the fountain of life, Jesus Christ. --- See light, of the Holy Ghost. S.

Amb. Theod. --- We shall see thee, Father of light, in thy Son. Orig. Prin. i. 1. C.

--- The saints behold in the light of God all that they can desire to know; and of course they will not be unacquainted with our wants and petitions, though they have not the asses' ears of Calvin. H. ---

Light and life denote all happiness. C. --- The psalmist might have a sublime idea of these pleasures. Bert. --- But none will presently

understand their excellence till they are put in possession of them. H.

Ver. 11. Mercy and justice, are here of the same import. Bellar. Muis. --- Deliver us from captivity, and extend thy mercies to all thy people. C. -- - Heart. Many who have sufficient learning, are destitute of this better quality. The right of heart are always more knowing than those who are only learned in speculation, and puffed up with pride. Bert.

Ver. 12. Sinner. Heb. and Sept. "sinners," who are always striving to supplant the just by pride and evil example. Bert. --- Let me not listen to their wicked advice. S. Aug. --- Let not the enemy invade our country any more. C. --- The just may pray that no bad example or pride may place an obstacle to his salvation. W.

Ver. 13. There. The devil fell by pride, and man by his persuasion. Neither could escape punishment. W. --- There, in heaven, (S. Jer.) and in paradise, pride proved fatal; (C.) while it will be punished in hell. S. Amb. --- Pride and injustice will entail destruction upon our persecutors. Babylon shall shortly fall a prey to Cyrus. C. --- Stand. Heb. "kum," "rise again."

The proud are seldom converted, (Bert.) and the rebel angels had no redress.

M.

PSALM 36

PSALM XXXVI. (NOLI ÆMULARI.)

An exhortation to despise this world; and the short prosperity of the wicked; and to trust in providence.

Ver. 1. Himself. Heb. has simply, "for David," (C.) as well as the Greek of the Vat. "It is a mistake in Bellanger to say in general that the Greek adds "a psalm," since this is true only with respect to the edit. of Aldus and Comp.

says Berthier. But he is not quite accurate, as Erasmus inserts "a psalm" in his edition of S. Jerom's Sept.; and the Alex. copy, which is equally famous with that of the Vatican, has [unto the end, a psalm] for David. Grabe has indeed marked all but the last word as a peculiarity, or not to be found in Origen's copy. But he has published his edition with such accuracy, that we may distinguish what his MS. contained from other interpolations. It were to be wished that the same attention had been paid to the Vatican copy.

But hitherto all the editors have taken the liberty to make alterations without specifying where; so that we can have no security that we ever quote the real MS. of the Vatican. The learned prefect, Zacagni, gives abundant proof of this in his letter to Grabe, which has been published by Kennicott, Diss. 2. Yet any of these editions may be quoted as the Greek or Sept. as we have yet no copy perfectly authentic: and the learned are not even agreed which standard ought to be followed. If that which presents the greatest number of Origen's corrections be preferable, the Alex. MS. must bear away the psalm. If the reverse, the glory must be given to its rival in the Vatican, which approaches the nearest to the koine, or to the edition of S. Lucian. See Kennicott.

These remarks may be of service, as Berthier often seems inclined to place the Vat. edit. on the same level as the Latin Vulg. H. --- This psalm is alphabetical.

The Syriac, Sept. &c. read, (v.

28) the unjust, &c. ávilim; a word which seems now to be deficient in the Heb.

which has no ver.

beginning with á. C. --- Some other derangement has taken place. Houbig. ---

The verses might be so divided as to begin every second verse with a fresh letter, and so to retain 42 verses. See v.

7. and 20. The matter is of no great importance. The prophet has comprised several duties in alphabetical order, to help the memory, (Bert.) and to excite attention. W. --- He may predict the death of Saul, (Rabbins) or hint at the rebellion of Absalom in his old age; (v. 25. Ferrand) or rather he may comfort the captives at Babylon, promising them liberty, and denouncing the fall of their oppressors, above ten times. He admonishes them not to be scandalized at the distress of the just, and the prosperity of the wicked. C. --- Emulous.

Heb. "Fret not thyself." Prot. "Mingle not with;" (Bert. Pagnin) "contend not." S.

Jer. H. --- Envy. Their splendour is deceitful. C. ---

Be not, therefore, seduced (H.) to imitate the wicked (M.) nor offended, that they should prosper here. W.

Ver. 2. Wither. Heb. "be cut down." C. --- Fall. Heb. "wither." S. Jer. H. --- This admirably describes the transient glory of sinners. Is. xl. 6. Jam. i. 10. C. --- All life is short. W. 1 Pet. i.

24. M.

Ver. 3. Riches. Sept. and Houb. read emuné, "abundance." Heb. begins with a.

The sense is much the same. Bert. --- "Thou shalt feed on faith," (S. Jer.) or

"incessantly." Sym. --- The Jews entertained the greatest desire of the promised land. C. --- It may here denote our soul, (Orig.) the Church, (S. Aug.) the Scriptures, (S. Athan.) or heaven. S. Jer. &c. C. --- Trust in God and be content. He will give thee what is requisite. W.

Ver. 4. Heart. Provided they be rational. S. Aug. --- He will enable thee to repose in peace, and to taste innocent pleasures in the Lord. C.

Ver. 5. Commit. Lit. "lay open." Heb. "roll." H. --- This expresses the most unbounded confidence. Ps. liv. 23. Prov. xvi. 3. --- Do it. Whatever may be proper. He will display thy justice, (v. 6.) and free the from anxiety, (C.) taking care of thee. 1 Pet. v. 7. M.

Ver. 6. Day. This will appear at the last judgment. S. Aug.

Ver. 7. Be. Heb. dom, begins only this verse with d. The other letters occupy two verses, (Bert.) the second of which may commence with any of the letters.

H. --- "Be silent to the Lord; wait upon Him." S. Jer. H. --- If he should suffer thee to be afflicted, envy not those who are in a more prosperous condition, nor give way to indignation. v. 8. C. --- None can be truly subjected to God, who do not comply with his laws and pray. Orig. S. Aug. --- We must wait patiently for his aid. Lam. iii. 26. Is. xxx. 15. "Allow the gods to judge what's best for us."

Juv. Sat. 13. H.

Ver. 8. Evil. Repining (M.) at the ways of Providence, &c. C. v. 1. --- Reflect on God's will. H.

--- Laboras; sed in via Dei. S. Aug. --- Heb. "be not angry nevertheless (ac, a word which Houbig. deems useless) to do evil;" (Mont.) or "against the wicked," (Prin. dis.) as lehareah may be perhaps signified; though it is more usually taken for a verb, as the points decide. Bert.

Ver. 9. Land of the living. W. --- David knew that many truly pious people would never obtain riches in the land of Chanaan, even though they might have remained there, if the nation had been faithful. He therefore comforts them with the prospect of a better land. If this were not the meaning, the Church would put these canticles in the mouth of her children to little purpose.

Bert.

Ver. 10. While. Till the day of judgment. Orig. S. Amb. --- And shalt. Heb. "and it shall not be. " Prot. "it, or he shall not subsist." S. Jer. H. -- The state of the wicked is not therefore so enviable. The captives witnessed the fall of the great Colossus, the empire of the Babylonians.

C.

Ver. 11. Meek. Heb. hanavim, also means "the afflicted." Bert. --- Captives, ye shall be reinstated in your dear country. Our Saviour alludes to this text, (Mat.

v. 4.) and the Fathers beautifully explain it of heaven. Euseb. S. Aug. C. --- What is now become of those who have heretofore filled the world with tumult and bloodshed to obtain dominion! They are confined to the land where everlasting horror and on order dwells. They would wish they had never existed, as our Saviour mentions; while those who passed through life unknown, or despised, but always seeking God, are now arrived at the summit of all their wishes. H.

--- O holy religion! thou explainest all these things. The just have ceased to exist: but their better part has inherited the land of the living. Yet a little while, and all will be in order, and in its proper place; though that of the wicked deserves not the name. Bert.

Ver. 12. Watch. Heb. "plot against." H. --- Teeth. In rage to destroy him, (C.) whose virtue is a continual censure of his impiety. H.

Ver. 13. Laugh. This expression is often used to denote the triumph of divine justice, whose day will set all right: that day (2 Tim. iv. 8.) which ought to be constantly before our eyes. Bert. ---

God cannot indeed mock at any one. C. --- But the wicked "deserve scorn and vengeance." H.

--- Digni sunt ut irrideantur in vindictâ. S. Jer. --- The day of their judgment or condemnation is at hand, (Ezec. xxi. 21. 1 K. xxvi. 10. H.) when they will be sought for in vain (v. 10. C.) by their foolish

admirers. They will seek to hide themselves from the indignation of the Lamb.

Ver. 14. Heart. Heb. "of way." Prot. "such as be of upright conversation." Only those whose heart is pure, will observe the right path. H.

Ver. 15. Broken. In the form of imprecation, he foretells the event. W. --
- Heb. is in the future, to imply as much. Bert.

Ver. 16. Wicked. Heb. "of many wicked," or "of the impious great ones." H. ---

What the just man hath, is preferable to the immense riches of sinners, acquired by injustice. In this sense Hesiod and Psittacus said, "half is more than all." The wicked are never satisfied. Eccle. iv. 6.

Prov. xiii. 25. Riches are a dangerous temptation, (C.) and the sentence is generally true, "every rich person is either unjust or the heir of one who has been such," (H.) aut hæres injusti. S. Jer.

--- It is difficult for the rich to enter heaven; and the unjust are certainly excluded. Yet if we confined our views to this world, it is evident that the rich may better procure the sweets of life.

Bert.

Ver. 17. Arms of the body, brachia. All that they have admired perishes in death, (C.) while the just then possess true riches.

Ver. 18. Days, or "ways," according to some copies of Sept. S. Aug. &c. God approves the conduct of the just. He takes notice of the time of their sufferings, and comforts them during life, (C.) yea, for ever.

Ver. 20. Because. Only this verse begins with c, as the seventh does with d. H.

--- Smoke. All their riches shall vanish, and their works be disregarded by God.

But they will not be annihilated, as they would desire; otherwise the justice of God would not be executed on them. Bert. ---

There is a continual antithesis between the good and bad. The latter shall shortly lose all their splendour. "I fear, lest offending the gods, I may receive glory among men," said the poet Ibicus, (C.) conformably to our Saviour's declaration concerning the vain-glorious, they have received their reward. Mat.

vi. 6. Heb. "shall be as the fat of lambs, consumed and reduced to smoke."

H. --- S. Jerom seems to have read differently, "boasting like unicorns, they shall be consumed, as smoke, they shall be consumed." Syr. and Chal.

intimate that they shall be like victims,

"fattened" for slaughter, and burnt. C.

Ver. 21. Give. Having both the will and the power to be liberal. H. --- "He shall lend without expecting any advantage, while the wicked falls into such misery as not to be able to pay his debts. This is not always the order of Providence.

C. --- But the just is often enabled by economy to relieve his brethren, at the same time that the libertine wastes his estate, (Bert.) or at least unjustly defers to pay his debts. M.

Ver. 22. Bless him. The just, (v. 21. Prin. disc.) or rather the Lord, v. 20. Bert. ---

"Are blessed of him," &c. S. Jer. Chal. H.

Ver. 23. With. Or by the decrees of the Lord. The Heb. and Sept. have, "By,"

para. Bert. ---

God gives grace to do all good, (Prov. xvi. 9. C.) and likes the way which He points out. The just also find the greatest consolation in virtue. H.

Ver. 24. Him. To break the fall. Heb. "the Lord upholdeth him with his hand."

Prot. H. --- The just man is like a courageous wrestler, who may slip, but yields not. Orig. Euseb. --- His fall is not mortal, (C.) though he may be guilty of venial sin. Prov. xxiv. W.

Ver. 25. Seeking, in vain. H. --- Rom. and Gothic Ps. read, "wanting." This does not condemn the mendicant orders. M. --- Nothing was more unusual under the old law than the extreme distress of the just: yet Job and Lazarus were reduced to it. They were not, however, discontent.

C. --- They found the bread of life in conformity to God's will. Jo. iv. 34. H. ---

Their souls were enriched with grace, which was never wanting, as the Fathers explain this passage. Bert. Amos viii. 11. --- It is certain that there were poor among the Jews; (Deut. xv. 11.) and who would assert that they were all wicked, or the children of such? Yet the prophet had not witnessed (C.) any person renowned for virtue reduced to this condition, (H.) though he does not deny but it might be possible. C. --- The proposition may be restrained to those who have been very charitable, and who are not often thereby reduced to want.

Dan. iv. 24. Genebrard. M. --- But the word just is more comprehensive; and S.

Paul gives several instances of persecuted saints (Heb. xi.) which is confirmed by the parable, or rather by the history, of Lazarus. Bert. --- At any rate, the Church is never deprived of the word of God. S. Aug. W.

Ver. 26. Lendeth. "To receive interest," daneizei, from God. Prov. xix. 17. S.

Aug. &c. C. ---

He maketh know the divine word. Orig.

Ver. 27. Dwell in the land of the living, rather than in that of promise, from which many just people were banished during the captivity. Bert. --- He who complies with these two conditions, will inherit heaven. W.

Ver. 28. Saints. Heb. "merciful ones." He will free them from captivity. C. ---

Punished. This sentence seems to be improperly omitted in Heb. which otherwise neglects the letter á, as the Chal. Syr. and S. Jer. do as well as a few copies of the Sept. The Rom. edit. with the Arab. and Ethiopic, reads amomoi ekdikethesontai, "the innocent shall be avenged," (C.) or "punished;"

which is inaccurately put for anomoi ekdiochthesontai, the wicked shall be punished, or

"expelled;" (Bert.) though Grabe prefers the former verb. H. --- S. Cyril acknowledges both readings. C.

Ver. 31. Supplanted. The devil shall have no advantage over the just, (C.) who aim constantly at perfection. Orig.

Ver. 32. Death, mortificare. Some read perdere, or occidere. The wicked are constantly laying snares for destruction, (C.) and to draw others into mortal sin. W.

Ver. 33. Judged, "by him." Illi seems to be superfluous; (Bert.) or it implies that God will revise the sentence of wicked judges. H. --- The just have nothing to fear. God will pass an equitable sentence, and the condemnation of men shall do no harm. Orig. --- The mistakes of human tribunals prove the necessity of a general judgment.

Ver. 34. See the truth of these maxims. C. --- While the wicked enjoy power they often conceal their injustice, which appears as soon as the

veil is removed by death, when people cease to fear them. H.

Ver. 35. Cedars, &c. Sept. have read differently from the present Heb. and present a more beautiful sense. C. --- Prot. "and spreading himself like a green bay-tree, (marg. or "a green tree that groweth in his own soil,") yet he passed away, and lo," &c. H. --- Ezrach, denotes an evergreen, (Rabbins) "a laurel covered with verdure." C. --- Houbigant has "a cedar," ezrach.

Ver. 36. I passed. This is better than the Heb. "it has passed," transivit, as a tree changes not its place, and all the ancient interpreters agree with us. Bert.

--- His place, is not expressed in Heb.

But it implies that every vestige of the proud is soon lost. This might serve to curb the violence of those who disturb mankind! H. --- The wicked may here refer to Nabuchodonosor, the devil, Judas, &c. C. --- We may behold the riches of sinners with our bodily eyes: but if we consider them with the eyes of faith, they presently vanish. S. Amb. S. Aug.

Ver. 37. Remnants, or rewards. W. --- Heb. acharith, "the reward," (Pag.) "the last end of man is peace," (Mont. H.) or "the posterity (v. 38.) of such a man shall be happy." C. --- "There are future things for the peaceful." Sym. --- The expectations of the just are not confined to this world. They have something laid up for heaven, whereas the wicked have nothing. H. --- These lose all by death; and the thought makes them take refuge in the foolish hope of being annihilated. Bert.

Ver. 38. Together. At the last day, (H.) or all without exception shall perish; the wicked, with their posterity and riches. W.

Ver. 39. Salvation. This is an effect of God's grace. W.

PSALM 37

PSALM XXXVII. (DOMINE NE IN FURORE.)

A prayer of a penitent for the remission of his sins. The third penitential psalm.

Ver. 1. For a remembrance, viz. of our miseries and sins; and to be sung on the sabbath-day. Ch.

--- This sabbath might also allude to the indolent rest which occasioned the fall of David. 2 K. xi.

1. H. --- Heb. mentions not the sabbath; and it is not known (C.) why the Sept.

made this addition. The prophet may have Christ suffering for our sins in view, (Bert.) though he probably composed this psalm, when he was afflicted with an illness after this fall. Rab. Muis, &c. C. ---

It contains an excellent model for penitents, (C.) to enable them to regain peace of conscience, (S.

Greg.) and paradise, from which they are banished by sin. S. Aug. --- This remembrance (W.) is most essential. H.

Ver. 2. Wrath. God is incapable of passion: but man deserves to be treated with the utmost rigour; and this David deprecates, begging that God would act rather like a physician in his regard. Theod. C. --- The same petition occurs in psalm vi.; and this ought to caution people not to make imprecations, since God's judgments are so terrible. Bert. --- S. Aug. and S. Greg.

explain this text of the fire of hell, and of purgatory. 1 Cor. iii. 15. H. --- Though some be saved by the latter, "yet is that fire more grievous than whatever man can suffer in this life." S. Aug. ---

"I esteem that transitory fire more intolerable than all present tribulation." S.

Greg. W. --- We may therefore pray, "Here burn," &c. with the same S. Aug. who assures us, (Gen. con. Man. ii.

20.) that "he who cultivates not the field of his soul, will, after this life, experience either the fire of purgatory or eternal punishment." H.

Ver. 3. Arrows. Afflictions, (W.) or the word of God, which convert the sinner. S.

Aug. --- The admonition of Nathan had made the deepest impression on David.

He was also visited by sickness, like Job vi. 4. and xix. 21.

Ver. 4. Sins. These occasion my great affliction, when I reflect on thy justice.

W. --- I chastise myself. Euseb. --- S. Aug. explains all this of original sin. C. ---

Jesus bore the weight of all our sins, which are above our comprehension, v.

5. Bert.

Ver. 5. Me. They press upon me like a deluge or huge weight. C. --- The sin of David had many aggravations. Bert. --- His punishment was also great. C. ---

His spirit was almost overwhelmed, as the sins which are not bewailed, bring on other transgressions. W. --- It is not so much sin as the neglect of penance, which destroys men. Bert. --- This folly is here acknowledged by David.

H.

Ver. 6. Foolishness, or sin. Shame has made me conceal the state of my soul; and hence evil has increased. S. Jer. &c. C. --- The poisoned wound has infected other parts which were sound: (W.) chaburoth denotes sores, or

"wounds still fresh or mortifying," (H.) rather than scars. M. ---

All sin is properly styled foolishness, as no prudent man should commit any.

Orig.

Ver. 7. End. Heb. "exceedingly," while a person feels his state is not desperate.

Bert. ---

Sorrowful. Heb. "in black," which may refer either to the mourning attire, (C.) or to the

"countenance." Sym. --- Grief will allow me to take no rest. Orig. --- I dare not look up to heaven, (C.) nor can I walk straight, to perform any good work (W.) of myself. H.

Ver. 8. Loins. Psoai, as the Alex. and Comp. Sept. read, though the Vat. has psuche, soul, (H.) with the Arab. &c. --- Illusions. Heb. nikle, "burning." Pagn.

"shameful ulcer." Houb.

"Ignominy." S. Jer. H. --- David acknowledges that the irregular motions of concupiscence were an effect of his transgression. The Jews and Greeks place these sensations in the loins. 3 K. viii.

10. Plato triplicem finxit animam, cujus principatum in capite, iram in pectore, cupiditatem subter præcordia locavit. Cicero, Tusc. 1. C. --- Flesh.

Concupiscence striving in me.

Ver. 9. Heart. I give vent to my inward grief by loud lamentations.

Ver. 10. Desire, to be restored to thy favour. W. --- Thou alone canst heal me. C.

Ver. 11. Troubled. Heb. "beats," palpitat. Houb. --- Itself. Heb. "even they are,"

&c. H. --- I was no longer endued with the spirit of prophecy, (S. Bas.) till my conversion, (S. Aug.) nor an object of favour. H. --- I was abandoned to myself, (C.) quitting thy light. S. Amb. --- My eyes have been hurt by weeping (H.) and maladies, (C.) while my heart is become so corrupt, that I do not relish or discern spiritual things. H. --- The beauty of virtue, and the enormity of vice, do not strike me. M.

Ver. 12. Have. Heb. "over-against my wound (H.) or leprosy." C. Prot. "stand aloof from my sore." H. --- But the original means rather "near to." Sept. may have read u for i, in nighi. Bert.

--- But Sym. and S. Jerom translate, "stood against my leprosy, (H.) and my neighbour stood at a distance;" as if they had been afraid of the contagion.

Job (xix. 13. 19.) makes the same complaints. C. --- These manners of worldlings may be seen in every age, and ought not to fill us with surprise.

Bert. Jo. xv. 18. --- David was abandoned by Achitophel, and by most of the tribe of Juda, (Theod.) as our Saviour was by his disciples. S. Aug.

Ver. 13. Violence. Heb. "laid snares." This treatment might be expected from enemies, since friends proved so treacherous. H. --- They would willingly have slain David. The will is often put for the deed. C. --- Things. Endeavouring to engage me again in sin, being displeased because I have quitted their evil company; (W.) or they raise their fortune, by causing dissensions in the state.

This might be well applied to the Pharisees, who persecuted Christ.

Ver. 14. Mouth. I utterly renounce all sin. W. --- David would make no reply to Semei, (Theod.) nor our Saviour to Pilate. C. --- Silence is often the best defence. H. --- Eagerness to justify one's self, causes trouble and disedification. Bert. --- The prophet joins the deaf and dumb; as

those who have naturally the former defect, are also afflicted with the latter. Pliny x. 69. H.

Ver. 16. Hoped. This was the reason of his silence. Bert. --- He knew that God was in a manner engaged to defend those (C.) who rely (W.) wholly on Him; and he declared such to be his disposition. H. --- Hear me. The same term thahane means, "wilt answer" (Mont.) as a judge and advocate. H. --- God will one day manifest the justice of his elect. Bert.

Ver. 17. For. On this account I turn to thee, and entreat thee not to suffer my enemies to gain the victory. W. --- My humble and earnest prayer is another motive of confidence. --- My enemies is not expressed in Heb. C. --- I decline saying any thing in my own defence, lest I should offend God. M.

Ver. 18. Scourges. Prot. to "halt," letselah. H. --- S. Jer. ad plagas. Chal. "for calamity." (Bert.) See Ps. xxxiv. 15. I speak not through impatience, as I know that my sins deserve still more. C.

--- I resign myself to thee. W. --- This was admirably verified in Jesus Christ, the victim for our sins. C. --- Before me. I cannot forget my transgression. H.

Ver. 19. Sin. Though Thou knowest all things, I will confess that I may be saved; and will meditate on what I have deserved. W. --- He goes to the source of his malady. C. --- "Be not secure after confession of thy sin, as being always ready to confess and to offend. Declare thy iniquities in such a manner as to take care on account of thy sin." S. Aug. --- Confession without repentance is only a mockery. H.

Ver. 20. Stronger. Heb. "strong, and they," &c. H. --- Art thou deaf to my cries?

C.

Ver. 21. Detracted me, by insinuating that my repentance is hypocrisy. Another mode of detracting is by making known secret faults, (W.) as

calumny imputes false ones. H. ---

Goodness. Sept. "justice." Many Greek and Latin copies add: "They have rejected me, the beloved, (Theod. Arab.) as one dead, as an abomination." ---

Forsake, v. 22. S. Amb. C.

Ver. 23. Attend. Heb. "hasten;" which is the sense of prosches, "attend." Sept.

H.

PSALM 38

PSALM XXXVIII. (DIXI CUSTODIAM.)

A just man's peace and patience in his sufferings; considering the vanity of the world, and the providence of God.

Ver. 1. Idithun was one of the four chief masters of music, called Ethan, 1 Par.

vi. 44. and Idithun ib. xvi. 41. Some think that he was the author of this psalm; but it was rather given to him by David to sing. C. --- The title shews that the psalms were designed for the public service of the Church, and not for David alone. Bert. --- This refers to the Christian Church, though some explain it of the Jews in captivity, (W.) with R. Salomon, while others think that it was composed during some of David's persecutions. It is connected with the preceding, and with the two next psalms. C.

Ver. 2. Tongue. The matter is very delicate and important. James iii. 2. Prov.

xviii. 21. Is.

xxxii. 17. Eccli. xxii. 33. and xxviii. 28. --- Me, and was treating me with injustice and calumny.

H. --- Chilo, the sage, said: "I know how to bear ill treatment," (Laert. 1.) and this is a proof of

"the greatest wisdom and virtue." H. --- Outos kratistos. Menand. C. --
- Weak men seek revenge; but the wise resolve to govern their tongues,
and do not stand up in their own just defence, though they be,
therefore, more persecuted. W.

Ver. 3. Renewed. I was conscious of no offence against my enemies, (H.)
but I reflected that I had forfeited my virtue, (Euseb.) and therefore
gave vent to my grief. H. --- Being afraid of saying anything amiss, I
refrained from saying what was good. But I perceived that this was
wrong. S. Aug. --- I deprived myself of all pleasure. C. --- The seven
first verses detail the arguments used by philosophers to comfort men,
which all prove of little service. We must have recourse to God, v. 8.
Bert.

Ver. 4. Out. This alludes to his sorrow for his sins, (Orig.) or to the fire
of charity, which is enkindled by meditation on the last end, &c. (v. 5.)
or rather it means, that while he repressed his tongue, he could not but
feel an inward zeal and indignation, (C.) in consequence of grief
suppressed. W. --- See Jer.

xx. 9. M.

Ver. 5. End, as I desire to die, like Elias, 3 K. xix. W. --- The just have
frequently expressed such sentiments, to move God to pity, (Job vii. 1.
Ps. ci. 4.) though they wished to live, that they might praise God on
earth, (C.) if it were his will.

H. --- This text may indicate the impatience (Bert.) of the mere
philosopher, (H.) or David desires to know to what a decree of
perfection he must arrive.

Orig. S. Amb.

Ver. 6. Measurable. Heb. "of a hand's breadth." H. --- Sym. "a
spithame, or twelve fingers'

breadth," perhaps in allusion to the Greek proverb, a "spithame of life;" which denotes one very short. Drus. --- The Gr. copies vary: some read, (C.) with the Vat. *palaia*s, "ancient;" and others of the palestra with the Alex. *palaista*s, or

"contentious." I am obliged always to wrestle with my adversaries. Grot. --- My days are short, and spent in conflicts. H. --- S. Chrys. S. Amb. &c.

mention both. The former word is adopted by the Arab. Ethiop, &c.; but the Heb. has *tephachoth*, "of a palm," or four fingers' breadth; (C.) and S. Jer.

breves, "short." H. ---

Substance. S. Jer. "life." Heb. "age." --- Living. Heb. "standing," how well soever he may seem to be established. Prot. "at his best estate, is altogether vanity. Selah." H. --- The wisest of men confirms this at large, Eccli. i. 1. C.

Jam. iv. 14. --- "What is this long while which has an end?"

Cic. pro. Marcel. M.

Ver. 7. Image, "of God." S. Greg. &c. Heb. "in a shadow or darkness," where the fall of a leaf affrights him. Life is so short and miserable, why should we strive to heap up riches? C. --- For whom. Heb. "who shall gather," &c. H. --- The term is used respecting harvest rather than money. C. --- Heb. has disquieted in the plural, and the rest of the words in the singular; but S.

Jerom agrees with us, *conturbatur...& ignorat cui dimittat ea*. H. --- The prophet still utters complaints. One step farther is necessary to ensure peace. Bert. ---

He acknowledges that his life is but a shadow, and what we ought not to grieve for temporal losses. W.

Ver. 8. Substance. Sept. hypostasis. Heb. "hope." H. --- I can depend only on thee. C.

Ver. 9. Thou hast. Heb. lo, "do not;" ne, or nonne; or "hast thou not made?" &c.

as the following verse intimates. Bert. --- Thou hast suffered me to be reproached by the foolish, who prosper in this world. W. --- The fool may denote the devil, (S. Jer. Orig.) and all the lovers of iniquity.

Flam. C.

Ver. 10. It. S. Aug. reads "me," conformably to some copies of the Sept. Arab,

&c. C. --- He is at a loss to explain the reason of the prophet, and suggests that this perhaps ought to be referred to the following sentence, " Because thou hast made me, remove, " &c. H. --- Such is the inconvenience of having incorrect copies. Amama. --- The Alex. and Vat. Sept. both have me, (H.) which is omitted in Complut. C. --- David knew that he was scourged by divine Providence. W.

Ver. 11. In (thy) rebukes, belongs to the next verse in Heb. and Sept. referring to man in general, unless the prophet mean himself. Bert.

Ver. 12. Spider. S. Jer. "moth." Sym. "thou dissolvest like corruption his desirable thing;" (H.) which means the soul, (Bert.) or "beauty." Prot. Remorse of conscience and God's judgments make a man pine away. --- Disquieted is obelized in the Sept. S. Jer. ad Sun. C. --- It is not found in the Alex. and Comp.

edit. (H.) and seems to be taken from v. 7. It does not alter the sense.

Bert. --- "Man is vanity always." S. Jer. --- As a spider which has consumed its moisture, so he decays. W.

Ver. 13. Were. 1 Par. xxix. 15. I can expect aid from no other but thee. C. ---

Heaven is our home. W. --- "Life is a travelling from home." Plato in Axiocho.

Ver. 14. More. In a state to do good. W. --- Grant me relief. Eccle. ix. 10. Job vii.

8. C.

PSALM 39

PSALM XXXIX. (EXPECTANS EXPECTAVI.)

Christ's coming, and redeeming mankind.

Ver. 1. Psalm. Prot. intimate that this was not in the Heb.; but we find mizmor,

"canticle," which is equivalent. H. --- David speaks of his own restoration to health as a figure of Jesus Christ, who is principally intended, Heb. x. 7. The end of the psalm is nearly the same with the 69th. C. ---

Some arbitrarily (Bert.) explain the words with relation to the revolt of Absalom. Bossuet. ---

Others think it may refer to the captives, (Ven. Bede) to Daniel, or Jeremias, rescued from prison.

See Theodoret, who explains it of men waiting for the general resurrection. It may express the sentiments of the Church, when the persecutions ceased.

Euthym. --- Christ sometimes speaks in his own name, and sometimes in that of his members. S. Amb. S. Aug. C. --- It is certain that David had Christ in view; and if he alludes to himself, it is only as the figure of him. Bert.

Ver. 2. Expectation, or patience. H. --- God has, at last, granted my request.

Ver. 3. Misery. Heb. "confusion," (Bert.) or "noise," (S. Jer. H.) from the greatest danger.

Theod. --- Dregs. Mud. Jer. xxxviii. 6. S. Aug. &c. explain this of the Christian saved by faith from the sink of his sins. C.

Ver. 4. New. Excellent. H. --- I was before uttering complaints, now I give thanks with joy, for my health and conversion. C. --- Song. Heb. "Praise." The penitent changes his language, which is no longer understood by worldlings. Bert. ---

Many. S. Aug. reads, the just, who take part in the welfare of their brethren, (Ps.

xxx. 11.) while the wicked are filled with alarm, at the ways of God; who humbles or exalts people as he pleases. C.

Ver. 5. Vanities. Heb. "the proud, nor such as turn aside to lies." Prot. H. --- All the world is vanity, (Ps. xxxviii. 6. &c. C.) though idolatry may be here meant.

S. Cyr.

Ver. 6. Thoughts, or designs, "over us," as Heb. adds. No one can fathom the counsels of the Lord. It is folly, therefore, to attack his mysteries. H. --- Like.

Prot. "and thy thoughts which are to usward, they cannot be reckoned up in order unto thee." Lit. non ordinare apud te. Mont. H.

--- But haroc means also æquiparare, which corresponds with the Vulg. Bert.

--- Syr. "none is comparable to thee." C. --- Number. Christ and his apostles preached, so that many followed their doctrine. W. --- David also had many witnesses of his gratitude. They crowded round him.

Some would improperly make multiplicati sunt, agree with mirabilia, dialogismois, which is in the masculine. Bert. --- "I find no order before

thee; if I would declare and number, they are more (wonders) than can be counted." S.

Jer. H. --- I am at a loss how to express myself, and must be content with the interior sentiments of gratitude. See Ps. lxx. 15. C.

Ver. 7. Sacrifice and oblation. Neither bloody nor unbloody sacrifices of the law will do. M. ---

Pierced ears. Sept. and S. Paul read, a body thou hast fitted to me. Heb. x. 5. H.

--- Nobilius mentions, that he found the reading of the Vulg. in one Gr. MS. in Eus. &c. --- The Arab. has both. "Thou hast prepared a body for me, and opened my ears." C. --- Both are, in effect, of divine authority. The version adopted by S. Paul, cannot be rejected, no more than the Heb.

confirmed by the Vulg. James Pierce asserts, that the Heb. is incorrect, oznaim being put for az zip, "then a body," as the letters are not unlike. The dissertation is ingenious: the author is, however, suspected of Socinianism.

We know not the reason why the Vulg. here abandons the Sept. The sense is much the same; the prophet noticing the entire obedience of the Messias, (Bert.) and the apostle comprising his whole person. M. --- His body was miraculous, (H.) and the incarnation the work of God. C. --- Nothing could come up to his submission. "Thou has dug ears for me," (S. Jer. H.) alluding to the custom of making slaves for ever, (Ex. xxi. 5.) or "thou hast fitted, (C.) opened, (Prot.) my ears," enabling me to hear, and to obey. H. --- The sacrifice of Christ was never interrupted, from the first moment of his incarnation. C. ---

He was always doing the will of his Father. H. --- This sacrifice is the most essential. God rejected all such as were destitute of this condition, or were not offered by people determined to observe the whole law. 1 K. xv. 22. Is. i. 11. Jer.

vii. 22. Porphyr. Abs. ii. C. --- No sacrifice of the Old Testament was sufficient to satisfy God's justice for sin. Christ, by the ear of obedience, performed the redemption of man by his death, as was determined from eternity. See Heb. x.

W. --- And is omitted in the Latin version of S. Paul, holocaustum pro peccato, inadvertently, or rather to intimate, that he was speaking of the holocaust of expiation. Heb. x. 6. 8. and xiii. 11. and Lev.

xvi. 27. Bert. --- S. Aug. also admits only one species of sacrifice, "holocausts likewise for sin."

But others distinguish them from the victims designed to expiate the sins of individuals, (Lev. v.

&c.) of which the prophet also speaks. C.

Ver. 8. Head, or beginning, (Gen. i. Jo. i. and viii. 25. S. Jer. &c.) or at the commencement of this book of Psalms, (S. Aug.) or rather in the whole Bible.

C. --- Kephalis denotes a volume, (Suidas) or stick, on which books were formerly rolled, being written on parchment. The Jews still observe the same custom in their synagogues. C. Lu. iv. 17. 20. --- Heb. "In the volume of the book," means, in the book, (Amama) or the Bible, which is the book by excellence, where the incarnation and death of Christ, for man's redemption, are clearly specified. H. --- This is the sum of the Scriptures. W. --- They bear witness to Christ. Jo. v. 39. Luke xxiv. 27. H. --- The apostle uses the word capitulum, for the sum. Hebrews viii. Whatever sense be chosen, we should meditate on this head, or volume. But Christ signed, as it were, this solemn engagement, from all eternity. If we adopt the passage to David, we may translate, "I come, having on me the volume of thy Scriptures." See 4 K. xi. 12.

C.

Ver. 9. Heart. So the Vat. Sept. reads; while other editions have koilias, "belly."

S. Jer. ad Sum.

--- Heb. "bowels." H. --- The sense is the same. Bert. --- I love the law so much, that I would hide it in my bowels, (C.) or in the most secret place. Theod.

Ver. 10. Thy, is not expressed in Heb. or Gr. but understood. Bert. --- Church, in the tabernacle, (Theod.) or rather in the Catholic Church; the propagation of which, (H.) and the preaching of the gospel throughout the world are foretold.

W. --- The justice, or mercies of our Saviour, are every where proclaimed. S.

Jer. C.

Ver. 11. Thy. Some copies of the Sept. have, my justice, as well as the Ethiopic version. Eus. S.

Aug. &c. C. --- But the Vulg. is more correct. Bert. --- Council. Christ conceals not his mercy and truth from the greatest and wisest congregations. He spoke boldly before Annas and Caiphas, as S. Paul did at Athens, &c. W. --- David testifies his gratitude, and invites all to praise God with him. C. --- But we must particularly learn from our Saviour, a horror of sin; the knowledge of his mysteries; confidence in his mercy; and a conviction, that we can never be saved but by his grace. He has announced these things, and then he finishes his career, by suffering for us, and pours forth his supplications to God. Bert.

Ver. 12. Withhold not. The prophet now speaks in the name of Christ's mystical body, the Church, praying to be made a partaker of mercy, and to be delivered from evils, (W.) or Christ speaks as the victim for our sins. H. --- Uphold me.

This might be also rendered as a prayer,

"May thy," &c. with the Heb. and some copies of the Sept. Bert.

Ver. 13. My iniquities. That is, the sins of all mankind, which I have taken upon me. Ch. C. ---

The sins even of those who believe, are so numerous, that they cannot be seen in particular. We may faint at the sight of so many sins committed by Christians. W. --- Forsaken me in the agony.

C. --- Christ had all the sins of mankind laid upon him. Bert. --- He did not suffer to release those who were already damned; though they had received sufficient graces, in consequence of the merits of his future death. H. --- Christ knew the number and enormity of sin. M. --- But he would not disclose his knowledge. H. Mar. vi. 5. M.

Ver. 14. Be pleased. The rest is nearly transcribed. Ps. lxxix. C. --- The Church prays for her weak members. W.

Ver. 15. Backward, as those who came to seize Christ were twice. Jo. xviii. 6. ---

He prays for their conversion. S. --- Shame might have proved very salutary to them. Theod. --- The reprobate will be confounded. W.

Ver. 16. 'Tis well. The Hebrew here is an interjection of insult and derision, like the Vah. Matt.

xxvii. 40. Ch. --- As S. Jerom here expresses it, Vah, Vah. See Mark xv. 29. M. ---

The Jews have now become objects of contempt, (C.) a just punishment (H.) of scoffers, who wish evil to the good.

Ver. 17. Magnified. Thus may those speak, who sincerely love God. W.

Ver. 18. Beggar. King David might assume this title, as well as all mankind. S.

Aug. --- The same may be applied to Christ, according to his human nature, as the end of this psalm, and the following, belong to him, more than to David. C.

--- He speaks in the name of penitents, whose sins he had undertaken to wash away. W. --- Careful. Heb. "will think of me." H. --- Slack. The faithful prayed for the coming of our Saviour, as they still entreat him to hasten the reward of the good. W.

PSALM 40

PSALM XL. (BEATUS QUI INTELLIGIT.)

The happiness of him that shall believe in Christ; notwithstanding the humility and poverty in which he shall come: the malice of his enemies, especially the traitor Judas.

Ver. 1. Himself; implying, that David composed this psalm, though the word is not expressed in Heb. or Gr. Berthier. T. iii. --- The same articles, however, occur, which have been thus rendered before. H. --- Some explain this psalm of the sickness of Ezechias, (Ven. Bede) or of that of David, a little before the revolt of Absalom. Rab. Muis. Bossuet. --- This may be described as a figure of our Saviour's sufferings. C. --- For it would be rash not to acknowledge, that He is here the principal object in view, (Theod.) since he has applied (v. 10.) to the traitor's conduct, (C.) and all the rest may properly allude to the same events. The psalmist speaks of the Messiah in the six first verses, and introduces him, in the remainder, uttering his own sentiments, (Bert.) respecting his passion and resurrection. W. Isai. liii. 4. M.

Ver. 2-3. Understandeth. Believing with eagerness, (H.) or reflecting seriously on Jesus Christ, (Bert.) who was pleased to be poor for our sakes. H. --- And the poor, is not in the ancient Sept.

(Eus.) nor Heb. &c. But it only expresses the same idea as the word needy, (Bert.) being added to show the extreme misery to which our Saviour was reduced. H. --- The Fathers explain the passage in this sense, though some would suppose, that David speaks of his own conduct, (C.) or of those who adhered to him in his distress, while most followed Absalom. Flam. --- Day of death or judgment. Happy the man, who makes the life of Christ his constant meditation, (Bert.) and endeavours to imitate his example, and divine charity!

H. --- The Church recites this psalm for the sick. Those who assist them may hope for similar treatment. But such as are not scandalized at Christ, on account of his poverty and afflictions, may be pronounced blessed, (Lu.

vii.23.) as He will deliver them from distress, if they place their confidence in Him. W. --- The sick are relieved, when they think on Christ's sufferings. M. ---

Preserve. Heb. "will preserve...and thou wilt not deliver him unto the will of his enemies." Prot. --- But S. Jerom has,

"and he will not," &c. H. --- Sixtus V. reads, "into the hands of his enemy," after S. Aug. &c.

Others add, "he will purify his soul from, or on the earth." C. --- Our Lord will give to such servants more grace in this life, and glory in the next, nor will he suffer them to yield to temptation. W. --- He will defend them and heal them, when sick. C.

Ver. 4. His bed. Lit. "on the bed of his sorrow." His, seems to have been formerly in Hebrew, (Houb.) though it be now omitted, (Bert.) as it was in the time of Sym. "the bed of misery," (S.

Jer.) of infirmity. --- Thou hast. Heb. "thou wilt make." Prot. "turn," (marg. H.)

"change, or take away." In the east, the bed was removed entirely, (Jo. v. 8.) and this expression may denote, (C.) that the sick man should be cured, and no longer be confined to his bed, (S. Chrys.) or that God would take him by the hand, to support him, and turn his bed, like a tender mother, to make it more comfortable. Geneb. C. --- When the just are sick unto death, Christ will give them greater consolation. W. -- - He will withdraw their affections from all terrestrial things, and remove whatever has been dangerous to them. S. Greg.

Mor. xxiii. 15. The ineffable name has been thrice repeated in these verses, to insinuate, that all good is wrought by the blessed Trinity.

Bert.

Ver. 5. Thee. Christ prays for his members, acknowledging their sins, (W.) which he had undertaken to expiate. The Fathers explain this of his prayer in the garden. C. --- Have we ever reflected on sin, which reduced the Lord of all, to such poverty and distress? Bert.

Ver. 6. Perish? When shall we have a change, and see Absalom on the throne?

When shall we get rid of this man, who reproves our conduct? So were the Jews animated to destroy Christ.

Theod. --- The rest of the psalm more visibly relates to him. C. --- His enemies were greatly disappointed. H. --- For after they had put him to death, he rose again, and his name and kingdom became more glorious. W.

Ver. 7. If he, any one among my enemies. H. --- The Scriptures often pass from the plural to the singular, (Bert.) to comprise every one distinctly. H. --- Yet S.

Aug. &c. read "they came," &c.

omitting if, as some of the Sept. edit. do likewise: though inaccurately, according to S. Jer. and Sun. C. --- It occurs in the Rom. copy, and Grabe inserts it in a smaller type. The sense is not altered. H. --- The conspirators affected to shew David some marks of civility, to obtain their ends. The Jews often strove to entangle Jesus, by their questions, (Matt. xix. 3. and xxii. 17. 24.

and Jo. viii. 3.) while Judas continued in his company, to gratify his own avarice, and to betray him. C. --- Such were their vain projects. H. --- Those who came maliciously to hear Christ, blamed him as an enemy to the law, or as one who cast out devils by Beelzebub. W.

Ver. 8. To me, seems useless, though it be added conformably to the Heb.

(Bert.) or rather it intimates, that the enemies made no secret of thier plots. H.

Ver. 9. Word of affecting the regal power, &c. S. Amb. --- No more? Jesus Christ speaks. They have unjustly condemned me: But can I not rise again? or the words may be put in the mouth of his enemies. Shall we have any thing to fear from the dead? If we were to confine him only, he might perhaps escape. C. ---

Heb. "an evil disease, say they, cleaveth fast unto him: and now that he lieth, he shall rise up no more." Prot. --- "The word of the devil they poured out against themselves; he who hath slept, shall rise no more." S. Jer. --- Yet lo may be explained, an non,

"shall not he," &c. Sept. have seen this insulting interrogation of the Jews who ridiculed what Christ had said of his future resurrection. Bert. --- They determined to put him to death; but they could not prevent his glorious (W.) appearance again on the third day. H. --- Those who explain this of David, say, that the sleep denotes a mortal illness, or a geievous fault, for which it was expected, that the king would die. Kimchi. Munster. &c.

Ver. 10. Bread. This characterizes the traitor, who had recieved the holy Communion, and had been intrusted with the purse by our Saviour, yet betrayed him with the sign of peace. C. --- To violate the laws of hospitality was greatly resented by the very pagans. Plut. Symp. vii. 4. -
--

Supplanted me, or kicked like a wild colt, as Plato complained that Aristotle had done, when he set up another school. H. Emas apelaktise. Laert. Elian iv.

9. --- David might allude to Absalom, though the Holy Ghost speaks of Judas.

C. --- Our Saviour himself says, (W.) that the Scriptures may be fulfilled, he that eateth bread with me, shall lift up his heel against me:

**Qui manducat mecum panem levabit contra me calcaneum suum:
eperen ep eme ten pternan autou,**

"has lifted up," &c. as the Heb. expresses it here. Judas had attempted to betray Christ already, and would do it more effectually hereafter; so that both the present and future might agree with him. We also find the psalm translated qui edebat panes meos, &c. But the difference is very small. H. --- To lift up the heel, is the posture of one who attempts to supplant his adversary. M.

Ver. 11. Them. No one is ignorant of the destruction of Jerusalem, and of the miserable condition of the Jews (M.) throughout the world. C. --- Christ will render every one according to his deserts. W.

Ver. 12. Over me. Thus the divinity of Christ was proved, since he rose victorious, in spite of his enemies. C.

Ver. 13. Innocence. Jesus was the spotless lamb incapable of sin. He effaced it by his blood, and is therefore crowned with glory. Heb. ii. 9. Phil. ii. 9. C. ---

This innocence made him a fit victim for sin. W.

Ver. 14. So be it. Chal. "Amen." This word, at the beginning of a discourse, implies an affirmative oath; (Matt. vi. 13.) and at the end, it is a mark of approbation. Num. v. 22. --- Here the Jews terminate the first book of the psalms, which they divide into five. C. --- S. Jerom rejects this division, as our Saviour mentions only the psalms, and the last psalm has no such conclusion.

W. --- It has Alleluia. All the rest have Amen. See Ps. lxxii. lxxxix. and cvi. Heb.

Bert. --- The observations which have been made in this first part, will serve to explain many other passages, on which we shall therefore be shorter, as well as in specifying the variations from the original, which are for the most part only apparent, as the intelligent reader may be convinced, by the preceding remarks. H.

PSALM 41

PSALM XLI. (QUEMADMODUM DESIDERAT.)

The fervent desire of the just after God: hope in afflictions.

Ver. 1. Understanding. See Ps. xxxi. M. --- Core, who composed, (T.) or sung (M.) most of the psalms in this second part. T. --- Pieces of a joyful nature were generally assigned to them, according to the Jews and S. Jer. Ps. lxxxiv. M. ---

They were descendants of the famous schismatic, the miraculous preservation of whose innocent children teaches us, that the good will not be punished with the guilty, and that we must be raised above this earth, lest hell devour us.

Num. xvi. 31. and xxvi. 10. W. --- The sentiments of the captives, (C.) and of every sincere Christian, are here expressed. S. Aug. --- David may have been the author, (C.) as it is generally believed. Bert.

Ver. 2. Waters. This was sung at the baptism of Catechumens, (S. Aug.) teaching them to thirst after heaven. H. --- The hart being infected with poison, thirsts exceedingly, as sinners must do for pardon. W.

Ver. 3. Strong. Most Bibles before Clement VIII. read "fountain." C. --- El signifies both God and strong. Bert. --- The Levites desired earnestly to serve God in his temple; Christians must wish to appear before him in heaven, (C.) when they will be free from temptations. Idols may destroy, but they cannot give life. W.

Ver. 4. Bread. Ovid imitates this: Cura dolorque animi lachrymæque alimenta fuere. Met. x. ---

The tears of compunction obtain the remission of sin. S. Jer. --- God. Thus the idolaters derided those who could not point at their God. H. -- - The Babylonians had conquered all the surrounding nations, and despised their deities. C. --- The wicked laugh at the just, who are for a time in distress, comforting themselves with weeping. W. --- Those who

saw David wandering (H.) in the mountains, at a distance from the tabernacle, might ask him what religion or God he followed. M.

Ver. 5. These sarcasms fill me with grief, (C.) while the solemn ceremonies of religion, which, I remember, were observed in the temple, cause my heart to overflow with joy. Bert. --- I shall.

Prot. "I had gone with the multitude; I went with them to the house of God with the voice of joy and praise; with a multitude that kept holiday." Yet the holidays of the Catholic Church are now ridiculed by many. Prot. H. --- The original may have several other meanings. The tabernacle may here designate the musach of Levites. 4 K. xvi. 18. C. --- Feasting. Some such religious feasts were prescribed. Deut. xii. 12. H. -- - David was not permitted to build the temple, nor to enter the tabernacle: but he speaks of heaven. W.

Ver. 6. My countenance. Heb. "his," as Aquila, &c. read. C. --- Yet as the words are repeated, (v.

12.) there seems to be a fault in the text, (Bert.) owing to v, "his" being taken in here, instead of explaining it by and, v. 7. H. --- The arrangement of the letters in the Vulg. is preferable. C.

Ver. 7. Little hill of Sion. I hope that I shall soon again behold the fertile regions along the Jordan. C. --- But these hills of Hermon, &c. are nothing when compared with heaven: They serve only to remind us of our banishment. Bert.

--- The difficulties of our present abode, hemmed in on all sides, teach us to place our hopes in heaven. W.

Ver. 8. Flood-gates. The Hebrews imagined there were immense reservoirs of water above, (C.) which might serve to drown the earth, as at the deluge. Gen.

vii. 11. Both heaven and earth seemed to be armed against the psalmist. H. ---

One affliction succeeded another, (C.) and God appeared to have abandoned his servants to temptations. But he enables them to come off with victory, and fills them with more joy in their trials: so that they may sing in heart, and pray.

W.

Ver. 9. Night. In affliction, as well as in prosperity, we must praise the Lord.

Rom. Sept. "in the night he will manifest it." --- Mercy. H. --- This is very beautiful, but not agreeable with the original. Bert.

Ver. 11. Whilst. Prot. As, "with a sword in my bones, mine enemies reproach me." H. --- Thus the martyrs were tortured and upbraided. C.

Ver. 12. Countenance. To whom I look up with confidence. M. --- The just are comforted with the hope of God's sight. W.

PSALM 42

PSALM XLII. (JUDICA ME DEUS.)

The prophet aspireth after the temple and altar of God.

Ver. 1. David. Sept. add, "it has no title, in Heb." being composed by the same author, and on the same subject, as the preceding. C. --- David teaches the faithful how to begin a good work; and priests how they ought to officiate at Mass. W. --- Holy. Heb. "merciful." The Babylonians and their king, treated the Jews with great cruelty. C. --- After we have proved ourselves, according to the admonition of S. Paul, (1 Cor. xi.) before approaching to the holy Eucharist, we may beg of God to judge and to protect us. W.

Ver. 2. Me. Without thy assistance, I can do nothing. My enemies seem too strong, while thou appearest to disregard my prayer. W.

Ver. 3. Light, your Messias, as the Jews confess, (Jarchi) truth, the holy Spirit.

S. Chrys. --- Both the titles may be applied to our Saviour. Bert. S. Jer. -- We are in the utmost distress; be pleased to send us relief. C. --- As thou hast sent Christ into the world to impart these graces, grant that we may know, and comply with our duties, before we approach to they holy altar. --- Holy hill, the Church, (W.) or tabernacle on Sion, where the Jews wished to be present. C.

Ver. 4. Youth. S. Jer. "the God of my joy and exultation." H. --- Syr. and Arab.

agree with us, and Gil means, (C.) a young man, in Arab. and Heb. Hammond.

--- People in youth, shew for the effects of joy. Bert. --- Accompanied with light, and a pure intention, we may offer sacrifice to God, who changeth our corruptions into newness of life. W. --- The Levites might sing near the altar, but could not offer victims. C.

Ver. 5. My God. This word is sing.; but the former "Elohim," is plural, to intimate one God in three persons. W. --- Harp. Heb. cinnor, which Sym.

renders, "the psaltery." The sons of Core were chiefly door-keepers: but they also played on musical instruments. C.

Ver. 6. God. Trust in God, whom I hope to see face to face. W.

PSALM 43

PSALM XLIII. (DEUS AURIBUS NOTRIS.)

The Church commemorates former favours, and present afflictions; under which she prays for succour.

Ver. 1. Understanding. See Ps. xli. M. --- David or the Corites composed this piece, to comfort the just under persecution. Bert. --- It may allude

to the situation of the Jews at Babylon, (C.) or under Antiochus Epiphanes, (Ven.

Bede) though S. Paul, (Rom. viii. 36.) applies v. 22. to the persecutions of the primitive Christians, which seems to shew, that the whole psalm refers to them, (Bert.) as the Fathers have explained it. Yet it may literally be understood of the Israelites (C.) also, (H.) as well as the Christian martyrs, since all things happened to the Israelites in figure. W.

Ver. 2. Old, in calling Abraham, and rescuing the Hebrews for the Egyptian bondage, &c. W. ---

God formerly protected our Fathers; but how are things changed? C. --
-

Gideon uses nearly the same words. Judg. vi. M.

Ver. 3. Plantedst them, thy people. See Jer. ii. 21. and xii. 10. Ezech. xvii. 6. ---

Out, by means of insects, &c. Wisd. xii. 8. Jos. xxiv. 12. C. --- The Hebrews were miraculously assisted, (W.) without any merit of their own, (C.) as all were wicked at first. Yet Abraham was freely chosen, that the visible Church might be preserved. W.

Ver. 5. Saving (salutes) the manifold instances of protection. H.

Ver. 6. Horn, like bulls. W. --- This we have done in former times. C. --- Not man's strength, but God's favour, granteth the victory. W.

Ver. 9. We glory. Lit. "be praised." H. --- We have always attributed our success to thee. C.

Ver. 10. Now. He foretelleth divers states of the Jews, and of the Church. W.

Ver. 11. To. Lit. "after," post. They were formerly defeated; now it is our turn. H.

Ver. 12. Nations. Many never returned from captivity. C. See Deut. xxviii. 43.

Ver. 13. Reckoning. Prot. "thou dost not increase thy wealth by their price." H.

--- Thou art eager to get quit of them, as of the vilest slaves. Theod. Grot. Isai.

l. 2. and lii. 3. Exchange.

Some copies of the Sept. read allalagmasi, "jubilations," with the Ethiopic. S.

Aug. &c. --- While others have more correctly allagmasi, like the Vulg. There were none to purchase, so that thou hast given the people for nothing. C. --- At the last siege of Jerusalem, the Jews, who had sold (W.) or bought Christ for thirty pieces of money, (H.) were themselves sold for the smallest price; thirty being given for one penny. See Joseph. de B. Jud. W.

Ver. 15. Head, out of contempt. M. --- The Gentiles propose us as an example of a people fallen a prey to the divine indignation. 4 K. xix. 21. Lam. ii. 15.

Ver. 17. Detracteth me. S. Jer. "blasphemeth" God, while they upbraid us, as a faithless people.

C.

Ver. 18. Covenant. Till the passion of Christ, the Jews did not wholly fall from God, and then many were chosen from among them, to found the Christian religion. W. --- The Corites speak in the name of their faithful brethren, whom no provocation had induced to follow the superstitious practices of Babylon.

C.

Ver. 19. Neither. Lit. "and or yet." H. --- But the negative particle is taken (W.) from the first part of the verse. C. --- S. Jer. "Neither hast thou," &c. M. --- Yet many adhere to the Heb. &c.

"And thou hast turned," &c. Though it may be taken in a dangerous sense, (C.) yet it may only signify, (H.) that God had removed his people from the country where his worship was observed, and had refused them his protection; hence their paths have been unfortunate.

Theodoret. --- This agrees better with the sequel. Bert. --- It is no proof that God is the author of sin, in either sense.

T.

Ver. 20. Affliction. Heb. or "dragons," (S. Jer. M.) alluding to the deserts, to which the Jews retired, when the Assyrians invaded them. The text may be more applicable to the first Christians, who might truly say, that they had not transgressed. Houbig. -- To the martyrs, death was but like a shadow. S. Greg.

Mar. iv. 17. --- Here it denotes great darkness and misery. M.

Ver. 21. If we. This is a Heb. idiom, to express, we have not. W.

Ver. 22. Slaughter. They will not suffer us to be quiet respecting our religion, striving to delude us: or, if we prove resolute, like Daniel, they expose us to torments. C. --- This was more fully verified at the first propagation of the gospel, (Rom. viii. 36.) as it still continues to be among those, who cease not to persecute Catholics by artifice, as well as by open violence. Christians in every age (H.) are persecuted, more than the prophets (W.) generally were. H.

Ver. 23. Sleepest thou, seeming not to attend to our sufferings. M. --- End, shall we never be restored to favour? C.

Ver. 25. Dust. We are at death's door, being oppressed with grief, as long as thou dost not assist us. W. --- We petition in the most fervent (H.) and humble posture. Isai. xlix. 23. Mic. vii. 17.

C.

PSALM 44

PSALM XLIV. (ERUCTAVIT COR MEUS.)

The excellence of Christ's kingdom, and the endowments of his Church.

Ver. 1. For them that shall be changed, i.e. For souls happily changed, by being converted to God; (Ch.) or it may allude to the variety of speakers here introduced. Bert. --- Prot. leave shoshannim, which some translate, "on the lilies," (Aquila. S. Jer.) or "instruments of six strings."

C. --- The beloved, viz. our Lord Jesus Christ. Ch. --- Heb. "of loves;" or of the young women, friends of the bride, (yedidoth) who sung the Epithalamium, as we see in the 18th Idyl of Theocritus. The Jews formerly explained this psalm of the Messias, as well as all the Fathers after the apostles. Heb. i. 8. Many passages cannot refer to Solomon's marriage with the daughter of Pharaoh, though some might be referred to that event, as a figure of Christ's union with his Church. C. --- The whole had better be understood of Christ, (Bert.) being intended for the instruction of all converts from paganism and schism. W.

Ver. 2. Uttered. Heb. rachash, "boileth," as one unable to contain himself. Bert.

--- Speak, or

"dedicate," dico, (H.) though here it only means to speak. C. --- He addresses the object of his praise, instead of invoking the muses. S. Jer. --- Swiftly. I have not to meditate. C. --- The Holy Ghost moves my tongue, (2 Pet. i. 21.) as fast as my hands can write. Jer. xxxvi. 18. and 4 Esdras xiv. 39. H. --- High mysteries, in honour of the great king, occupy my thoughts, and to him I refer this canticle. W.

Ver. 3. Beautiful. The corporal beauty of Christ may be problematical. **H. --- But justice is the truest beauty. S. Aug. --- All admired his eloquence, (Lu. iv. 22.**

and Jo. vii. 46.) and innumerable converts were made, by the preaching of his word. S. Jer. --- The young women here address the spouse. --- Therefore, I say, (Rabbins) or "because" God hath chosen thee freely. Solomon was styled the beloved, (2 K. xii. 25.) and was highly favoured. Wisd. viii. 20. and 3 K. iv.

29. &c.

But this was only a figure of Jesus Christ, (C.) whose hypostatical union was an effect of gratuitous predestination, (S. Aug. præd. xv.) though his other graces were merited. S. Chrys. Sa.

C. --- He was most excellent in all sorts of gifts. W.

Ver. 4. Mighty. (Potentissime) Erasmus (Apol. con. Sutor.) complains, that he could not learn, whether this was a noun or an adverb, without consulting the originals. Amama.

Ver. 5. Reign. Devise, execute, and perfect the establishment of thy spiritual kingdom. W. ---

Solomon was no warrior; but he only wanted enemies to be so. The sword of Christ is his word, (Heb. iv. 12.) anger, (Apoc. xix. 15. C.) or human nature. S.

Jer. --- Some translate, "and ride,"

because kings were mounted on chariots, and governed their people with the reins of justice, &c.

Robertson. --- Justice. These titles are eagerly desired by monarchs; as martial prowess, clemency, and justice, (C.) render them objects of terror, and of love.

H. --- Christ conquered by his miracles, mildness, &c. (C.) propagating the truth, and punishing the rebellious. W. Ps. ii. 8.

Ver. 6. Fall. This seems to be placed too soon, in order to shew the rapidity of the conquest. C.

--- "Thy arrows are sharp, shot into the hearts," &c. H. --- Some explain in corde, (as the Heb.

Sept. &c. read) of the voluntary submission of those who had formerly been enemies of the Messias. S. Chrys. &c. --- "Thy sharp arrows, the people subject to thee, shall fall into," &c. ---

Men are sometimes represented as arrows. Is. xlix. 2. Bert.

Ver. 7. O God, O Theos. The Sept. thus mark the vocative case, (Ps. cxxxviii.

17. H.) and it is clear, that the Messias is here styled God, (Heb. i. 8.) though some of the Jews would evade this proof by saying, "God is thy throne." 1 Par.

xxix. 23. Even Munster translates, O Deus, and the Jew Agesila, o Thee. Elohim is never addressed to any one by the prophets, but to the true God, (Bert.) and this title alludes to the judicial character of Christ, (Acts x. 42. C.) of whose kingdom there shall be no end. Luke i. 33. --- Calvin is very bold in asserting, that David spoke properly of Solomon, as if the apostle had applied the text to our Saviour only in the mystical sense; whereas many things cannot belong to the former, and the Chal. and Fathers expound this psalm of Christ and his Church. --- Solomon did not persevere in wisdom, and his beauty was equalled by that of Absalom, &c. W. --- Crellius and Grotius in vain attempted to weaken this proof of Christ's divinity, as a Jew, who disputed with Origen, did. con.

Cels. i. D. H.

Ver. 8. God. Sym. Thee. Theophyl. --- Elohim is used in both places, (H.) with a singular verb, as being spoken of the Deity. S. Iræn. iii. 6. Bossuet. D. --- "O

Elohim, thy Elohim," (H.) which implies more than one person in God. Bert. ---

Many king might be preferred to Solomon; but Christ was raised above all. W.

--- Fellows. In consequence of the free gift of God, in uniting the human nature to the second person, the Messiah advanced in glory; (H.) or rather the prophet speaks of his subsequent merits, which entitled him to the greatest felicity. ---

The oil of gladness, alludes to the reward of his labours. Dia touto seems to require this sense, though the Heb. may be rendered, "because." Bert. ---

Either the cause or the effect may be meant. M. --- Solomon was chosen before many of his elder brothers; but Christ was anointed by the Holy Ghost. Acts x.

38. C.

Ver. 9. Perfume. Lit. "from thy garments, from the ivory houses, out of which they have delighted thee, (10.) the daughters of kings, in thy honour." They esteem it an honour to wait upon thee, and perfume thy robes, which are placed in chests of ivory, with odoriferous herbs. H.

--- The ancients admired such garments. Gen. xxvii. 27. Amos iii. 15. --- They had been given, together with the ivory boxes, as a present to Solomon at his marriage, and might give him delight, (C.) as it was then deemed unpolite to refuse a present. Odys. S. --- Stacte. Lit. "the drop" gutta, (H.) distils from the myrrh, the wood of settim, (Num. xxiv. 6.) and may denote aloes, but not the plant. C. --- Mortification and humility (W.) raise the soul on high. 2 Cor. ii.

16. H. --- The blessed Virgin is here styled a house of ivory. The Church, and all who observe purity, may be considered as God's temples. 1 Cor. iii. 17. C. ---

The virtues of Christ are this precious perfume. S. Aug. &c. --- Houses. Sept.

Βαρεῖς, a word which means "a tower." Some have not understood this, and have rendered it, gravibus, "heavy," (S. Jer. ad Prin.) which others have improperly correct by gradibus, "steps." C. --- Houbigant would change three words, and translate, "from ivory vessels, the vases of thy anointing."

Ver. 10-11. Clothing. Heb. "in gold of Ophir." H. --- The Church is spotless. Eph.

v. 26. The attendants of this glorious queen, are the nations converted, or Christian virgins. They are not the maids of Pharaoh's daughter, whose marriage was never commended. Bert. --- House. Paganism, and the observances of the old law. Bert. --- The Church, and every faithful soul, may be styled the daughter, as well as the spouse of Christ.

Ver. 12. Lord. Heb. adonaiic, "thy master," and worship him, (H.) like a dutiful wife. 1 Pet. iii.

6. and 3 K. i. 16. --- God is not found in the Sept. The title belongs to Jesus Christ, the spouse, who has been twice called God before. C.

Ver. 13. Daughters of Tyre; the city, with her dependant villages. Bossuet. ---

Tyre might send presents on this grand occasion, or might even pay tribute. 2

Par. ix. 26. C. --- Idolatrous nations submitted to Christ. Bert.

Ver. 14. Is within. Rom. Sept. &c. have "of Hesebon," by mistake, for Esiothen.

C. --- Queens in the East, could not appear much abroad. Kimchi. --- When they go out, they cannot be seen. The beauty of the Church consists in virtue, and in the grace of God. C. --- Borders. Charity influences the exterior works of piety, (T.) and gives beauty to the ceremonies (S. Bas.) and decorations used by the Church, with such magnificence. H.

Ver. 15. Neighbours. The Jews, as well as the Gentiles, shall embrace the faith.

C. --- Virginité became honourable only after the coming of Christ. S. Chrys.

Ver. 16. Temple. Even virgins (H.) out of the Church, cannot please the king. S.

Aug. W.

Ver. 17. Sons. Prot. "shall be thy children." H. --- This was the wish of those present. But it does not appear that the daughter of Pharaoh had any children, (C.) and thus it seems improbable, that she is here spoken of, as the psalmist foretells the establishment and glory (Bert.) of the Church, by means of the apostles, (S. Chrys.) and their successors, who are made princes over all the world. Let those who are cut off acknowledge this, and come to the unity, that they may be introduced into the temple of the king. S. Aug. W. --- Innumerable saints of all ranks, kings and emperors, acknowledge the Church for their mother, and submit to her. C.

Ver. 18. They. Heb. Sept. of Ald. and Comp. and the Gr. Fathers, have "I will;"

yet this is contrary to the Vat. and Alex. Sept. (Bert.) and seems less accurate.

Houbig. --- The prophet was not to live for ever, so that the fame of the Church was to be spread by others. Bert. --- Ever.

There shall be pastors and faithful people to the end. W.

PSALM 45

PSALM XLV. (DEUS NOSTER REFUGIUM.)

The Church in persecution trusteth in the protection of God.

Ver. 1. It may allude to the defeat of Sennacherib, (Houbig.) or might be sung by the Corites at the dedication of the second temple, when peace was restored to the world, after the death of Cambyses. Ezec. xxxviii. The Fathers explain it of the Christian Church, delivered from persecutions. S. Chrys. &c.

C.

Ver. 2. Troubles. Those of English Catholics have been very great; yet they increase. W.

Ver. 4. Their. Heb. S. Amb. &c. read, "its." C. --- Both sea and land may be in confusion; we shall fear nothing, having God for our protector. H. --- Though many and noble personages have revolted from the faith in England, yet the Catholic Church will never fail, (W.) even if it should in these islands. H.

Ver. 5. Stream. Jerusalem was surrounded by placid streams, which are here opposed to the great waters, as in Isai. viii. 6. The Church, after persecution, is restored to peace, and adorned with all graces. C. --- Tabernacle. This is the source of our joy. Apoc. xxi. M. and xxii. 1. Ezec. xlvii. 1.

--- The advantages of the virtuous, both here and in heaven, are great. Bert.

Ver. 7. Trembled. We have witnessed the commotions in the East, under Cyrus, and his son; the latter of whom seems to be styled Gog, (Ezec. xxxviii. 19.) and perished in Judea, which he intended to plunder. C.

Ver. 10. Shields. Heb. "the round things," which some explain, "chariots,"

without need. Bert.

--- Fire. The Fathers apply this to the peace which reigned at the birth of Christ, or to that which Constantine gave to the Church. C.

Ver. 11. Still. We have only to admire the work of God. Bert. --- He will bring all to a happy issue for his elect, though the wicked may rage. H.

PSALM 46

PSALM XLVI. (OMNES GENTES PLAUDITE.)

The Gentiles are invited to praise God for the establishment of the kingdom of Christ.

This psalm appears to be a sequel to the former psalm, and is addressed to the Gentiles who were present at the dedication of the second temple, as Darius had ordered his governors to assist the Jews. 1 Esd. vi. 15. See Esth.

viii. 17. --- Many explain it of the translation of the ark: but the Fathers behold the establishment of Christianity, and the ascension of Christ, v. 6. C.

Ver. 4. Feet. The Chanaanites were subdued by Josue, and others by David,

&c. The army of Cambyses became a prey to the Jews. Ezech. xxxix. 10. C. ---

All who embrace the true faith, even kings, become subjects, and not heads of the Church. W.

Ver. 5. Beauty. The temple. Ezech. xxiv. 21. Both Jews and Gentiles form the Church.

Ver. 6. Trumpet. Christ ascended, accompanied by choirs of angels. His apostles proclaimed his truths. C. --- They were not left desolate, but joyful; having the Paraclete sent the them.

Ver. 7. King. Christ is God, by his divine nature, and our king, by his humanity.

W.

Ver. 8. Wisely. Heb. mascil, which is so often rendered "understanding" in the titles. No one can do well, what he does not understand. C. --- The union of faith and good works, is singing wisely. S. Chrys. C. --- Concordent manus & lingua. S. Aug. D. --- Let each strive to know the mysteries of faith. W.

Ver. 9. Throne. Christ reigns over the heart with all power. Matt. xxviii. 18.

Ver. 10. Gods. Judges appointed by the king of Persia over the Jews, &c. (C.) or rather the apostles, who were more than men, (S. Jer.) and exercised a greater power than any earthly monarch. C. --- The richest princes have submitted to the God of Abraham, whose seed was to prove a blessing to all.

Gen. xviii. 18. Heb. as it is now pointed, "the princes of the people are gathered unto the people of the God of Abraham, for He is far elevated above the gods the shields of the earth," as kings are often styled. C. --- Prot. "for the shields of the earth belong unto God: He is greatly exalted;" or (Sept.) "the earthly potentates, who are of God, have been," &c. --- We might explain the Vulg. in the same sense, if Dei were substituted for Dii, (H.) as it should be. C.

--- Dei sunt optimates terræ, & ipse summe elevatus est. Houbig. --- S. Jer.

agrees with the Vulg.

(H.) which is the clearest, (Bert.) only he renders ham, "the people" of the God, as it may also signify, and retains the word shields, which we explain the strong gods, or the "strong ones of God." H. --- The blessed Trinity is not divided, but more distinctly professed in baptism than it was under the law. W.

PSALM 47

PSALM XLVII. (MAGNUS DOMINUS.)

God is greatly to be praised for the establishment of his Church.

Ver. 1. On the, &c. is not in Heb. nor Euseb. &c. It means Sunday, (S. Amb. W.) or rather Monday, being sung on that day. S. Jer. &c. H. --- The subject of the former canticle is continued, in thanksgiving to God, for some signal victory, or for the peace which God afforded to his people, after the death of Cambyses. C. --- The Fathers explain it of the propagation and peace of the Church. H.

Ver. 2. City, or temple, which lay to the north of old Jerusalem, on Sion. C. ---

Yet Genebrard,

&c. place this mountain south of Salem. M. --- The concourse of priests and people gave the appearance of a great city. Ezec. xl. 2. Is. xiv. 13. --- The Church is built upon a rock. C. --- The Jews and Christians are under the greatest obligation of praising God. W.

Ver. 3. With. Heb. "the beautiful situation, the joy of the whole earth, (M.) Sion, sides of," &c.

Chal. "Sion, thou art beautiful as a bride." Christ's Church is thus described.

Apoc. xxi. 2. C. ---

Its figure, (H.) the temple, was the glory of the whole country. Ps. xxv. 8. Lam.

ii. 15. C. --- But the Church alone extends to the sides of the north, or over the world. W.

Ver. 4. Houses. Heb. "palaces;" Sept. "towers." Baresi, a word which has again been mistaken for gravibus or gradibus, as v. 14. and Ps. xlv. 9. God is the defence of his people, (Prov. xviii.

10.) the Church, Mat. xvi. 18. C. --- All particular houses, or churches, must come to the unity of faith, (W.) and to the seat of Peter. S. Iræn. iii.

Ver. 5. Earth is superfluous. S. Jer. ad Sun. C. --- Yet it is found in the Vat. Sept.

&c. H. --- The kings of the earth assembled against the Church, (Ps. ii. 2.) as many came to oppose Jerusalem, under Cambyses. Ezec. xxviii. 2. 13. C.

Ver. 6. Saw. They could not say, like Cæsar, Veni, vidi, vici. For they no sooner came to invade the unsuspecting people, than they began to tremble. Ezec.

xxxviii. 11. &c. Ps. xlv. 7. H.

Ver. 7. There, denotes the promptitude of vengeance, as well as the following allusion. Is. xiii. 8.

1 Thes. v. 3.

Ver. 8. Vehement. Heb. "eastern." --- Tharsis, such strong-built ships, as might go to Tarsus, in Cilicia, (Gen. x. 4. C.) or to India. M. --- The merchants of Tharsis, the naval officers, shall say,

&c. There shall be a great commotion, &c. Ezec. xxxviii. 13. 19. --- The same storm proved fatal to the land and sea-forces of Cambyses. His navy is mentioned by Herodotus, (iii. 11. and 44.) and was probably stationed over against Acco, or Ptolemais, as the king perished at the foot of Carmel. C. ---

Nothing maketh a deeper impression than the sentiments of religion.
God's grace enableth the soul to sustain all conflicts, and to overcome.
W.

Ver. 9. Seen. All the promises have been fulfilled. How could any one
have thought that we should have been permitted to dedicate this
temple under the patronage of the king of Persia? (1

Esd. vi. 8.) Who would not have feared, lest the Christian religion
should perish, under such violent persecutions? Converts admire its
beauty and strength. C. --- The completion of the prophecies is a
wonderful confirmation and comfort of Christians, (W.) whose faith is
founded indeed for ever. H. ---

The gates of hell shall not prevail. M.

Ver. 10. Temple. Naou. Sept. S. Amb. &c. though the Vat. and Alex.
copies have Laou,

"people," with the Arab. Ethiop. S. Aug. &c. H. --- In the Church we
receive many graces, (C.) even Christ himself, (S. Amb.) to which those
who refuse to be Catholics, can have no title. W.

Ver. 11. Earth. all who hear of the wonders of God, must praise him;
and who can be ignorant of what He has done, (C.) in the defeat of the
enemies of his people, (H.) of Sennacherib, Cambyeses,

&c.? Yet all the earth will be instructed only by the propagation of the
Gospel.

C. --- Justice, against thy enemies, (H.) though this word may here
imply

"mercy," in opposition to the judgments, v. 12. C. --- These perfections
are never at variance. W.

Ver. 12. Juda. Sept. Sym. &c. have "Judea," (C.) which would intimate,
that the psalm was composed after the captivity. But the Hebrew reads

Yehuda, "Juda,"

with S. Jerom. H.

Ver. 13. Surround. Heb. "walk round, (H.) tell her towers." S. Jer.

Ver. 14. Strength. Perhaps the outward wall, (Ezec. xl. 5.) not seen in Solomon's temple. ---

Houses. Heb. "palaces." Sept. "houses built like towers." Bareis. Jerusalem was not rebuilt or fortified, when the second temple was dedicated. 2 Esd. i. 3.

C. --- The fortresses of the Church are the holy Fathers and Doctors, who watch in her defence. Her pillars shall not fail. The particular Churches are all united in the same faith, and these reflections ought to prevail on all to embrace the same. W.

Ver. 15. Our God. Christ incarnate works all this. He shall rule over the Church, not for three or four hundred years only, but as long as time shall last, and He shall have a Church triumphant in eternity. W. --- Evermore. Heb. hal-moth. The letters being differently arranged, are rendered,

"in death." S. Jer. "even unto death." Prot. (H.) "in youth," (Chal.) or "in the secret" of Providence. It may form a part of the following title, "over the young women," as Ps. ix. and xlv.

C. --- But then it would probably come after lamnatseach. The psalmist inculcates the perpetual duration of the Church under God's conduct, by three terms. In sæculum & ultra...usque ad mortem, "till death," (Pagn.) or

"incessantly." Sym. H. --- This psalm may also express the sentiments of a penitent, (Bert.) or of one who is put in possession of unchangeable felicity. H.

PSALM 48

PSALM XLVIII. (AUDITE HÆC OMNES GENTES.)

The folly of worldlings, who live in sin, without thinking of death or hell.

Ver. 1. Psalm. S. Amb. adds, "of David." It is written in an enigmatical style, like the book of Ecclesiastes, and is very obscure. But the drift is, to impress the captives with a contempt of worldly grandeur, which will end in death. The redemption of mankind and the resurrection of Christ are foretold, v. 8. 16. &c.

C.

Ver. 3. Earth-born. Heb. "sons of Adam," a title belonging to the meanest.

Progenies terræ.

**Perseus vi. 56. C. --- So Callimachus styles the giants, "mud-born." H.--
- Yet Houbigant explains it of the rich, (Bert.) who have lands, and
leave their names to them, v. 12. H. --- Of men. Heb. ish, noblemen. M.
--- Ye just and (S. Aug.) and polite. S. Athan.**

**Ver. 5. Proposition. Heb. "riddle." Bert. --- The ancients delighted in
parables, which required attention to discern the meaning, and thus
people had the pleasures of ingenuity. Music often accompanied their
precepts. Strabo i. 12.**

**C. --- Utile dulci. H. --- The psalmist intimates, that he had attended the
best masters, (C.) even the Holy Ghost. S. Chrys. --- He delivers the
instructions which he had received from God, on the instrument of ten
strings, to imply that we must keep the ten commandments. W. --- He
listens if the instrument be in tune. C.**

**Ver. 6. The iniquity of my heel. That is, the iniquity of my steps, or
ways: or the iniquity of my pride, with which, as with the heel, I have
spurned and kicked at my neighbours: or the iniquity of my heel, that
is, the iniquity in which I shall be found in death. The meaning of this**

verse is, why should I now indulge those passions and sinful affections, or commit now those sins, which will cause me so much fear and anguish in the evil day; when the sorrows of death shall compass me, and the perils of hell shall find me? Ch. --- The old serpent is constantly laying snares for our heel. Gen. iii. 15. H. --- Original (S. Jer.) and actual sin, (Euseb.) particularly final impenitence, (Rabbins) and the punishment of our transgressions, (Abenezra) are much to be feared, (H.) as well as concupiscence. S. Amb. --- All that will fill us with alarm in the day of vengeance, will be the having been supplanted, like wrestlers, by our iniquity, (C.) of which we have not repented.

H. --- Any such injustice must be dreaded, as it will bring on damnation. W. ---

Instead of heel, Sym. has "steps," including all the unjust actions of life. H.

Ver. 7. They that trust, &c. As much as to say, let them fear, that trust in their strength or riches; for they have great reason to fear: seeing not brother, or other man, how much a friend soever, can by any price or labour rescue them from death. Ch. --- I address myself particularly to the rich, who are in the greatest danger.

Ver. 8. No. Prot. "none of them can by any means redeem his brother; nor, &c.

H. --- But the Sept. translate as well, and the sense is the same. Matt. xvi. 26.

Bert. --- If Jesus Christ, thy brother, does not redeem thee, will any other do it?

(S. Aug.) or though thy brother neglect, the man, Christ Jesus, will suffice. S.

Amb. --- But with respect to death, no redemption will be admitted. It is appointed for all once to die. H. --- A man shall be more precious than gold, says Isaias, (xiii. 12.) of the Babylonians, whom the enemy

will not spare, for any consideration. We must therefore make good use of our time. Eccle. ix. 10.

Prov. xi. 4. C.

Ver. 9. And shall labour for ever, &c. This seems to be a continuation of the foregoing sentence; as much as to say, no man can by any price or ransom, prolong his life, that so he may still continue to labour here, and live to the end of the world. Others understand it of the eternal sorrows, and dying life of hell, which his the dreadful consequence of dying in sin. Ch. --- The just, on the contrary, who have laboured for eternity, shall see the death of the wicked, or of the wise of this world. Euseb. &c. --- It may also be a prediction of Christ's life of sufferings and future glory, (Bossuet) or express the sentiments of infidels, who deny a Providence; because both good and bad perish alike.

Eccle. iii. 18. S. Aug. --- Heb. "he rests for ever," (S. Jer.) or "shall he be undisturbed?" C. --- Both those who disbelieve a future state, and those who live as if they did, shall suffer. W. --- This verse is included within a parenthesis by Prot. (For the redemption...is precious, and it, &c.) H.

Ver. 11. He shall not see destruction, &c. or shall he not see destruction? As much as to say, however thoughtless may be of his death, he must not expect to escape: when even the wise and the good are not exempt from dying. Ch. ---

Strangers. This is very distressing. Pindar. Olym. x.

Eccles. ii. 18. --- The endeavours of the wicked to establish their families, will be vain, while they themselves shall never more return from the graves hither.

W.

Ver. 12. Sepulchres. Heb. Kobrom is better than the present Kirbam, their

"interior," and is adopted by the Chal. Syr. &c. C. --- "Their inward thought is, that their houses shall continue for ever." Prot. H. --- Called. That is, they have left their names on their graves, which alone remain of their lands, (Ch.) or, they have called cities and countries by their own names, as Alexander and Romulus did, Alexandria, (H.) and Rome. M. &c. --- They have spread their fame throughout the world. C. --- Scarcely two translate the four last verses alike.

Bert.

Ver. 13. Compared. Heb. "he is like dumb, or perishable beasts." H. --- So much is man degraded by his attachment to riches and pleasures. Theod. C. --- Some explain this of Adam, (S. Chrys.) reduced to the necessity of labouring, and dying, like brutes. v. 21. Eccle. iii. 18. C.

--- This is a very serious reflection, to think that man should so far neglect the gifts of reason, as to strive for temporal advantages only, like irrational creatures. W.

Ver. 14. They shall delight in their mouth. Notwithstanding the wretched way in which they walk, they shall applaud themselves with their mouths, and glory in their doings, (Ch.) though it be to their shame. Phil. iii. 10. --- Heb. their posterity shall applaud their maxims, (C.) as many of their followers contributed to keep them in the delusion, (H.) which the damned will deplore, when it is too late. v. 15. S. Jer. --- A thirst after worldly advantages has proved their ruin; yet they obstinately persist in their evil ways. W.

Ver. 15. In the morning. That is, in the resurrection to a new life; when the just shall judge and condemn the wicked. --- From their glory. That is, when their short-lived glory in this world shall be past, and be no more. Ch. --- Sic transit gloria mundi. H. --- Then the world shall be turned upside down. C. --- The just shall have their day, (M.) when the beautiful palaces of the wicked shall be exchanged for darkness, and horrible torments. H. --- "Their bodies shall grow old in hell, because they have stretched out their hand, and destroyed the habitation of the house of his majesty." Targum. --- Their figure shall be destroyed in hell, after his dwelling. S. Jer. ---

They can rescue themselves no more than sheep. Those whom they oppressed shall be their judges. All friends will forsake them. W. --- Crowds shall be confined to those mansions, where the fire is not extinguished. M.

Ver. 16. Redeem. Chal. and some Rabbins seem to understand this of purgatory. "He will draw me from hell, and give me a place in his habitation."

Geneb. --- Others explain it of Christ's resurrection, or of the liberation of the patriarchs from limbo. Cassiod. --- It seems a full solution of the enigma v. 6. I repent, and shall have nothing to fear. Bert.

Ver. 18. Him. "The glory of a man increases with his prosperity, but it does not go down with him when he descends" (S. Amb.) into the grave. He there finds the same reception as the most ignoble.

Ver. 19. To him. The wicked are very selfish. They will seem grateful to those who are in power, and will cringe to get riches. H. --- Yea, they will seem to thank God for their prosperity, (W.) or rather, they will assume these appearances with men. Heb. "he will bless his soul during life, (Bert.) with all pleasures." Lu. xii. 19. Deut. xxix. 19. C. --- To him, is not in Heb. which insinuates, that people are flattered during their prosperity. H. --- Yet Houbigant would restore this word, "and he will praise thee when thou shalt have done him a kindness;" c may have been placed for i, as Sym. seems to have read auto. H. --- The proper use of riches is to do good. Luke xvi. 9.

Ver. 20. Fathers. Like them he shall die. H. --- Heb. reads in the second person, with Syr.

Aquila, &c. C. --- Yet Prot. Mont. and others agree with us and the Sept. --- And he. Heb. "they."

The --- edit. however, has opsetai. Each individual, as well as the whole collection of the damned, shall be deprived of light and comfort. H. --- Chal.

"the just shall live like his fathers, a long and happy life; but the wicked shall enjoy no light in the life to come."

Ver. 21. Understand. Heb. yabin, though (v. 13.) we find yalin, "shall remain all night." C. ---

But this is probably a mistake, as the prophet concludes with repeating this important instruction: (Bert.) Remember, O man, not to degrade thy rational soul. W. --- Thou wast honoured by all, and made to the likeness of God. M.

PSALM 49

PSALM XLIX. (DEUS DEORUM.)

The coming of Christ: who prefers virtue and inward purity before the blood of victims.

Ver. 1. For Asaph. The prep. L is placed before his name, as it is before David's.

H. --- Yet whether he was the author of the psalm, (C.) or only set it to music, (W.) is uncertain. M. --- The 72d, and ten following psalms, bear his name, and it is observed, that the style is not so flowing as those which are attributed to the royal prophet. Moller. --- It is certain, that Asaph was a prophet, and chief musician in the days of David. 1 Par. vi. 39. and xxv. 2. and 2 Par. xxix. 30.

Bert. --- But the psalms that have this title relate to the captives, and may have been composed by some of his descendants. This and the following seem designed to shew, that something more than bloody victims is required by God; and thus the Israelites, who could not offer sacrifices at Babylon, were comforted; and the people taught by degrees, to look for something more excellent than the law of Moses. C. --- The first and second coming of Christ are here described. D. ---

God's angels, just men, judges, (C.) idols, &c. W. --- Heb. El Elohim, Yehova,

"the mighty God, the Lord." H. --- From these three titles, some of the Fathers have proved the blessed Trinity. E.

--- But this argument is not conclusive. Bert. --- They ought, however, to fill us with awe, when he shall come to judge the earth, his chosen people, (v. 4. C.) or all mankind. Bert. M. --- Christ will come, surrounded by many legions of angels. H.

Ver. 2. Beauty. This may refer to God, or to Sion, (C.) where the Church of Christ began. W.

Ver. 3. Silence. Christ displayed the light of truth from Sion, at his first coming.

But he would not judge any till the second. Jo. iii. 17. and viii. 15. S. Jer. C. ---

Before him, at the last day, (H.) or in hell. S. Athan. --- Our Saviour appeared formerly with great mildness: but he will come with majesty and terror, after fire shall have destroyed all transitory things. W.

Ver. 4. Earth. As if they were animated. Deut. iv. 26. and xxxii. 1. Is. i. 2. Jer. ii.

12. --- Some understand the angels and apostles by heaven. C. --- Judge. Lit.

"to divide," discernere, (H.) the goats from the sheep. Matt. xxv. 32. C. M. ---

The whole earth, particularly the elect, will approve of God's decree. 1 Cor. vi.

2.

Ver. 5. His saints. Heb. "my merciful ones," (H.) the chosen people, (C.) particularly priests, (Theod.) who might have too high an opinion of the legal sacrifices, (S. Chrys.) or all the elect are meant. Matt. xxiv. 30.

Euseb. --- The Hebrews were the only nation which then offered sacrifices to the true God, though some individuals might do it among the Gentiles. C. --- Before, super, or, "who make a covenant with him respecting sacrifices." --- Prot. "those that have made a covenant with me by sacrifice." Mal. i. 12. H. --- The Sept. seem to have read v for i, more accurately, as the prophet speaks till v. 7. Bert. ---

Judgment should begin at the house of God.

And if first at us, what shall be the end of them that believe not the gospel of God? 1 Pet. iv. 17.

Rom. ii. 9. H. --- Those who believe not, are already judged. Jo. iii. --- Sacrifice generally precedes a covenant. Gen. xv. 17. M.

Ver. 6. Heavens. Apostles, (S. Jer.) or angels. Chal. S. Athan. --- God is judge.

His sentence must therefore be just, (M.) and we ought to tremble. 1 Cor. iv. 4.

H.

Ver. 7. Testify. I will require thee to speak the truth, and attest the world. Ps.

lxxx. 9. C.

Ver. 8. Sight. I complain of no neglect (M.) in these outward ceremonies. H. ---

God required no victims during the captivity; but he always demanded praise, (v. 14. C.) a contrite heart. Ps. l.

19. &c. H. --- The prophets often admonished the people of this truth, (Is. i. 2.

Jer. vii. 20. C.) that they might not set too high a value on sacrifices, (H.) which, though pleasing to God, are of no service to him; as all the world is his property. W.

Ver. 10. Oxen. S. Jer. and Prot. "the cattle upon a thousand hills." But our version is very good, and adopted by the Syr. Ferrand, &c. C. --- Aleph means an ox as well as a thousand; and i may have been added to the preceding word, instead of u, at the beginning of this. Bert. --- We find u here improperly in either, "beast." Houbig. --- No mention is made of fishes, because they were not used as victims. C.

Ver. 11. I know your number, and have absolute dominion over all. Is. xxxvii.

28. C. --- Field.

Ripe fruits. S. Cyr. Alex. --- With God all things are present. S. Aug. Lombard, 1

dist. 35. F.

Amama.

Ver. 13. Goats? Can any of you be so stupid? M. --- Some of the pagans believed, that their idols delighted in the smell of victims. H.

Ver. 14. Vows. A faithless promise is very displeasing. Eccle. v. 3. True religion must be interior, (C.) also 1 Cor. xiv. 15. H. --- We must discharge, not only our general, (M.) but also our particular vows, (W.) and obligations. H.

Ver. 15. Call. Prayer is a perfect act of religion, and a confession of God's dominion.

Qui fingit sacros auro vel marmore vultus,

Non facit ille Deos: qui rogat, ille facit. Mart. viii. v. 24.

To neglect prayer is, in some sense, to deny God. C. --- He is pleased to exercise our confidence, (H.) and will have us to call upon him in distress. M.

Ver. 16. Sinner. He is not blamed for praying: but his hypocrisy is condemned.

Bert. --- The world is full of such hypocrites, who have God in their mouths, but not in their hearts, and whose voice alone is the voice of Jacob. Gen. xxvii.

22. Is. xxix. 13. Tit. i. 16. --- The wicked judges, who condemned Susanna, (Dan. xiii.) should have attended to these lessons. C. --- Thou that teachest another, teachest not thyself. Rom. ii. 21. --- It is surely to be expected, (H.) that those who undertake to teach others, should shew good example, and serve God with sincerity, (W.) and not content themselves with the glory of their vocation. M.

Ver. 20. Lay. Heb. "slanderest." (Prot.) But dophi occurs on where else. Bert. ---

The sinner sits to detract, or with pleasure, (M.) habitually offends. H.

Ver. 21. Silent, and deferred punishment, (S. Aug.) waiting for thy conversion.

Rom. ii. 4. ---

Unjustly, is not expressed in Heb. Bert. --- Face, judgment and hell, (Chal.) or all these things, (S. Jer.) and thy manifold transgressions. The sight will be most intolerable. C.

Ver. 22. Lest he. Heb. "I tear you in pieces." Prot. H. --- Rapiat ut Leo. S. Aug. ---

It may be understood of death, (Theod.) or of God. C.

Ver. 23. Praise. This king of improper sacrifice, and those of justice, and of a contrite heart, (Ps.

iv. and l.) must accompany outward sacrifices, to make them acceptable. The latter has always been obligatory, (W.) as well as the former. H. --- This ps.

proves, that the old victims should give place to one far more excellent, the body of Christ, the sacrifice of praise which the Church offers, S. Aug. con.

advers. xx. orat. con Jud. vi. and ep. cxx. 18. W. --- Eucharist means "good grace," or thanksgiving, being intended to enable us to render that tribute of praise, which he requires. H. --- There. Heb. " to him that ordereth his conversation aright, will I," &c. Prot. ---

The difference consists only in the points. Bert. --- Syr. "There I will shew him the way of his salvation," or, according to S. Chrys. " even my salvation." C. ---

By adoring God in spirit and truth, (H.) we may be saved. M.

PSALM 50

PSALM L. (MISERERE.)

The repentance and confession of David after his sin. The fourth penitential psalm.

Ver. 2. Bethsabée. Sept. "Bersabee." Some copies add, "the wife of Urias." H.

--- The rest of the title is in Heb. &c. so that it is one of the most authentic.

Nathan did not give the admonition till about a year had elapsed after the transgression, (2 K. xii.) when David was made to enter into

himself, by a prophet inferior to himself. Bert. --- After his departure, he is supposed to have composed this psalm, to testify his repentance to all the world. C. --- He had also in view the state of the captives. Theod. &c. --- The two last verses seem to have been added at Babylon, (Abenezra) as a similar addition has been made (Ps. cv. 47. and 1 Par. xvi. 35. C.) by some inspired author. H. --- David knew that something more than confession was requisite, and that he must submit to temporal punishments, even though the prophet had assured him that his sin was remitted. He prays to be washed still more from evil habits, v.

4. W.

Ver. 3. Thy great mercy. Such is the purport of the Heb. chasdec, though (H.) the Chal. and Syr.

omit great. My sin requires the deepest compunction. I must strive to repair the scandal I have given. C. --- Mercies. I stand in need of many sorts, mitigation of punishment, true sorrow and perseverance, and that I may make some amends for my bad example, &c. W.

Ver. 4. Yet more, by baptism. Euseb. S. Amb. apol. --- The true penitent never ceases to deplore his sins, like David, S. Peter, and S. Paul. Eccli. v. 5. The psalmist prays, that all the remains of sin may be obliterated. Jo. xiii. 10. W.

Ver. 5. Me. I do not forget it, but am covered with shame. C. --- Sin is our greatest enemy, and continually cries for vengeance. H. --- While David did not confess, his sin lay heavy upon him.

W.

Ver. 6. Only, or principally, who art the only God, (1 Tim. i. 17. W.) the judge and witness of my crime. H. --- David was a king, and acknowledged no judge among men. S. Amb. c. x. --- Soli Deo reus est. Cassiod. --- Urias, whom he had injured, was no more. S. Aug. --- The action had been done in secret: (2 K. xii.

12.) but many began to suspect, and to blaspheme. H. --- Judged.

S. Paul reads thus, (Rom. iii. 4.) though the Heb. be, "when thou judgest." S.

Jerom has also *judicaberis*, so that we might infer, that the Heb. is now incorrect, or that *beshophtec* means in *judicare te*. Bert. --- Houbigant changes the order of the verse, "cleanse me from my sins, that thou mayst be blameless when thou comest into judgment: For I know," &c. H. --- Susanna was preserved from sinning by the thought of God's presence. Dan. xiii. 25. ---

If David fell, he confessed his fault. Bert. --- God is faithful to his promises, and desires the conversion of sinners, though some would represent him as cruel, and unconcerned about his creatures. The psalmist prevents this unjust inference, (H.) and proves, that God is both just and merciful. W. ---

He acknowledges his ingratitude, as the captives confess, that their sins have brought on them this chastisement, though they had not injured the Babylonians. Theod. Flam. C. --- God had often promised pardon to those who truly repent. An appeal is made to his truth and mercy.

Ver. 7. Sins. Heb. "iniquity,...and in sin did my mother warm or conceive me."

Original sin has a manifold deformity, and is the fatal root of other transgressions. See S. Aug. Ench. S. Tho. i. 2.

q. 82. a. 2. *est multiplex virtute*. H. --- The prophet speaks here undoubtedly of original sin.

Amama. --- No text could be more express, as the Fathers and the Jews agree.

Yet Grotius, whose opinions are almost always singular, and dangerous, maintains, that the expression is hyperbolical, and only implies, that David had been long subject to sin, even from his infancy, as Job was

naturally of a merciful disposition. Job xxxi. 18. --- Thus free-thinkers abuse the Scripture, and setting aside all authority, will only see what they think proper. C. --- The weakness of man is a motive for pity: (M.) David pleads for it, yet allows, that the fault was entirely his own, and that he had grace sufficient to have avoided it. C. --- The consideration of our sinful origin, ought to move us to beg, that we may be washed still more, and that we may not yield to our evil propensities. W. --- We may resist them, and therefore David would not make vain excuses in sin, as God love the truth, and a sincere confession. M.

Ver. 8. Uncertain. Heb. "in the interior," I am full of sin, and thou requirest that I should constantly adhere to virtue. See Job xiv. 1. --- To me. This increases my crime, (C.) as I cannot plead ignorance. M. --- Those who have true faith, are more easily converted. But God gives to all some good, which he loves in them, and is ever ready to preserve his gifts, and to save his creatures. W.

Ver. 9. Hyssop, which was used in sprinkling lepers, &c. (Lev. xiv. 6.) not that the like ceremony, or even sacrifice, would suffice to heal the wound of the soul. Sincere contrition, (v.

18, 19.) and the virtue of Christ's blood, are necessary. C. Heb. ix. 19. -- - The heat (Num. xix.) and operation of this sovereign medicine was shewn to the prophet. Jo. xix. W. --- The sprinkling of the priest might be of service, if the heart was contrite. Heb. ix. 13. M.

Ver. 10. Rejoice, when thou givest me an assurance of pardon. My bones, or virtue, shall then be restored. Heb. "the bones which thou hast broken may exult." S. Jer. H. --- God gives contrition, after which the whole interior is filled with joy. Bert. --- When the affections are purified, the soul takes delight in God's word, and revives. W. --- The assurance of being pardoned, give her fresh alacrity in his service. M.

Ver. 11. Face. Anger. If the sinner consider his fault, God will forget it. C. --- His justice requires that he should punish the impenitent. W.

Ver. 12. Create. Heb. bera, a term never used but for a new production.

Whatever comes immediately from God must be pure, and as David had fallen into impurity, he earnestly implores this gift. He prays for the new heart of flesh. Ezech. xxxvi. 26. H. --- Thou hast said, Behold, I make all things new.

Apoc. xxi. Oh that I may be included, that I may sing a new canticle, having become a new man! 2 Cor. v. 17. Eph. iv. 24. Bert. --- Right. Heb. "constant,"

(H.) the Holy Spirit, thy inspiration, or that uprightness, of which I have been deprived. C. --- Bowels, or interior. W. --- These sentiments ought to animate priests, when they hear confessions. W.

Ver. 13. Spirit of prophecy, which is not withdrawn, except for some crime.

Orig. Huet. p. 35.

--- David had been without this privilege, till his repentance. S. Athan. -
-- Yet S.

Chrys. and Theodoret maintain the contrary. C. --- He prays for final perseverance, which is due to none, (Bert.) and that he may fall no more. W.

Ver. 14. Salvation, or thy salutary joy, (Bert.) "the joy of thy Jesus," (S. Jer.) for whom he prays, (S. Aug.) knowing that He will save his people from their sins, and that there is salvation in no other name. H. --- Perfect. Lit. "principal."

Sept. "conducting;" such a spirit as may suit one who is to command. H. ---

This may denote sound reason, (4 Mac. Philo Nobil) which keeps the passions under, (S. Chrys. Job xxx. 15.) or God himself, to whose Spirit all others shall be subservient. Rancè often inculcated to his Monks, the importance of having this principal spirit, which includes every virtue, particularly of liberality, as the Heb. nediba, implies. Bert. --- "Thy free

Spirit." Prot. --- How earnest should we endeavour to be disentangled from all the chains of our passions! H. --- David might also fear, lest he had forfeited the throne, like Saul, whom the Spirit left.

1 K. x. 9. and xvi. 14. Kings affected to be styled liberal. Lu. xxiii. 25. C. --- He repeats his petition thrice, in allusion to the three persons in one God, (S. Aug.

&c.) and prays, that the Messiah may still spring from him, notwithstanding his sins, and that he may have a constant and willing spirit to fall no more. W. ---

Principal, or liberal, may refer to the Holy Ghost, the fountain of all grace, or to the king, who ought to be generous. M.

Ver. 15. Thee. The sinner cannot testify his gratitude better, than by promoting the conversion of others. W. --- This is a sort of satisfaction. M. --- While engaged in sin, David could not well exhort his subjects to repentance. His example was rather an inducement for them to transgress.

Bert.--- But when they saw his grief, and knew that God had pardoned him, they were no longer tempted to despair. He also watched more carefully over their conduct.

Ver. 16. Blood, from death, which I have deserved. S. Athan. --- That of Urias, and his companions, (W.) cries to heaven for vengeance. 2 K. xi. 24. H.

---Hence the word sanguinibus, is used. Bert. --- Spare me, and my people. ---

Justice, which has given place to mercy. C. ---

The latter word is here used by Sym. and justice may have this meaning.

Theod. --- Sixtus V.

reads exaltabit, instead of exultabit, which Sept. agalliasetai, (C.) requires.

Heb. terannen, "shall sing aloud of." Prot. "shall praise thy justice." S. Jer. ---

Extol agrees better with exaltabit, though both have nearly the same sense. H.

--- God's justice will pardon the penitent, as he has promised. W.

Ver. 18. Sacrifice. If my crime were of such a nature as the be expiated by certain victims, I would surely have offered them: but my heart has offended, and must do penance. C. --- The legal victims were not of themselves sufficient to remit sin. M. --- Contrition was necessary. Is.

lxvi. 2. Ezec. vi. 9. Bert. --- The Scripture often prefers internal, before outward sacrifices. This of the heart must precede those of justice, and of praise. W. ---

The heart must be broken, to make place for love. Compunction is thrice urged. The two first terms in Heb. are the same,

"contrite," (H.) broken, or disconcerted. Kateklasthe philon etor. Odyss. M. ---

The captives might adopt this prayer. Dan. iii. 39. C. --- External sacrifices are commended in the next verse, as they are good, (H.) being instituted by God.

M.

Ver. 20. Deal. These two verses have no necessary connexion with the preceding: they may have been added by some prophet at Babylon, (C.) or David foresaw the destruction of the city by the Chaldees. S. Chrys. - -- He might fear that his sin would draw ruin on the capital, as a much less offence did, and as in all ages, the sins of the rulers have fallen on their subjects. 2 K.

xxiv.

H. --- Though the place was not destitute of fortifications, (C.) he might pray that they might be completed, (Bert.) as they were by Solomon, who built the temple and various walls, so that David might very well add this conclusion, (3

K. iii. 1. and ix. 15. H.) alluding to the sacrifices which should be offered in the future temple. Bert. --- He insinuates, that his pardon may prove beneficial to his people, and sues for it to be granted for their sakes. M.

Ver. 21. Justice; works of piety, (Ps. iv. 6.) or victims vowed or prescribed by the law; the same which are afterwards styled holocausts (C.) by two different terms, hola and calil. H. --- The latter includes fruits, &c. C. --- While we are in sin, our good works are less acceptable. M.

PSALM 51

PSALM LI. (QUID GLORIARIS.)

David condemneth the wickedness of Doeg, and foretelleth his destruction.

Ver. 2-3. Achimelech. Sixtus V. Sept. &c. read Abimelech. But the former is the true name. See 1 K. xxii. 9. 20. C. --- The word understanding implies, that we ought to reflect on the misery of detraction, and bear our crosses with submission. Bert. --- Doeg was but half a Jew, and persecuted the faithful. W.

--- Iniquity. Heb. chesed, means also mercy, and some translate, "the mercy of God! or, the great mercy." Noble exploit! C. --- But our version seems more natural.

El may be a preposition, as Sym. has Kath. Bert. --- If Doeg, who was the most powerful of the shepherds of Saul, (1 K. xxi. 7.) thought it his duty to give his master information of what had passed, he ought to

have stated the matter fairly, instead of insinuating, that the high-priest was ill-affected. H. --- Nothing could be more false, as he supposed he was acting agreeably to the interests of Saul, and of the state. C.

Ver. 6. Ruin. Sept. katapontismou, "drowning," or to make the innocent suffer

"shipwreck."

Ver. 7. Thy, is not found in Heb. Doeg would not dare to enter the tabernacle, after he had slain the priests. C. --- Houbigant properly supplies thy. Bert. ---

Living. The Jews inform us, that Doeg slew himself with his master at Gelboe, and that David punished his offspring with death.

C.

Ver. 8. Laugh, at the last day, when they will have nothing to fear, nor the wicked to hope. In this life, the just are full of compassion; but they cannot but approve of God's judgments. C.

Ver. 9. The man. Heb. hageber, "the hero."

Ver. 10. Fruitful. David foretells his own prosperity on the throne, (W.) when this wretch shall be no more. H. --- He was at this time in great perplexity, (C.) in banishment from the house of God. M.

Ver. 11. It punished the wicked, and asserted thy just providence. H. --- Good.

Thy saints find the greatest comfort in thee. C.

PSALM 52

PSALM LII. (DIXIT INSIPIENS.)

The general corruption of man before the coming of Christ.

Ver. 1. Maeleth, or Machalath. A musical instrument, or a chorus of musicians: for S. Jerom renders it, per chorum; (Ch.) and Aquila, "for dancing." Sixtus V.

&c. read incorrectly, "for Amalec." --- The psalm is nearly the same with the 13th, (C.) except v. 6. M. --- We know not the reason why David gave this second copy, omitting the name of Jehovah. Bert. --- S. Aug.

explains it of the dangers of the latter times. W. --- It seems to speak of the return from captivity, v. 7. C.

Ver. 6. God hath scattered the bones, &c. That is, God hath brought to nothing the strength of all those that seek to please men, to the prejudice of their duty to their Maker. Ch. --- That. Heb.

"who besiege thee. Thou hast confounded them, because," &c. Sept. seem to have read more correctly, as no one has been addressed before. Bert.

Ver. 7. Glad. The Fathers explain this of Christ's redemption. The captives doubted not but that they should be speedily set at liberty, as the prophets had assured them. C.

PSALM 53

PSALM LIII. (DEUS IN NOMINE TUO.)

A prayer for help in distress.

Ver. 2. Ziph lay to the south of Juda. H. --- David was rescued from the most imminent danger, by an irruption of the Philistines. He then composed this canticle, expressing his sentiments in danger, and his gratitude to God. C. --- It may also be used by any person in distress. W. --- The Church orders it to be said by her ministers at Prime, that they may be protected from all their spiritual enemies. Bert. --- The Fathers apply it to Jesus Christ, (S. Hil.) or to his persecuted members. S. Aug.

Ver. 3. Name, which is a strong tower, (Prov. xviii. 10. C.) event thyself. Hence it is so criminal to take it in vain. Bert. --- Judge. Ancient psalters have, "deliver."

Saul and the Zipheans persecute me unjustly. I commit my cause to thee. H. ---

Defend me for the justice of my cause.

W.

Ver. 5. Strangers. Barbarous, (W.) enemies, though of the same tribe. C. ---

Hostis dicebatur quem nunc peregrinum dicimus. Cic. Off. i. --- The devil and our passions, as well as the world, are such to us. Bert.

Ver. 6. Behold. He admires how God delivered him, though Saul seemed to have only one step more to take. Jesus Christ was secure amid the persecutions of the Jews, till he was pleased to deliver himself up. Jo. x. 18. C.

Ver. 7. Truth. To fulfil thy promises. H. --- He foretells their destruction.

Ver. 8. Freely, without being commanded. W. M. Lev. iii. 1. --- Jesus Christ was offered, because he would. Is. liii. 7. Jo. x. 17. S. Jer. --- Good, so to do, (D.) or sweet in itself. Ps. li.

11. C.

Ver. 9. Enemies, from the hill which divided the armies. I saw them retire, (H.) and in security beheld their chastisement. M.

PSALM 54

PSALM LIV. (EXAUDI DEUS.)

A prayer of a just man under persecution from the wicked. It agrees to Christ persecuted by the Jews, and betrayed by Judas.

Ver. 1. David. It alludes to some of his persecutions, particularly to that of Absalom, as well as to that of the Church, and of Jesus Christ. Bede explains it of Onias: who, being excluded from the high priesthood, retired into Egypt, and built the temple of Onion. 2 Mac. xiii. C.

Ver. 3. Hear me. He repeats the same petition four times, (H.) to testify his fervour, and humility. Eccli. xxxv. 21. --- Exercise, among the wicked, (S. Aug.) or while I consider the sufferings of Christ. Euseb. --- David was perplexed what course to take, when he first heard of his son's revolt. Our Saviour was sorrowful unto death. Matt. xxvi. 37. C. - -- This life is a warfare. W. ---

Ldoleschia. Heb. sichi, denotes serious (H.) meditation. Gen. xxiv. 63. M.

Ver. 4. Upon me. When a person has fallen into distress, the world is ever ready to attribute it to some fault. Absalom accused his father of neglecting to judge, &c. 2 K. xv. 2. The Jews calumniated and sought the death of Christ, whose agony in the garden is well described, (v. 5.) as well as the consternation of David, at the sight of such a general revolt, (C.) which almost overwhelmed him. W.

Ver. 5. Troubled, like a woman in labour, (M.) as yachil implies, (C.) in Hiphel. M.

Ver. 7. Dove, which flies swiftly. He now adored the judgments of God, which chastised him, as he had threatened; (2 K. xii. 11.) though, while innocent, he had rejected a similar proposal. Ps.

x. 1. The event shewed, that he acted wisely in retiring beyond the Jordan. C.

--- O that I could fly, and in the simplicity of the dove, be removed from these afflictions! W. --- As I could not go to heaven, I retired into the wilderness. M.

Ver. 9. Storm. The first fury of the rebels, which is most dangerous, is thus specified. David was convinced, that his son's party would dwindle away, when he was informed that he did not pursue him, following the advice of Chusai. C. --- Heb. "I would hasten my escape from the impetuous wind and tempest." But the Sept. may be equally correct. Bert. --- God protected his weak servant in the greatest dangers. W.

Ver. 10. Cast down. Heb. "swallow up," as the earth did Dathan. C. --- Sept.

"drown." H. ---

Tongues, as at Babel, that they may not know how to proceed. C. --- Heb.

"swallow up...the torrent of their tongue." Bate. --- Pallag, means also to

"divide." Absalom was accordingly infatuated by David's friend. 2 K. xv. 31.

and xvii. 7. M. --- City of Hebron, or even of Jerusalem, which caused the king to leave no garrison in it. The city was still more abandoned in our Saviour's regard. C. --- Contradiction. Their counsels agree not. They have their troubles, yet will not amend; but strive to oppress the poor. W.

Ver. 13. From him. But how shall we guard against a traitor? C. --- The injury received from a friend is most cutting. W.

Ver. 14. Guide, the prime minister, (Bert.) and chief of the council. M. -- - Such was Achitophel, who had nevertheless been long (C.) secretly disaffected. See 2 K. xv. 12. and xvi. 23. He professed the same religion, and was trusted with the most important affairs, as Judas carried the purse. H.

Ver. 15. Consent, or with expedition, as the Rabbins order people to go to the temple, though they must return slowly. All this designates

Judas. C. ---

Dreadful lesson for all sacred ministers, who prove faithless! (Bert.) participating of the holy sacraments of the Catholic Church, (W.) and yet betraying themselves, and their master! Achitophel had probably to attend David in the temple, as Naaman did Benadad. 4 K. v. 18. H.

Ver. 16. Let death, &c. This, and such like imprecations, which occur in the psalms, are delivered prophetically; that is, by way of foretelling the punishments which shall fall upon the wicked from divine justice, and approving the righteous ways of God: but not by way of ill-will, or uncharitable curses, which the law of God disallows. Ch. --- David shewed even too much tenderness towards the rebels, in the opinion of Joab, &c. He would not hurt Saul. His predictions were verified; as Achitophel became a suicide, Absalom perished miserably, suspended between heaven and earth, as an object of horror to both, while many of his accomplices were either slain, or fell into precipices. 2 K. xvii. 23. and xviii. 8. H. --- Hell, by a sudden death, like Antiochus, Core, &c. Num. xvi. 30. They just are already dead to this world.

Bert. --- Those who sin on purpose, descend, as it were, alive into hell. W.

Ver. 18. Evening. The Hebrew then began the day. C. Gen. i. 5. H. --- They had three times allotted for prayer, (Dan. vi. 10.) as the Church had afterwards.

Const. Ap. vii. 25. C. --- Evening song, matins, and the sacrifice of the mass, are the principal times for divine service. W. ---

David comprises all times, because his prayer was continual. Bert. C.

Ver. 19. Among many, &c. That is, they that drew near to attack me, were many in company, all combining to fight against me. Ch. --- Or, many also joined themselves to me with Joab, and the holy angels, (4 K. vi. 16.) though almost all Israel followed Absalom. 2 K. xv. 13. C. --- In many things, schismatics agree with the Church; but their crime is the breaking of unity. S. Aug.

Ver. 20. Change, or redemption for them, (Ps. xliii. 13. Euseb.) or they will not amend, (W.) nor cease to blaspheme God, and to calumniate me. C. --- Eternal.

Lit. "He who is before ages." H.

Ver. 21. Repay. Heb. bishlomaiv, "in his tribulations," or "against his peaceable ones."

Houbigant too arbitrarily translates, "they have sent forth their hand against, "

&c. Bert.

Ver. 22. They are divided, &c. Dispersed, scattered, and brought to nothing, by the wrath of God, who looks with indignation on their wicked and deceitful ways. Ch. --- They are separated from the good, (S. Jer.) slain by a look. 2

Thess. ii. 8. --- Near, or fought, v. 19. C. --- Some translate, "they have divided the butter, like words of his mouth." But this is less accurate, and the same idea is conveyed in the next words. Bert. --- Prot. " The words of his mouth were smoother than butter, but war was in his heart. His words were softer than oil, yet were they drawn swords." H. --- My enemy has violated every law, under his appearance of friendship. C.

--- Darts. Absalom kissed the men of Israel to delude them, (2 K. xv. 2.) and the traitor gave this sign to those who came to seize our Saviour. Matt. xxvi. 48. C.

--- The words of God are most excellent in themselves, but they seem hard to the incredulous. Thus the Capharnaïtes gave rise to the first heresy against the words of Christ, which S. Peter piously believed, though, as yet, he did not comprehend their meaning. Jo. vi. S. Aug. W. --- His heart and words may thus be understood of God: but they more probably relate to any one of David's numerous enemies, who is thus singled out. H.

Ver. 23. Cast. The prophet had experienced the happy effect of this conduct. C.

--- In all troubles and doubts, we must have recourse to God. W. 1 Pet. v. 7.

Ver. 24. Destruction; "into gehenna," (Chal.) or "hell," (S. Jer.) to which the judge sentences the reprobate, without promoting their crimes. S. Aug. C. ---

Days. It is rare that murderers and notorious malefactors escape punishment in this world; but in the next, they will surely be requited. Absalom perished in the flower of his age. Bert. --- Achitophel, and may others, have been suddenly cut off. God sometimes permits such to reign for a time, to exercise his servants, or that they may repent. S. Aug. --- The Scripture often threatens sinners in this manner. Job xxi.

21. Is. lxx. 20. C. --- Their days are indeed spent, when they die. But if they had altered their conduct, they might have prolonged their life, (H.) according to the usual course of nature. W.

M.